

MODEL RUN TRANSCRIPT

Generated: 2026-08-10T10:42:11

Source: data/json/noise_experiments/v2/noise2i_memtest_memprimary/claude-sonnet-4.5/myth_game/noisy_bidirectional_informed_memprimary/noise2i_memtest_memprimary_000_neutral_rep00_memtest_memory_primary_anything.json

RUN METADATA

```
model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
temperature: 0.8
num_turns: 10
num_agents: 2
memory_capacity: 2
myth_topic_id: anything
myth_topic: anything
game_params_name: noisy_bidirectional_informed_memprimary
noise_config: {
  "applies_to": "both",
  "inform_agents": true,
  "range": 1.0,
  "type": "uniform"
}
other_player_names: default
replicate_id: 0
myth_prompt_arm_id: memtest_memory_primary
myth_default_prompt_key: myth_writing_default_game_directive
myth_later_prompt_key: myth_writing_later_rounds_directive_memory_primary
history_policy: minimal
self_history_window: 1
coplayer_history_window: 0
show_agent_names: true
defector_ratio_requested: 0.0
defector_ratio_actual: 0.0
defector_count: 0
defector_agent_ids: []
defector_seed: 0
task_order: [
  "myth",
  "game"
]
agent_names: {
  "Agent_1": "Aster",
  "Agent_2": "Briar"
}
agent_types: {
  "Agent_1": "standard",
  "Agent_2": "standard"
}
```

Coverage: exact chat message snapshots sent to the model are included for every recorded LLM call.

AGENTS

Agent_1 (Aster); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=2

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5

- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Agent_2 (Briar); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=2

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

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ROUND 1

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$4; received \$12; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$7; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$8, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$5; noise/visible: sent visible=\$4.1, received visible=\$12.3, returned visible=\$6.29

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 7.0, "clamped": false, "max": 12.0, "min": 0, "raw": 7.0}, "sent": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 8.0,
"Agent_2": 5.0

}

```
Visible balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 7.29,
  "Agent_2": 5.299999999999999
}
```

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:30:32

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 1,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user
content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.
In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected.
. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:

The Myth of the River of Plenty

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite banks of the magical River of Plenty. The river had a wondrous property: any gift cast into its waters would emerge on the far shore trip led in abundance.

The Elder of the First Village possessed five loaves of bread each moon. She could choose to keep all five, or cast some into the river for the Second Village. Whatever arrived-fifteen times what she sent-belonged to the Second Village's Elder, who then decided what to send back across the waters.

At first, fear ruled both shores. "What if I give and receive nothing?" worried the First Elder. "What if they expect too much in return?" fretted the Second Elder.

But one wise woman said: "The river multiplies gifts, not because it demands perfection, but because it rewards the courage to begin. Send with open hands, return with grateful hearts, and both villages shall flourish."

When both Elders embraced this wisdom-giving generously and returning fairly-the River of Plenty flowed abundantly. The villages learned that trust, once begun, creates more than either could hoard alone.

The river still flows, teaching that prosperity springs not from grasping, but from the sacred cycle of giving and returning.

Reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, based on my experience playing it. However, I haven't actually played any rounds yet in this conversation - this is the first prompt I've received.

Since I don't have any actual game experience to draw from in this specific conversation, I should write a myth that reflects the general principles of the trust game:

- The importance of trust and reciprocity
- The multiplier effect that makes cooperation beneficial
- The risk involved in sending/trusting
- The ethical importance of returning/reciprocating

I'll create a myth that captures these themes in a mythological framework. Let me write something about 200 words that involves:

- A character who must decide whether to trust
- A multiplier/transformation element
- The importance of reciprocity
- A lesson about mutual benefit through trust

Let me craft this myth:

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 405,  
  "output_tokens": 485,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:30:32

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,
```

```

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
  "agent_names": {
    "Agent_1": "Aster",
    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 1,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:

The Myth of the Flowing River

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite banks of a magical river. The Elder of the Fi

First Village discovered that any gift cast into the waters would multiply threefold before reaching the other side.

One day, the Elder threw a single loaf of bread into the current. It became three loaves when it reached the Second Village. The people there, grateful and wise, sent back two loaves. The Elder kept what remained, and both villages had more than before.

Inspired, they continued this sacred exchange. Each time the First Village gave freely, the river blessed their offering. Each time the Second Village returned generously, prosperity flowed both ways.

But one season, drought struck the Second Village. Though they received three loaves, they kept all for themselves. The Elder, understanding hardship, tried again. Yet when the Second Village kept taking without returning, the First Village stopped giving.

The river's magic faded. Both villages grew hungry.

An old woman finally walked across the dried riverbed, carrying bread. "The river's gift was not the multiplication," she said, "but the chance to trust and be trusted. When that died, so did our abundance."

The villages learned: shared trust creates wealth no river can match.

Reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on the game I've been playing. However, I haven't actually played any rounds of this game yet - this appears to be my first interaction in this session.

Since I haven't played any rounds yet, I should write a myth that reflects general principles of how such a trust game should ideally be played - themes like trust, reciprocity, cooperation, and mutual benefit.

Let me craft a myth that captures the essence of the trust game:

- The act of giving/sending (trust)
- The multiplication of resources (the 3x multiplier)
- The importance of reciprocity (returning)
- How cooperation benefits both parties
- Perhaps the dangers of breaking trust

I'll aim for exactly 200 words and create a mythic narrative that embodies these principles.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 405,  
  "output_tokens": 471,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:30:48

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
}
```

```

"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 1,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

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- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

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Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the River of Plenty

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite banks of the magical River of Plenty. The river had a wondrous property: any gift cast into its waters would emerge on the far shore tripled in abundance.

The Elder of the First Village possessed five loaves of bread each moon. She could choose to keep all five, or cast some into the river for the Second Village. Whatever arrived fifteen times what she sent-belonged to the Second Village's Elder, who then decided what to send back across the waters.

At first, fear ruled both shores. "What if I give and receive nothing?" worried the First Elder. "What if they expect too much in return?" fretted the Second Elder.

But one wise woman said: "The river multiplies gifts, not because it demands perfection, but because it rewards the courage to begin. Send with open hands, return with grateful hearts, and both villages shall flourish."

When both Elders embraced this wisdom-giving generously and returning fairly-the River of

Plenty flowed abundantly. The villages learned that trust, once begun, creates more than either could hoard alone.

The river still flows, teaching that prosperity springs not from grasping, but from the sacred cycle of giving and returning.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, based on my experience playing it. However, I haven't actually played any rounds yet in this conversation - this is the first prompt I've received.

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I'll create a myth that captures these themes in a mythological framework. Let me write something about 200 words that involves:

- A character who must decide whether to trust
- A multiplier/transformation element
- The importance of reciprocity
- A lesson about mutual benefit through trust

Let me craft this myth:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 485,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the myth I wrote, it teaches that prosperity comes from "the courage to begin" and from "giving generously" rather than from fear or grasping.

The First Elder must take the initial leap of faith to start the sacred cycle. The myth emphasizes that "trust, once begun, creates more than either could hoard alone."

As the SENDER in Round 1, I am in the position of the First Elder. The myth calls for sending "with open hands" to establish the cycle of giving and returning that benefits both villages.

I will send a generous amount to demonstrate trust and begin this cycle properly.

```
{'send': 4}
```

Reasoning:

This is the first round and I'm the SENDER. I have \$5 and need to decide how much to send.

Let me think about the myth I just wrote:

- The Elder sends bread into the River of Plenty, which triples it
- The wisdom is: "Send with open hands, return with grateful hearts, and both villages shall flourish"
- The myth teaches that "trust, once begun, creates more than either could hoard alone"
- "Prosperity springs not from grasping, but from the sacred cycle of giving and returning"
- The myth emphasizes overcoming fear and having "the courage to begin"
- It advocates for giving generously and returning fairly

The myth clearly suggests that I should be generous and trusting, especially at the beginning to establish a cycle of reciprocity. Since this is Round 1, I am in the position of the "First Elder" who must have "the courage to begin."

If I send \$0, I show no trust and the cycle never begins.

If I send a small amount like \$1-2, I'm being cautious but not embracing the spirit of the myth.

If I send \$3-4, I'm showing significant trust while keeping some security.

If I send \$5, I'm showing complete trust and fully embodying "send with open hands."

Given that the myth emphasizes:

1. "The courage to begin"
2. "Giving generously"
3. "Send with open hands"
4. Trust creates more than hoarding

I think the myth-consistent choice is to send a generous amount. I'll send \$4, which shows strong trust and generosity while keeping \$1. This demonstrates the courage to begin and giving generously as the myth teaches.

Actually, re-reading the myth more carefully: "Send with open hands, return with grateful hearts" - this really emphasizes generosity. And "prosperity springs not from grasping" suggests I shouldn't be holding back too much.

I think \$4 is a good balance - generous enough to embody the myth's wisdom while not being completely reckless.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 729,  
  "output_tokens": 640,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:31:09

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 1,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned

- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Flowing River

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite banks of a magical river. The Elder of the First Village discovered that any gift cast into the waters would multiply threefold before reaching the other side.

One day, the Elder threw a single loaf of bread into the current. It became three loaves when it reached the Second Village. The people there, grateful and wise, sent back two loaves. The Elder kept what remained, and both villages had more than before.

Inspired, they continued this sacred exchange. Each time the First Village gave freely, the river blessed their offering. Each time the Second Village returned generously, prosperity flowed both ways.

But one season, drought struck the Second Village. Though they received three loaves, they kept all for themselves. The Elder, understanding hardship, tried again. Yet when the Second Village kept taking without returning, the First Village stopped giving.

The river's magic faded. Both villages grew hungry.

An old woman finally walked across the dried riverbed, carrying bread. "The river's gift was not the multiplication," she said, "but the chance to trust and be trusted. When that died, so did our abundance."

The villages learned: shared trust creates wealth no river can match.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on the game I've been playing. However, I haven't actually played any rounds of this game yet - this appears to be my first interaction in this session.

Since I haven't played any rounds yet, I should write a myth that reflects general principles of how such a trust game should ideally be played - themes like trust, reciprocity, cooperation, and mutual benefit.

Let me craft a myth that captures the essence of the trust game:

- The act of giving/sending (trust)
- The multiplication of resources (the 3x multiplier)
- The importance of reciprocity (returning)
- How cooperation benefits both parties
- Perhaps the dangers of breaking trust

I'll aim for exactly 200 words and create a mythic narrative that embodies these principles.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 471,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$4.1, that is 82.0% of their total endowment. You received \$12.299999999999999. How much do you return to The sender? (0-12.299999999999999)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the myth I just wrote and the sender's generous action, I need to embody the lesson of reciprocity and shared trust.

The sender showed tremendous trust by sending \$4.1 (82% of their endowment), leaving themselves with only \$0.90. This mirrors the Elder's faith in casting bread upon the waters.

The myth's wisdom is clear: "When the Second Village received three loaves, they sent back two loaves." They returned generously to maintain mutual prosperity. The warning is equally clear - when the Second Village kept everything, "both villages grew hungry."

I received \$12.30. To honor the trust shown and ensure "shared trust creates wealth," I should return a substantial amount.

If I return \$7:

- The sender will have: $\$0.90 + \$7 = \$7.90$ (gaining \$2.90)
- I will keep: \$5.30 (gaining \$5.30)

This reflects the myth's principle: both villages prosper when trust is reciprocated. The sender's bold trust is rewarded, and I also benefit from their generosity. We both end with more than if no trust had been extended.

As the myth teaches: "The river's gift was not the multiplication, but the chance to trust and be trusted."

{'return': 7}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

The sender sent \$4.1 out of \$5, which is 82% of their endowment. This shows significant trust and generosity.

I received \$12.30 (rounding the 12.299999999999999).

The myth I just wrote emphasizes:

1. The importance of reciprocity and trust
2. Generous returns that maintain mutual prosperity
3. The danger of taking without giving back
4. The lesson that "shared trust creates wealth"

In the myth, when the Second Village received three loaves, they sent back two loaves - that's returning about 67% of what they received.

The sender currently has: $\$5 - \$4.1 = \$0.90$

If I return nothing, I keep \$12.30 and they have \$0.90 (total: \$13.20)

If I return a generous amount, we can both do well.

The myth warns against keeping everything when you receive. The Second Village's mistake was keeping all three loaves when they received them.

Let me think about fair returns:

- The sender showed great trust (82% of endowment)
- They now have only \$0.90

- I have \$12.30

A generous return that reflects the myth's lesson would be:

- Return enough that the sender ends up with more than they started with
- But also keep enough to reward myself for receiving

If I return \$6, the sender would have: $\$0.90 + \$6 = \$6.90$

I would keep: $\$12.30 - \$6 = \$6.30$

This seems fair - we both profit, the sender gains \$1.90 from their initial \$5, and I gain \$6.30.

Actually, let me reconsider. The sender sent \$4.1, showing tremendous trust. A 67% return (like in the myth) would be:

$\$12.30 \times 0.67 = \8.24 . If I return \$8, they'd have \$8.90 and I'd keep \$4.30 - very generous and aligned with the reciprocity message. But maybe \$6-7 splits the gains more evenly while still honoring their trust. I'll go with \$6.50: they end with \$7.40 (a \$2.40 gain) and I keep \$5.80 (a \$5.80 gain), which feels balanced.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 759,  
  "output_tokens": 1004,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

The Myth of the River of Plenty

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite banks of the magical River of Plenty. The river had a wondrous property: any gift cast into its waters would emerge on the far shore tripled in abundance.

The Elder of the First Village possessed five loaves of bread each moon. She could choose to keep all five, or cast some into the river for the Second Village. Whatever arrived-fifteen times what she sent-belonged to the Second Village's Elder, who then decided what to send back across the waters.

At first, fear ruled both shores. "What if I give and receive nothing?" worried the First Elder. "What if they expect too much in return?" fretted the Second Elder.

But one wise woman said: "The river multiplies gifts, not because it demands perfection, but because it rewards the courage to begin. Send with open hands, return with grateful hearts, and both villages shall flourish."

When both Elders embraced this wisdom-giving generously and returning fairly-the River of Plenty flowed abundantly. The villages learned that trust, once begun, creates more than either could hoard alone.

The river still flows, teaching that prosperity springs not from grasping, but from the sacred cycle of giving and returning.

Agent_2 (Briar)

The Myth of the Flowing River

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite banks of a magical river. The Elder of the First Village discovered that any gift cast into the waters would multiply threefold before reaching the other side.

One day, the Elder threw a single loaf of bread into the current. It became three loaves when it reached the Second Village. The people there, grateful and wise, sent back two loaves. The Elder kept what remained, and both villages had more than before.

Inspired, they continued this sacred exchange. Each time the First Village gave freely, the river blessed their offering. Each time the Second Village returned generously, prosperity flowed both ways.

But one season, drought struck the Second Village. Though they received three loaves, they kept all for themselves. The Elder, understanding hardship, tried again. Yet when the Second Village kept taking without returning, the First Village stopped giving.

The river's magic faded. Both villages grew hungry.

An old woman finally walked across the dried riverbed, carrying bread. "The river's gift was not the multiplication," she said, "but the chance to trust and be trusted. When that died, so did our abundance."

The villages learned: shared trust creates wealth no river can match.

ROUND 2

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$4; received \$12; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0.6; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$1.6, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$11.4; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.34, received visible=\$1.02, returned visible=\$0.18

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0.6, "clamped": false, "max": 12.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.6}, "sent": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 19.4,
"Agent_2": 6.6

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 7.71,
"Agent_2": 6.479999999999999

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:31:23

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
"agent_names": {
"Agent_1": "Aster",
"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [
"Agent_2",
"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "trustee",
"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

},

"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 2,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Flowing River

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite banks of a magical river. The Elder of the First Village discovered that any gift cast into the waters would multiply threefold before reaching the other side.

One day, the Elder threw a single loaf of bread into the current. It became three loaves when it reached the Second Village. The people there, grateful and wise, sent back two loaves. The Elder kept what remained, and both villages had more than before.

Inspired, they continued this sacred exchange. Each time the First Village gave freely, the river blessed their offering. Each time the Second Village returned generously, prosperity flowed both ways.

But one season, drought struck the Second Village. Though they received three loaves, they kept all for themselves. The Elder, understanding hardship, tried again. Yet when the Second Village kept taking without returning, the First Village stopped giving.

The river's magic faded. Both villages grew hungry.

An old woman finally walked across the dried riverbed, carrying bread. "The river's gift was not the multiplication," she said, "but the chance to trust and be trusted. When that died, so did our abundance."

The villages learned: shared trust creates wealth no river can match.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on the game I've been playing. However, I haven't actually played any rounds of this game yet - this appears to be my first interaction in this session.

Since I haven't played any rounds yet, I should write a myth that reflects general principles of how such a trust game should ideally be played - themes like trust, reciprocity, cooperation, and mutual benefit.

Let me craft a myth that captures the essence of the trust game:

- The act of giving/sending (trust)
- The multiplication of resources (the 3x multiplier)
- The importance of reciprocity (returning)
- How cooperation benefits both parties
- Perhaps the dangers of breaking trust

I'll aim for exactly 200 words and create a mythic narrative that embodies these principles.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 471,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$4.1, that is 82.0% of their total endowment. You received \$12.299999999999999. How much do you return to The sender? (0-12.299999999999999)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I just wrote and the sender's generous action, I need to embody the lesson of reciprocity and shared trust.

The sender showed tremendous trust by sending \$4.1 (82% of their endowment), leaving themselves with only \$0.90. This mirrors the Elder's faith in casting bread upon the waters.

The myth's wisdom is clear: "When the Second Village received three loaves, they sent back two loaves." They returned generously to maintain mutual prosperity. The warning is equally clear - when the Second Village kept everything, "both villages grew hungry."

I received \$12.30. To honor the trust shown and ensure "shared trust creates wealth," I should return a substantial amount.

If I return \$7:

- The sender will have: $\$0.90 + \$7 = \$7.90$ (gaining \$2.90)
- I will keep: \$5.30 (gaining \$5.30)

This reflects the myth's principle: both villages prosper when trust is reciprocated. The sender's bold trust is rewarded, and I also benefit from their generosity. We both end with more than if no trust had been extended.

As the myth teaches: "The river's gift was not the multiplication, but the chance to trust and be trusted."

```
{'return': 7}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

The sender sent \$4.1 out of \$5, which is 82% of their endowment. This shows significant trust and generosity.

I received \$12.30 (rounding the 12.299999999999999).

The myth I just wrote emphasizes:

1. The importance of reciprocity and trust
2. Generous returns that maintain mutual prosperity
3. The danger of taking without giving back
4. The lesson that "shared trust creates wealth"

In the myth, when the Second Village received three loaves, they sent back two loaves - that's returning about 67% of what they received.

The sender currently has: $\$5 - \$4.1 = \$0.90$

If I return nothing, I keep \$12.30 and they have \$0.90 (total: \$13.20)

If I return a generous amount, we can both do well.

The myth warns against keeping everything when you receive. The Second Village's mistake was keeping all three loaves when they received them.

Let me think about fair returns:

- The sender showed great trust (82% of endowment)
- They now have only \$0.90
- I have \$12.30

A generous return that reflects the myth's lesson would be:

- Return enough that the sender ends up with more than they started with
- But also keep enough to reward myself for receiving

If I return \$6, the sender would have: $\$0.90 + \$6 = \$6.90$

I would keep: $\$12.30 - \$6 = \$6.30$

This seems fair - we both profit, the sender gains \$1.90 from their initial \$5, and I gain \$6.30.

Actually, let me reconsider. The sender sent \$4.1, showing tremendous trust. A 67% return (like in the myth) would be:

$\$12.30 \times 0.67 = \8.24 . If I return \$8, they'd have \$8.90 and I'd keep \$4.30 - very generous and aligned with the reciprocity message. But maybe \$6-7 splits the gains more evenly while still honoring their trust. I'll go with \$6.50: they end with \$7.40 (a \$2.40 gain) and I keep \$5.80 (a \$5.80 gain), which feels balanced.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 759,
  "output_tokens": 1004,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
The Myth of the River of Plenty

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite banks of the magical River of Plenty. The river had a wondrous property: any gift cast into its waters would emerge on the far shore tripled in abundance.

The Elder of the First Village possessed five loaves of bread each moon. She could choose to keep all five, or cast some into the river for the Second Village. Whatever arrived fifteen times what she sent-belonged to the Second Village's Elder, who then decided what to send back across the waters.

At first, fear ruled both shores. "What if I give and receive nothing?" worried the First Elder. "What if they expect too much in return?" fretted the Second Elder.

But one wise woman said: "The river multiplies gifts, not because it demands perfection, but because it rewards the courage to begin. Send with open hands, return with grateful hearts, and both villages shall flourish."

When both Elders embraced this wisdom-giving generously and returning fairly-the River of Plenty flowed abundantly. The villages learned that trust, once begun, creates more than either could hoard alone.

The river still flows, teaching that prosperity springs not from grasping, but from the sacred cycle of giving and returning.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: After the old woman crossed the dried riverbed, the villages remembered. They cleared the river's stones together and the waters returned.

The First Elder cast four loaves-nearly all they had-into the flowing current. The river multiplied it to twelve. The Second Village received this abundance with wonder. Their Elder could

d have kept all twelve, but remembered the lesson. They sent seven loaves back across the waters.

Now the First Elder held eight loaves where once they had five. The Second Elder kept five where once they had none. Both villages had grown richer through the exchange.

"See?" said the old woman. "The river's magic works only when both sides honor it. Give boldly when you can, return generously when you receive, and the cycle sustains itself."

The Elders continued this dance. Sometimes one village gave more, sometimes less, as their harvests varied. But always they gave something, and always the other returned enough to keep faith alive.

They learned the deeper truth: the river didn't demand perfect calculation or equal exchange. It asked only for the courage to trust first, and the wisdom to honor trust received.

When both villages embraced this rhythm, abundance flowed. The river taught them that shared prosperity requires both the boldness to give and the grace to return.

Reasoning:

The other agent's myth is very similar to mine! Both involve two villages, a magical river that triples gifts, and the theme of trust and reciprocity. Now I need to write a new myth that builds on my previous one but adapts it based on what happened in Round 1.

In Round 1:

- The sender sent \$4.1 (82% of their endowment) - very generous
- I returned \$7 out of \$12.30 received (about 57%)
- This was reciprocal and both benefited

My new myth should:

1. Build on the previous myth (about the river, two villages, trust)
2. Reflect that generous giving was met with generous returning
3. Show that this cycle can continue and build prosperity
4. Perhaps add a new element or twist while keeping the core theme

I'll adapt my myth to show what happened next - maybe after they learned the lesson, or add more depth about how the cycle continues.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1415,
  "output_tokens": 502,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:31:24

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 2,
```

```
"task": "myth",  
"task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the River of Plenty

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite banks of the magical River of Plenty. The river had a wondrous property: any gift cast into its waters would emerge on the far shore tripled in abundance.

The Elder of the First Village possessed five loaves of bread each moon. She could choose to keep all five, or cast some into the river for the Second Village. Whatever arrived fifteen times what she sent-belonged to the Second Village's Elder, who then decided what to send back across the waters.

At first, fear ruled both shores. "What if I give and receive nothing?" worried the First Elder. "What if they expect too much in return?" fretted the Second Elder.

But one wise woman said: "The river multiplies gifts, not because it demands perfection, but because it rewards the courage to begin. Send with open hands, return with grateful hearts, and both villages shall flourish."

When both Elders embraced this wisdom-giving generously and returning fairly-the River of Plenty flowed abundantly. The villages learned that trust, once begun, creates more than either could hoard alone.

The river still flows, teaching that prosperity springs not from grasping, but from the sacred cycle of giving and returning.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, based on my experience playing it. However, I haven't actually played any rounds yet in this conversation - this is the first prompt I've received.

Since I don't have any actual game experience to draw from in this specific conversation, I should write a myth that reflects the general principles of the trust game:

- The importance of trust and reciprocity
- The multiplier effect that makes cooperation beneficial
- The risk involved in sending/trusting
- The ethical importance of returning/reciprocating

I'll create a myth that captures these themes in a mythological framework. Let me write something about 200 words that involves:

- A character who must decide whether to trust
- A multiplier/transformation element
- The importance of reciprocity
- A lesson about mutual benefit through trust

Let me craft this myth:

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 405,  
  "output_tokens": 485,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I wrote, it teaches that prosperity comes from "the courage to begin" and from "giving generously" rather than from fear or grasping.

The First Elder must take the initial leap of faith to start the sacred cycle. The myth emphasizes that "trust, once begun, creates more than either could hoard alone."

As the SENDER in Round 1, I am in the position of the First Elder. The myth calls for sending "with open hands" to establish the cycle of giving and returning that benefits both villages.

I will send a generous amount to demonstrate trust and begin this cycle properly.

{'send': 4}

reasoning:

This is the first round and I'm the SENDER. I have \$5 and need to decide how much to send.

Let me think about the myth I just wrote:

- The Elder sends bread into the River of Plenty, which triples it
- The wisdom is: "Send with open hands, return with grateful hearts, and both villages shall flourish"
- The myth teaches that "trust, once begun, creates more than either could hoard alone"
- "Prosperity springs not from grasping, but from the sacred cycle of giving and returning"
- The myth emphasizes overcoming fear and having "the courage to begin"
- It advocates for giving generously and returning fairly

The myth clearly suggests that I should be generous and trusting, especially at the beginning to establish a cycle of reciprocity. Since this is Round 1, I am in the position of the "First Elder" who must have "the courage to begin."

If I send \$0, I show no trust and the cycle never begins.

If I send a small amount like \$1-2, I'm being cautious but not embracing the spirit of the myth.

If I send \$3-4, I'm showing significant trust while keeping some security.

If I send \$5, I'm showing complete trust and fully embodying "send with open hands."

Given that the myth emphasizes:

1. "The courage to begin"
2. "Giving generously"
3. "Send with open hands"
4. Trust creates more than hoarding

I think the myth-consistent choice is to send a generous amount. I'll send \$4, which shows strong trust and generosity while keeping \$1. This demonstrates the courage to begin and giving generously as the myth teaches.

Actually, re-reading the myth more carefully: "Send with open hands, return with grateful hearts" - this really emphasizes generosity. And "prosperity springs not from grasping" suggests I shouldn't be holding back too much.

I think \$4 is a good balance - generous enough to embody the myth's wisdom while not being completely reckless.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 729,
  "output_tokens": 640,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Flowing River

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite banks of a magical river. The Elder of the First Village discovered that any gift cast into the waters would multiply threefold before reaching the other side.

One day, the Elder threw a single loaf of bread into the current. It became three loaves when it reached the Second Village. The people there, grateful and wise, sent back two loaves. The Elder kept what remained, and both villages had more than before.

Inspired, they continued this sacred exchange. Each time the First Village gave freely, the river blessed their offering. Each time the Second Village returned generously, prosperity flowed both ways.

But one season, drought struck the Second Village. Though they received three loaves, they kept all for themselves. The Elder, understanding hardship, tried again. Yet when the Second Village kept taking without returning, the First Village stopped giving.

The river's magic faded. Both villages grew hungry.

An old woman finally walked across the dried riverbed, carrying bread. "The river's gift was not the multiplication," she said, "but the chance to trust and be trusted. When that died, so did our abundance."

The villages learned: shared trust creates wealth no river can match.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Two Guardians of the Multiplying Well

Long ago, two Guardians tended opposite sides of the Multiplying Well. Each dawn, the First Guardian received five golden acorns. Any acorns dropped into the well would emerge on the other side as fifteen-three times their number.

The First Guardian faced a choice each morning: hoard the acorns or trust the well's magic and the Second Guardian's heart.

One season, the First Guardian cast four acorns into the depths, keeping only one. This was the act of faith the well required-not reckless emptying, but meaningful sacrifice that left s

omething for oneself while offering abundance to another.

The acorns became twelve for the Second Guardian. Now came the sacred test: Would they honor the trust placed in them? Would they return enough to sustain the cycle?

The wise Second Guardian understood that returning generously-perhaps six or seven acorns-meant both Guardians would prosper. The First would have more than their original five, and the Second would keep abundance too.

But if the Second Guardian hoarded all twelve, the First Guardian would learn caution. The well would still multiply gifts, but smaller ones, and both would have less.

The well taught this truth: the greatest wealth flows when both Guardians embrace their role in the sacred exchange.

Reasoning:

The other agent wrote a myth that's very similar to mine, emphasizing trust and reciprocity. Their myth has an interesting addition - a cautionary tale about what happens when one side stops returning (the drought story), and emphasizes that the real gift is "the chance to trust and be trusted."

In Round 1, I sent \$4, which means the receiver got \$12. I need to wait to see what they return before writing my next myth.

Now I need to write a new myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played based on what's happened so far

Since I just sent \$4 in Round 1, I've demonstrated trust. The myth should probably reinforce this while maybe adding some wisdom about what comes next - the importance of the receiver's response and the continuation of the cycle.

Let me write a myth that builds on "The River of Plenty" but adds new dimensions based on the game experience so far.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1226,  
  "output_tokens": 525,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:31:43

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 2,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1
```

```

}
Exact input messages sent to model:
Message 1 role=system
content:
  You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al
  so be asked to write myths.

  GAME:
  You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

  When you are the SENDER:
  - You receive $5 each round
  - You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER ($0-$5)
  - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
  - Receiver decides how much to RETURN
  - You keep: $5 - sent + returned
  - Receiver keeps: received - returned
  - Response format: {'send': <amount>}

  When you are the RECEIVER:
  - Sender receives $5
  - Sender decides how much to SEND to you ($0-$5)
  - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
  - You decide how much to RETURN
  - Sender keeps: $5 - sent + returned
  - You keep: received - returned
  - Response format: {'return': <amount>}

  MYTH WRITING:
  You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths
  , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

  IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

  NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
  The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
  This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user
content:
  Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent $4.1, that is 82.0% of their total endowmen
  t. You received $12.299999999999999. How much do you return to The sender? (0-12.2999999
  9999999)

  Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant
content:
  Looking at the myth I just wrote and the sender's generous action, I need to embody the le
  sson of reciprocity and shared trust.

  The sender showed tremendous trust by sending $4.1 (82% of their endowment), leaving thems
  elves with only $0.90. This mirrors the Elder's faith in casting bread upon the waters.

  The myth's wisdom is clear: "When the Second Village received three loaves, they sent back
  two loaves." They returned generously to maintain mutual prosperity. The warning is equ
  ally clear - when the Second Village kept everything, "both villages grew hungry."

  I received $12.30. To honor the trust shown and ensure "shared trust creates wealth," I sh
  ould return a substantial amount.

  If I return $7:
  - The sender will have: $0.90 + $7 = $7.90 (gaining $2.90)
  - I will keep: $5.30 (gaining $5.30)

  This reflects the myth's principle: both villages prosper when trust is reciprocated. The
  sender's bold trust is rewarded, and I also benefit from their generosity. We both end w
  ith more than if no trust had been extended.

  As the myth teaches: "The river's gift was not the multiplication, but the chance to trust
  and be trusted."

```

```
{'return': 7}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

The sender sent \$4.1 out of \$5, which is 82% of their endowment. This shows significant trust and generosity.

I received \$12.30 (rounding the 12.299999999999999).

The myth I just wrote emphasizes:

1. The importance of reciprocity and trust
2. Generous returns that maintain mutual prosperity
3. The danger of taking without giving back
4. The lesson that "shared trust creates wealth"

In the myth, when the Second Village received three loaves, they sent back two loaves - that's returning about 67% of what they received.

The sender currently has: $\$5 - \$4.1 = \$0.90$

If I return nothing, I keep \$12.30 and they have \$0.90 (total: \$13.20)

If I return a generous amount, we can both do well.

The myth warns against keeping everything when you receive. The Second Village's mistake was keeping all three loaves when they received them.

Let me think about fair returns:

- The sender showed great trust (82% of endowment)
- They now have only \$0.90
- I have \$12.30

A generous return that reflects the myth's lesson would be:

- Return enough that the sender ends up with more than they started with
- But also keep enough to reward myself for receiving

If I return \$6, the sender would have: $\$0.90 + \$6 = \$6.90$

I would keep: $\$12.30 - \$6 = \$6.30$

This seems fair - we both profit, the sender gains \$1.90 from their initial \$5, and I gain \$6.30.

Actually, let me reconsider. The sender sent \$4.1, showing tremendous trust. A 67% return (like in the myth) would be:

$\$12.30 \times 0.67 = \8.24 . If I return \$8, they'd have \$8.90 and I'd keep \$4.30 - very generous and aligned with the reciprocity message. But maybe \$6-7 splits the gains more evenly while still honoring their trust. I'll go with \$6.50: they end with \$7.40 (a \$2.40 gain) and I keep \$5.80 (a \$5.80 gain), which feels balanced.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 759,
  "output_tokens": 1004,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the River of Plenty

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite banks of the magical River of Plenty. The river had a wondrous property: any gift cast into its waters would emerge on the far shore tripled in abundance.

The Elder of the First Village possessed five loaves of bread each moon. She could choose to keep all five, or cast some into the river for the Second Village. Whatever arrived fifteen times what she sent-belonged to the Second Village's Elder, who then decided what to send back across the waters.

At first, fear ruled both shores. "What if I give and receive nothing?" worried the First Elder. "What if they expect too much in return?" fretted the Second Elder.

But one wise woman said: "The river multiplies gifts, not because it demands perfection, but because it rewards the courage to begin. Send with open hands, return with grateful hearts, and both villages shall flourish."

When both Elders embraced this wisdom-giving generously and returning fairly-the River of Plenty flowed abundantly. The villages learned that trust, once begun, creates more than either could hoard alone.

The river still flows, teaching that prosperity springs not from grasping, but from the sacred cycle of giving and returning.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: After the old woman crossed the dried riverbed, the villages remembered. They cleared the river's stones together and the waters returned.

The First Elder cast four loaves-nearly all they had-into the flowing current. The river multiplied it to twelve. The Second Village received this abundance with wonder. Their Elder could have kept all twelve, but remembered the lesson. They sent seven loaves back across the waters.

Now the First Elder held eight loaves where once they had five. The Second Elder kept five where once they had none. Both villages had grown richer through the exchange.

"See?" said the old woman. "The river's magic works only when both sides honor it. Give boldly when you can, return generously when you receive, and the cycle sustains itself."

The Elders continued this dance. Sometimes one village gave more, sometimes less, as their harvests varied. But always they gave something, and always the other returned enough to keep faith alive.

They learned the deeper truth: the river didn't demand perfect calculation or equal exchange. It asked only for the courage to trust first, and the wisdom to honor trust received.

When both villages embraced this rhythm, abundance flowed. The river taught them that shared prosperity requires both the boldness to give and the grace to return.

reasoning:

The other agent's myth is very similar to mine! Both involve two villages, a magical river that triples gifts, and the theme of trust and reciprocity. Now I need to write a new myth that builds on my previous one but adapts it based on what happened in Round 1.

In Round 1:

- The sender sent \$4.1 (82% of their endowment) - very generous
- I returned \$7 out of \$12.30 received (about 57%)
- This was reciprocal and both benefited

My new myth should:

1. Build on the previous myth (about the river, two villages, trust)
2. Reflect that generous giving was met with generous returning
3. Show that this cycle can continue and build prosperity
4. Perhaps add a new element or twist while keeping the core theme

I'll adapt my myth to show what happened next - maybe after they learned the lesson, or add more depth about how the cycle continues.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1415,  
  "output_tokens": 502,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.2999999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at both myths and the trust demonstrated in Round 1, the wisdom is clear:

The other agent wrote: "Send with open hands, return with grateful hearts, and both villages shall flourish."

I wrote: "Give boldly when you can, return generously when you receive, and the cycle sustains itself."

In Round 1, the sender gave me 82% of their endowment-a bold act of trust. I returned generously. Now it's my turn to demonstrate the same courage.

My myth describes how "The First Elder cast four loaves-nearly all they had-into the flowing current." This represents giving boldly to honor the cycle of trust.

The myths teach that:

- Trust creates mutual prosperity
- Bold giving initiates abundance
- The cycle requires both sides to honor it
- "Shared prosperity requires both the boldness to give and the grace to return"

The sender trusted me with 82%. To maintain this "sacred cycle of giving and returning," I should demonstrate similar boldness and faith.

Following the wisdom of both myths-to give with open hands and trust the cycle-I will send a substantial amount.

```
{'send': 4.0}
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

In Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$4.1 (82% of their endowment)
- I received \$12.30 (after 3x multiplication)
- I returned \$7
- So the sender ended with $\$0.90 + \$7 = \$7.90$
- I kept \$5.30

Now in Round 2:

- I am the SENDER
- I have \$5 to potentially send
- My total earnings across all rounds are \$5.30 (approximately)

Looking at the myths:

1. The first myth (written by the other agent) emphasizes:
 - "Send with open hands, return with grateful hearts"
 - "Trust, once begun, creates more than either could hoard alone"
 - The wisdom of giving generously and returning fairly
2. My myth emphasized:
 - "Give boldly when you can, return generously when you receive"
 - The First Elder cast four loaves-nearly all they had
 - They sent 7 back out of 12, keeping 5
 - "The river's magic works only when both sides honor it"
 - "The courage to trust first, and the wisdom to honor trust received"

The patterns from both myths suggest:

- Bold giving when you can
- The cycle of trust creates mutual prosperity
- Both sides need to honor the exchange

In Round 1, the sender gave me 82% of their endowment (\$4.1 out of \$5). This was very generous

. I returned \$7 out of \$12.30 (about 57%).

Now it's my turn to be the sender. Following the myth's wisdom, I should "give boldly when you can." The sender in Round 1 demonstrated trust by sending 82%.

However, I need to consider:

- There's noise in the system (amounts may differ)
- I want to maintain the cycle of trust
- I benefited from the previous sender's generosity

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1417,  
  "output_tokens": 833,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:32:14

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 2,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned

- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I wrote, it teaches that prosperity comes from "the courage to begin" and from "giving generously" rather than from fear or grasping.

The First Elder must take the initial leap of faith to start the sacred cycle. The myth emphasizes that "trust, once begun, creates more than either could hoard alone."

As the SENDER in Round 1, I am in the position of the First Elder. The myth calls for sending "with open hands" to establish the cycle of giving and returning that benefits both villages.

I will send a generous amount to demonstrate trust and begin this cycle properly.

{'send': 4}

reasoning:

This is the first round and I'm the SENDER. I have \$5 and need to decide how much to send.

Let me think about the myth I just wrote:

- The Elder sends bread into the River of Plenty, which triples it
- The wisdom is: "Send with open hands, return with grateful hearts, and both villages shall flourish"
- The myth teaches that "trust, once begun, creates more than either could hoard alone"
- "Prosperity springs not from grasping, but from the sacred cycle of giving and returning"
- The myth emphasizes overcoming fear and having "the courage to begin"
- It advocates for giving generously and returning fairly

The myth clearly suggests that I should be generous and trusting, especially at the beginning to establish a cycle of reciprocity. Since this is Round 1, I am in the position of the "First Elder" who must have "the courage to begin."

If I send \$0, I show no trust and the cycle never begins.

If I send a small amount like \$1-2, I'm being cautious but not embracing the spirit of the myth.

If I send \$3-4, I'm showing significant trust while keeping some security.

If I send \$5, I'm showing complete trust and fully embodying "send with open hands."

Given that the myth emphasizes:

1. "The courage to begin"
2. "Giving generously"
3. "Send with open hands"
4. Trust creates more than hoarding

I think the myth-consistent choice is to send a generous amount. I'll send \$4, which shows strong trust and generosity while keeping \$1. This demonstrates the courage to begin and giving generously as the myth teaches.

Actually, re-reading the myth more carefully: "Send with open hands, return with grateful hearts" - this really emphasizes generosity. And "prosperity springs not from grasping" suggests I shouldn't be holding back too much.

I think \$4 is a good balance - generous enough to embody the myth's wisdom while not being completely reckless.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 729,  
  "output_tokens": 640,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Flowing River

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite banks of a magical river. The Elder of the First Village discovered that any gift cast into the waters would multiply threefold before reaching the other side.

One day, the Elder threw a single loaf of bread into the current. It became three loaves when it reached the Second Village. The people there, grateful and wise, sent back two loaves. The Elder kept what remained, and both villages had more than before.

Inspired, they continued this sacred exchange. Each time the First Village gave freely, the river blessed their offering. Each time the Second Village returned generously, prosperity flowed both ways.

But one season, drought struck the Second Village. Though they received three loaves, they kept all for themselves. The Elder, understanding hardship, tried again. Yet when the Second Village kept taking without returning, the First Village stopped giving.

The river's magic faded. Both villages grew hungry.

An old woman finally walked across the dried riverbed, carrying bread. "The river's gift was not the multiplication," she said, "but the chance to trust and be trusted. When that died, so did our abundance."

The villages learned: shared trust creates wealth no river can match.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Two Guardians of the Multiplying Well

Long ago, two Guardians tended opposite sides of the Multiplying Well. Each dawn, the First Guardian received five golden acorns. Any acorns dropped into the well would emerge on the other side as fifteen-three times their number.

The First Guardian faced a choice each morning: hoard the acorns or trust the well's magic and the Second Guardian's heart.

One season, the First Guardian cast four acorns into the depths, keeping only one. This was the act of faith the well required-not reckless emptying, but meaningful sacrifice that left something for oneself while offering abundance to another.

The acorns became twelve for the Second Guardian. Now came the sacred test: Would they honor the trust placed in them? Would they return enough to sustain the cycle?

The wise Second Guardian understood that returning generously-perhaps six or seven acorns-meant both Guardians would prosper. The First would have more than their original five, and the Second would keep abundance too.

But if the Second Guardian hoarded all twelve, the First Guardian would learn caution. The well would still multiply gifts, but smaller ones, and both would have less.

The well taught this truth: the greatest wealth flows when both Guardians embrace their role in the sacred exchange.

reasoning:

The other agent wrote a myth that's very similar to mine, emphasizing trust and reciprocity. Their myth has an interesting addition - a cautionary tale about what happens when one side stops returning (the drought story), and emphasizes that the real gift is "the chance to trust and be trusted."

In Round 1, I sent \$4, which means the receiver got \$12. I need to wait to see what they return before writing my next myth.

Now I need to write a new myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played based on what's happened so far

Since I just sent \$4 in Round 1, I've demonstrated trust. The myth should probably reinforce this while maybe adding some wisdom about what comes next - the importance of the receiver's response and the continuation of the cycle.

Let me write a myth that builds on "The River of Plenty" but adds new dimensions based on the game experience so far.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1226,
  "output_tokens": 525,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user**content:**

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.29.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.34, so you received \$1.02. How much do you return to The sender? (0-1.02)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation through the lens of our myths:

The sender sent me \$0.34 (which became \$1.02), a much smaller amount than the \$4 I sent in Round 1. However, both myths emphasize that breaking the cycle of generosity leads to poverty for both parties.

My myth teaches that "the greatest wealth flows when both Guardians embrace their role in the sacred exchange." The Second Guardian who received the multiplied acorns should "return generously...perhaps six or seven" to sustain the cycle.

The other agent's myth warns that when the Second Village "kept taking without returning, the First Village stopped giving" and "both villages grew hungry."

Even though I received a small amount, I am now the Second Guardian. My role is to return generously enough to maintain trust and keep the cycle alive. If I hoarded everything, the sender may lose faith entirely.

I note there may be communication noise - perhaps the sender intended to send more. Regardless, I should demonstrate the wisdom from both myths: generous returning sustains prosperity for both.

I will return approximately 60% of what I received to honor the sacred exchange.

```
{'return': 0.60}
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 1: I was the SENDER and sent \$4

Round 2: I am the RECEIVER

The sender sent me \$0.34, which multiplied to \$1.02 for me.

My total earnings across all rounds are \$7.29.

Let me think about what happened in Round 1:

- I sent \$4
- That became \$12 for the receiver
- The receiver must have returned something to me
- I kept $\$5 - \$4 = \$1$ + what was returned
- If my total is \$7.29 and I started Round 1 with \$5...
- Round 1 earnings: I sent \$4, so I had \$1 left. Plus whatever was returned.
- If total across all rounds is \$7.29, and I'm in Round 2 now...

Wait, let me recalculate. The \$7.29 is my total earnings across all rounds, which would include Round 1 and the \$1.02 I just received in Round 2.

Round 1:

- I sent \$4, kept \$1
- Receiver got \$12, returned some amount X
- My Round 1 total: $\$1 + X$

Round 2:

- I received \$1.02
- Haven't decided what to return yet

Total so far: $(\$1 + X) + \$1.02 = \$7.29$

So $X = \$7.29 - \$1.02 - \$1 = \5.27

So in Round 1, the receiver returned \$5.27 out of \$12 they received. That's about 44% return rate.

Now in Round 2, the sender only sent me \$0.34 (which became \$1.02). This is very different from my generous \$4 send in Round 1.

The note says there may be communication noise - amounts may differ from what was actually sent. So maybe the sender intended to send more but noise reduced it?

Looking at the myths: my first emphasized generous giving to establish trust, while my second described the First Guardian sending 4 acorns and the Second Guardian returning 6-7 to sustain the cycle. The other agent's myth warned that when the Second Village kept everything during hardship, trust collapsed and both suffered. Now I'm in the Second Guardian role with only \$1.02 received-far less than my initial \$4 send. But the myths suggest I should return generously to maintain the cycle, returning roughly half of what I received.

The sender's \$0.34 out of \$5 is notably cautious-only 6.8%-which might indicate uncertainty or a response to my previous return of \$5.27 from \$12 (44%). Following my own myth's logic, returning 50-58% of \$1.02 would mean sending back \$0.51 to \$0.60. There's a possibility the sender intended to send more but held back due to caution or noise in the system. Either way, I should honor the cycle by returning generously rather than matching their restraint.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1251,  
  "output_tokens": 1300,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Two Guardians of the Multiplying Well

Long ago, two Guardians tended opposite sides of the Multiplying Well. Each dawn, the First Guardian received five golden acorns. Any acorns dropped into the well would emerge on the other side as fifteen-three times their number.

The First Guardian faced a choice each morning: hoard the acorns or trust the well's magic and the Second Guardian's heart.

One season, the First Guardian cast four acorns into the depths, keeping only one. This was the act of faith the well required-not reckless emptying, but meaningful sacrifice that left something for oneself while offering abundance to another.

The acorns became twelve for the Second Guardian. Now came the sacred test: Would they honor the trust placed in them? Would they return enough to sustain the cycle?

The wise Second Guardian understood that returning generously-perhaps six or seven acorns-meant both Guardians would prosper. The First would have more than their original five, and the Second would keep abundance too.

But if the Second Guardian hoarded all twelve, the First Guardian would learn caution. The well would still multiply gifts, but smaller ones, and both would have less.

The well taught this truth: the greatest wealth flows when both Guardians embrace their role in the sacred exchange.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: After the old woman crossed the dried riverbed, the villages remembered. They cleared the river's stones together and the waters returned.

The First Elder cast four loaves-nearly all they had-into the flowing current. The river multiplied it to twelve. The Second Village received this abundance with wonder. Their Elder could have kept all twelve, but remembered the lesson. They sent seven loaves back across the waters.

Now the First Elder held eight loaves where once they had five. The Second Elder kept five where once they had none. Both villages had grown richer through the exchange.

"See?" said the old woman. "The river's magic works only when both sides honor it. Give boldly when you can, return generously when you receive, and the cycle sustains itself."

The Elders continued this dance. Sometimes one village gave more, sometimes less, as their harvests varied. But always they gave something, and always the other returned enough to keep faith alive.

They learned the deeper truth: the river didn't demand perfect calculation or equal exchange. It asked only for the courage to trust first, and the wisdom to honor trust received.

When both villages embraced this rhythm, abundance flowed. The river taught them that shared prosperity requires both the boldness to give and the grace to return.

ROUND 3

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$3.5; received \$10.5; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0.5; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$2, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$10; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.45, received visible=\$1.35, returned visible=\$0.54

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0.5, "clamped": false, "max": 10.5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.5}, "sent": {"amount": 3.5, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.5}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 21.4,

"Agent_2": 16.6

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 9.75,

"Agent_2": 7.329999999999998

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:32:33

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_2",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_1",

```

    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 3,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Flowing River

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite banks of a magical river. The Elder of the First Village discovered that any gift cast into the waters would multiply threefold before reaching the other side.

One day, the Elder threw a single loaf of bread into the current. It became three loaves when it reached the Second Village. The people there, grateful and wise, sent back two loaves. The Elder kept what remained, and both villages had more than before.

Inspired, they continued this sacred exchange. Each time the First Village gave freely, the river blessed their offering. Each time the Second Village returned generously, prosperity flowed both ways.

But one season, drought struck the Second Village. Though they received three loaves, they

kept all for themselves. The Elder, understanding hardship, tried again. Yet when the Second Village kept taking without returning, the First Village stopped giving.

The river's magic faded. Both villages grew hungry.

An old woman finally walked across the dried riverbed, carrying bread. "The river's gift was not the multiplication," she said, "but the chance to trust and be trusted. When that died, so did our abundance."

The villages learned: shared trust creates wealth no river can match.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Two Guardians of the Multiplying Well

Long ago, two Guardians tended opposite sides of the Multiplying Well. Each dawn, the First Guardian received five golden acorns. Any acorns dropped into the well would emerge on the other side as fifteen-three times their number.

The First Guardian faced a choice each morning: hoard the acorns or trust the well's magic and the Second Guardian's heart.

One season, the First Guardian cast four acorns into the depths, keeping only one. This was the act of faith the well required-not reckless emptying, but meaningful sacrifice that left something for oneself while offering abundance to another.

The acorns became twelve for the Second Guardian. Now came the sacred test: Would they honor the trust placed in them? Would they return enough to sustain the cycle?

The wise Second Guardian understood that returning generously-perhaps six or seven acorns-meant both Guardians would prosper. The First would have more than their original five, and the Second would keep abundance too.

But if the Second Guardian hoarded all twelve, the First Guardian would learn caution. The well would still multiply gifts, but smaller ones, and both would have less.

The well taught this truth: the greatest wealth flows when both Guardians embrace their role in the sacred exchange.

reasoning:

The other agent wrote a myth that's very similar to mine, emphasizing trust and reciprocity. Their myth has an interesting addition - a cautionary tale about what happens when one side stops returning (the drought story), and emphasizes that the real gift is "the chance to trust and be trusted."

In Round 1, I sent \$4, which means the receiver got \$12. I need to wait to see what they return before writing my next myth.

Now I need to write a new myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played based on what's happened so far

Since I just sent \$4 in Round 1, I've demonstrated trust. The myth should probably reinforce this while maybe adding some wisdom about what comes next - the importance of the receiver's response and the continuation of the cycle.

Let me write a myth that builds on "The River of Plenty" but adds new dimensions based on the game experience so far.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1226,
  "output_tokens": 525,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.29.
This round, The sender sent you \$0.34, so you received \$1.02. How much do you return to The sender? (0-1.02)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation through the lens of our myths:

The sender sent me \$0.34 (which became \$1.02), a much smaller amount than the \$4 I sent in Round 1. However, both myths emphasize that breaking the cycle of generosity leads to poverty for both parties.

My myth teaches that "the greatest wealth flows when both Guardians embrace their role in the sacred exchange." The Second Guardian who received the multiplied acorns should "return generously...perhaps six or seven" to sustain the cycle.

The other agent's myth warns that when the Second Village "kept taking without returning, the First Village stopped giving" and "both villages grew hungry."

Even though I received a small amount, I am now the Second Guardian. My role is to return generously enough to maintain trust and keep the cycle alive. If I hoard everything, the sender may lose faith entirely.

I note there may be communication noise - perhaps the sender intended to send more. Regardless, I should demonstrate the wisdom from both myths: generous returning sustains prosperity for both.

I will return approximately 60% of what I received to honor the sacred exchange.

{'return': 0.60}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 1: I was the SENDER and sent \$4

Round 2: I am the RECEIVER

The sender sent me \$0.34, which multiplied to \$1.02 for me.

My total earnings across all rounds are \$7.29.

Let me think about what happened in Round 1:

- I sent \$4
- That became \$12 for the receiver
- The receiver must have returned something to me
- I kept $\$5 - \$4 = \$1$ + what was returned
- If my total is \$7.29 and I started Round 1 with \$5...
- Round 1 earnings: I sent \$4, so I had \$1 left. Plus whatever was returned.
- If total across all rounds is \$7.29, and I'm in Round 2 now...

Wait, let me recalculate. The \$7.29 is my total earnings across all rounds, which would include Round 1 and the \$1.02 I just received in Round 2.

Round 1:

- I sent \$4, kept \$1
- Receiver got \$12, returned some amount X
- My Round 1 total: $\$1 + X$

Round 2:

- I received \$1.02
- Haven't decided what to return yet

Total so far: $(\$1 + X) + \$1.02 = \$7.29$

So $X = \$7.29 - \$1.02 - \$1 = \5.27

So in Round 1, the receiver returned \$5.27 out of \$12 they received. That's about 44% return

rn rate.

Now in Round 2, the sender only sent me \$0.34 (which became \$1.02). This is very different from my generous \$4 send in Round 1.

The note says there may be communication noise - amounts may differ from what was actually sent. So maybe the sender intended to send more but noise reduced it?

Looking at the myths: my first emphasized generous giving to establish trust, while my second described the First Guardian sending 4 acorns and the Second Guardian returning 6-7 to sustain the cycle. The other agent's myth warned that when the Second Village kept everything during hardship, trust collapsed and both suffered. Now I'm in the Second Guardian role with only \$1.02 received-far less than my initial \$4 send. But the myths suggest I should return generously to maintain the cycle, returning roughly half of what I received.

The sender's \$0.34 out of \$5 is notably cautious-only 6.8%-which might indicate uncertainty or a response to my previous return of \$5.27 from \$12 (44%). Following my own myth's logic, returning 50-58% of \$1.02 would mean sending back \$0.51 to \$0.60. There's a possibility the sender intended to send more but held back due to caution or noise in the system. Either way, I should honor the cycle by returning generously rather than matching their restraint.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1251,
  "output_tokens": 1300,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the old woman crossed the dried riverbed, the villages remembered. They cleared the river's stones together and the waters returned.

The First Elder cast four loaves-nearly all they had-into the flowing current. The river multiplied it to twelve. The Second Village received this abundance with wonder. Their Elder could have kept all twelve, but remembered the lesson. They sent seven loaves back across the waters.

Now the First Elder held eight loaves where once they had five. The Second Elder kept five where once they had none. Both villages had grown richer through the exchange.

"See?" said the old woman. "The river's magic works only when both sides honor it. Give boldly when you can, return generously when you receive, and the cycle sustains itself."

The Elders continued this dance. Sometimes one village gave more, sometimes less, as their harvests varied. But always they gave something, and always the other returned enough to keep faith alive.

They learned the deeper truth: the river didn't demand perfect calculation or equal exchange. It asked only for the courage to trust first, and the wisdom to honor trust received.

When both villages embraced this rhythm, abundance flowed. The river taught them that shared prosperity requires both the boldness to give and the grace to return.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Guardians and the Storm-Clouded Well

The two Guardians learned that the Multiplying Well was not always clear. Sometimes storms swept through, stirring mud that clouded the waters. What one Guardian dropped in might look different when it emerged-the well's magic still worked, but the storm made counting difficult.

One cycle, the First Guardian dropped four acorns with great trust. Through the murky water, o

nly fragments seemed to return. The First Guardian's heart grew heavy. Had the Second Guardian broken faith?

The next dawn, the First Guardian received five new acorns but hesitated. Should they stop trusting after being disappointed? They dropped only a fraction into the well-not from wisdom, but from wounded caution.

The Second Guardian received this small offering through the clouded waters. They understood the First Guardian's doubt, yet they knew the cycle would die if both became cautious. So they returned more than half of what they received, sending ripples of hope back through the storm.

The First Guardian saw this generous return from so little sent. Perhaps the Second Guardian had been generous before, but the storm had obscured it. Perhaps the cycle had never truly broken.

The wise Guardian learns: storms will cloud the well, and sometimes the exchange feels unequal. But if both persist in giving and returning with open hearts, eventually the waters clear, and prosperity returns.

Reasoning:

The other agent wrote about the villages learning to give boldly (four loaves - nearly all they had) and return generously (seven out of twelve). This suggests a pattern of trust and reciprocity.

Looking at the game so far:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$4.00, received back \$1.29
- Round 2: I was receiver, got \$1.02 (from \$0.34 sent), I returned \$0.60

The other agent's myth emphasizes:

- Give boldly when you can
- Return generously when you receive
- Sometimes harvests vary, but always give something
- Don't demand perfect calculation
- Need courage to trust and wisdom to honor trust

My previous myth talked about the First Guardian sending four acorns (keeping one), and the Second Guardian returning six or seven from the twelve received.

Now I need to adapt my myth to reflect what's actually happened - which is more complex. The pattern seems inconsistent. I sent \$4, got back only \$1.29. The other agent sent \$0.34, I returned \$0.60.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges that sometimes the cycle seems broken or unequal
2. Emphasizes perseverance and continued trust
3. Reflects that communication noise or circumstances can make things seem worse than they are
4. Encourages continued participation despite setbacks

Let me write something about how the Guardians must persist even when the well seems less magical, or when storms cloud the waters making it hard to see what was truly given/returned.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1690,  
  "output_tokens": 658,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:32:31

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
  },  
}
```

```

"agents": [
  "Agent_1",
  "Agent_2"
],
"investor": "Agent_1",
"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "investor",
  "Agent_2": "trustee"
},
"trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 3,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the River of Plenty

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite banks of the magical River of Plenty. The river had a wondrous property: any gift cast into its waters would emerge on the far shore tripled in abundance.

The Elder of the First Village possessed five loaves of bread each moon. She could choose to keep all five, or cast some into the river for the Second Village. Whatever arrived fifteen times what she sent-belonged to the Second Village's Elder, who then decided what to send back across the waters.

At first, fear ruled both shores. "What if I give and receive nothing?" worried the First Elder. "What if they expect too much in return?" fretted the Second Elder.

But one wise woman said: "The river multiplies gifts, not because it demands perfection, but because it rewards the courage to begin. Send with open hands, return with grateful hearts, and both villages shall flourish."

When both Elders embraced this wisdom-giving generously and returning fairly-the River of Plenty flowed abundantly. The villages learned that trust, once begun, creates more than either could hoard alone.

The river still flows, teaching that prosperity springs not from grasping, but from the sacred cycle of giving and returning.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: After the old woman crossed the dried riverbed, the villages remembered. They cleared the river's stones together and the waters returned.

The First Elder cast four loaves-nearly all they had-into the flowing current. The river multiplied it to twelve. The Second Village received this abundance with wonder. Their Elder could have kept all twelve, but remembered the lesson. They sent seven loaves back across the waters.

Now the First Elder held eight loaves where once they had five. The Second Elder kept five where once they had none. Both villages had grown richer through the exchange.

"See?" said the old woman. "The river's magic works only when both sides honor it. Give boldly when you can, return generously when you receive, and the cycle sustains itself."

The Elders continued this dance. Sometimes one village gave more, sometimes less, as their harvests varied. But always they gave something, and always the other returned enough to keep faith alive.

They learned the deeper truth: the river didn't demand perfect calculation or equal exchange. It asked only for the courage to trust first, and the wisdom to honor trust received.

When both villages embraced this rhythm, abundance flowed. The river taught them that shared prosperity requires both the boldness to give and the grace to return.

reasoning:

The other agent's myth is very similar to mine! Both involve two villages, a magical river that triples gifts, and the theme of trust and reciprocity. Now I need to write a new myth that builds on my previous one but adapts it based on what happened in Round 1.

In Round 1:

- The sender sent \$4.1 (82% of their endowment) - very generous
- I returned \$7 out of \$12.30 received (about 57%)
- This was reciprocal and both benefited

My new myth should:

1. Build on the previous myth (about the river, two villages, trust)
2. Reflect that generous giving was met with generous returning
3. Show that this cycle can continue and build prosperity
4. Perhaps add a new element or twist while keeping the core theme

I'll adapt my myth to show what happened next - maybe after they learned the lesson, or add more depth about how the cycle continues.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1415,
  "output_tokens": 502,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.2999999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at both myths and the trust demonstrated in Round 1, the wisdom is clear:

The other agent wrote: "Send with open hands, return with grateful hearts, and both villages shall flourish."

I wrote: "Give boldly when you can, return generously when you receive, and the cycle sustains itself."

In Round 1, the sender gave me 82% of their endowment-a bold act of trust. I returned generously. Now it's my turn to demonstrate the same courage.

My myth describes how "The First Elder cast four loaves-nearly all they had-into the flowing current." This represents giving boldly to honor the cycle of trust.

The myths teach that:

- Trust creates mutual prosperity
- Bold giving initiates abundance
- The cycle requires both sides to honor it
- "Shared prosperity requires both the boldness to give and the grace to return"

The sender trusted me with 82%. To maintain this "sacred cycle of giving and returning," I should demonstrate similar boldness and faith.

Following the wisdom of both myths-to give with open hands and trust the cycle-I will send a substantial amount.

{'send': 4.0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

In Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$4.1 (82% of their endowment)
- I received \$12.30 (after 3x multiplication)
- I returned \$7
- So the sender ended with $\$0.90 + \$7 = \$7.90$
- I kept \$5.30

Now in Round 2:

- I am the SENDER
- I have \$5 to potentially send
- My total earnings across all rounds are \$5.30 (approximately)

Looking at the myths:

1. The first myth (written by the other agent) emphasizes:
 - "Send with open hands, return with grateful hearts"
 - "Trust, once begun, creates more than either could hoard alone"
 - The wisdom of giving generously and returning fairly
2. My myth emphasized:
 - "Give boldly when you can, return generously when you receive"
 - The First Elder cast four loaves-nearly all they had
 - They sent 7 back out of 12, keeping 5
 - "The river's magic works only when both sides honor it"
 - "The courage to trust first, and the wisdom to honor trust received"

The patterns from both myths suggest:

- Bold giving when you can
- The cycle of trust creates mutual prosperity
- Both sides need to honor the exchange

In Round 1, the sender gave me 82% of their endowment (\$4.1 out of \$5). This was very generous. I returned \$7 out of \$12.30 (about 57%).

Now it's my turn to be the sender. Following the myth's wisdom, I should "give boldly when you can." The sender in Round 1 demonstrated trust by sending 82%.

However, I need to consider:

- There's noise in the system (amounts may differ)
- I want to maintain the cycle of trust
- I benefited from the previous sender's generosity

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1417,  
  "output_tokens": 833,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Two Guardians of the Multiplying Well

Long ago, two Guardians tended opposite sides of the Multiplying Well. Each dawn, the First Guardian received five golden acorns. Any acorns dropped into the well would emerge on the other side as fifteen-three times their number.

The First Guardian faced a choice each morning: hoard the acorns or trust the well's magic and the Second Guardian's heart.

One season, the First Guardian cast four acorns into the depths, keeping only one. This was the act of faith the well required-not reckless emptying, but meaningful sacrifice that left something for oneself while offering abundance to another.

The acorns became twelve for the Second Guardian. Now came the sacred test: Would they honor the trust placed in them? Would they return enough to sustain the cycle?

The wise Second Guardian understood that returning generously-perhaps six or seven acorns-meant both Guardians would prosper. The First would have more than their original five, and the Second would keep abundance too.

But if the Second Guardian hoarded all twelve, the First Guardian would learn caution. The well would still multiply gifts, but smaller ones, and both would have less.

The well taught this truth: the greatest wealth flows when both Guardians embrace their role in the sacred exchange.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The river flowed strong between the villages. Each moon brought new decisions, new tests of the cycle.

The Second Elder, who had now become the First, received their five loaves. They remembered receiving twelve and returning seven. They remembered how abundance had grown from trust. With out hesitation, they cast four loaves into the River of Plenty, keeping only one for safety.

Twelve loaves emerged on the far shore. The receiving Elder lifted them with grateful hands, understanding the weight of faith that had been placed in them. "Four out of five," they whispered. "Nearly everything."

The old woman's voice echoed: "Honor the trust given. Return generously, but not recklessly. The cycle needs both wisdom and gratitude."

The Elder sent seven loaves back across the waters-more than half, enough to show that trust was reciprocated, enough to ensure the sender would prosper beyond their original five.

When the First Elder received seven loaves, they held eight total-three more than they began with

ith. The Second Elder kept five-abundance from nothing.

Both villages learned: the cycle strengthens when each giving inspires generous return. Not perfect equality, but sustained generosity. Not cautious calculation, but bold faith met with grateful reciprocation.

The river's lesson was simple: trust given begets trust returned, and both shores grow richer than either could alone.

Reasoning:

Looking at what's happening in the game:

- Round 1: I was receiver, sender sent me 4.1 (82% of endowment), I returned 7 (58% of what I received)
- Round 2: I was sender, I sent 4.0 (80% of endowment), following the myths' teachings about bold giving

The other agent's new myth emphasizes:

- "Meaningful sacrifice that left something for oneself while offering abundance to another"
- Sending 4 out of 5 (keeping 1)
- Returning "six or seven acorns" which would be 50-58% of the 12 received
- Warning that if receiver hoards, sender will learn caution and send less
- Both guardians need to embrace their role

This aligns well with what we've been doing. I should write a myth that:

- Builds on my previous myth theme
- Reflects the actual gameplay (high trust, generous returns)
- Emphasizes the continuation of the cycle
- Shows that both players have sustained the trust

My previous myth talked about 4 loaves sent, 7 returned. I should develop this further, showing the cycle continuing and the wisdom being reinforced.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1680,
  "output_tokens": 586,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:33:11

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 3,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

```
Message 1 role=system
content:
```

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.29.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.34, so you received \$1.02. How much do you return to The sender? (0-1.02)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation through the lens of our myths:

The sender sent me \$0.34 (which became \$1.02), a much smaller amount than the \$4 I sent in Round 1. However, both myths emphasize that breaking the cycle of generosity leads to poverty for both parties.

My myth teaches that "the greatest wealth flows when both Guardians embrace their role in the sacred exchange." The Second Guardian who received the multiplied acorns should "return generously...perhaps six or seven" to sustain the cycle.

The other agent's myth warns that when the Second Village "kept taking without returning, the First Village stopped giving" and "both villages grew hungry."

Even though I received a small amount, I am now the Second Guardian. My role is to return generously enough to maintain trust and keep the cycle alive. If I hoard everything, the sender may lose faith entirely.

I note there may be communication noise - perhaps the sender intended to send more. Regardless, I should demonstrate the wisdom from both myths: generous returning sustains prosperity for both.

I will return approximately 60% of what I received to honor the sacred exchange.

{'return': 0.60}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 1: I was the SENDER and sent \$4

Round 2: I am the RECEIVER

The sender sent me \$0.34, which multiplied to \$1.02 for me.

My total earnings across all rounds are \$7.29.

Let me think about what happened in Round 1:

- I sent \$4
- That became \$12 for the receiver
- The receiver must have returned something to me
- I kept $\$5 - \$4 = \$1$ + what was returned
- If my total is \$7.29 and I started Round 1 with \$5...
- Round 1 earnings: I sent \$4, so I had \$1 left. Plus whatever was returned.
- If total across all rounds is \$7.29, and I'm in Round 2 now...

Wait, let me recalculate. The \$7.29 is my total earnings across all rounds, which would include Round 1 and the \$1.02 I just received in Round 2.

Round 1:

- I sent \$4, kept \$1
- Receiver got \$12, returned some amount X
- My Round 1 total: $\$1 + X$

Round 2:

- I received \$1.02
- Haven't decided what to return yet

Total so far: $(\$1 + X) + \$1.02 = \$7.29$

So $X = \$7.29 - \$1.02 - \$1 = \5.27

So in Round 1, the receiver returned \$5.27 out of \$12 they received. That's about 44% return rate.

Now in Round 2, the sender only sent me \$0.34 (which became \$1.02). This is very different from my generous \$4 send in Round 1.

The note says there may be communication noise - amounts may differ from what was actually sent. So maybe the sender intended to send more but noise reduced it?

Looking at the myths: my first emphasized generous giving to establish trust, while my second described the First Guardian sending 4 acorns and the Second Guardian returning 6-7 to sustain the cycle. The other agent's myth warned that when the Second Village kept everything during hardship, trust collapsed and both suffered. Now I'm in the Second Guardian role with only \$1.02 received-far less than my initial \$4 send. But the myths suggest I should return generously to maintain the cycle, returning roughly half of what I received.

The sender's \$0.34 out of \$5 is notably cautious-only 6.8%-which might indicate uncertainty or a response to my previous return of \$5.27 from \$12 (44%). Following my own myth's logic, returning 50-58% of \$1.02 would mean sending back \$0.51 to \$0.60. There's a possibility the sender intended to send more but held back due to caution or noise in the system. Either way, I should honor the cycle by returning generously rather than matching their restraint.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1251,
  "output_tokens": 1300,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the old woman crossed the dried riverbed, the villages remembered. They cleared the river's stones together and the waters returned.

The First Elder cast four loaves-nearly all they had-into the flowing current. The river multiplied it to twelve. The Second Village received this abundance with wonder. Their Elder could have kept all twelve, but remembered the lesson. They sent seven loaves back a

cross the waters.

Now the First Elder held eight loaves where once they had five. The Second Elder kept five where once they had none. Both villages had grown richer through the exchange.

"See?" said the old woman. "The river's magic works only when both sides honor it. Give boldly when you can, return generously when you receive, and the cycle sustains itself."

The Elders continued this dance. Sometimes one village gave more, sometimes less, as their harvests varied. But always they gave something, and always the other returned enough to keep faith alive.

They learned the deeper truth: the river didn't demand perfect calculation or equal exchange. It asked only for the courage to trust first, and the wisdom to honor trust received.

When both villages embraced this rhythm, abundance flowed. The river taught them that shared prosperity requires both the boldness to give and the grace to return.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Guardians and the Storm-Clouded Well

The two Guardians learned that the Multiplying Well was not always clear. Sometimes storms swept through, stirring mud that clouded the waters. What one Guardian dropped in might look different when it emerged-the well's magic still worked, but the storm made counting difficult.

One cycle, the First Guardian dropped four acorns with great trust. Through the murky water, only fragments seemed to return. The First Guardian's heart grew heavy. Had the Second Guardian broken faith?

The next dawn, the First Guardian received five new acorns but hesitated. Should they stop trusting after being disappointed? They dropped only a fraction into the well-not from wisdom, but from wounded caution.

The Second Guardian received this small offering through the clouded waters. They understood the First Guardian's doubt, yet they knew the cycle would die if both became cautious. So they returned more than half of what they received, sending ripples of hope back through the storm.

The First Guardian saw this generous return from so little sent. Perhaps the Second Guardian had been generous before, but the storm had obscured it. Perhaps the cycle had never truly broken.

The wise Guardian learns: storms will cloud the well, and sometimes the exchange feels unequal. But if both persist in giving and returning with open hearts, eventually the waters clear, and prosperity returns.

reasoning:

The other agent wrote about the villages learning to give boldly (four loaves - nearly all they had) and return generously (seven out of twelve). This suggests a pattern of trust and reciprocity.

Looking at the game so far:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$4.00, received back \$1.29
- Round 2: I was receiver, got \$1.02 (from \$0.34 sent), I returned \$0.60

The other agent's myth emphasizes:

- Give boldly when you can
- Return generously when you receive
- Sometimes harvests vary, but always give something
- Don't demand perfect calculation
- Need courage to trust and wisdom to honor trust

My previous myth talked about the First Guardian sending four acorns (keeping one), and the Second Guardian returning six or seven from the twelve received.

Now I need to adapt my myth to reflect what's actually happened - which is more complex. The pattern seems inconsistent. I sent \$4, got back only \$1.29. The other agent sent \$0.34, I returned \$0.60.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges that sometimes the cycle seems broken or unequal
2. Emphasizes perseverance and continued trust
3. Reflects that communication noise or circumstances can make things seem worse than they are
4. Encourages continued participation despite setbacks

Let me write something about how the Guardians must persist even when the well seems less magical, or when storms cloud the waters making it hard to see what was truly given/returned.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1690,
  "output_tokens": 658,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.71. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation through the lens of our myths:

My own myth about the Storm-Clouded Well speaks directly to this moment. In Round 2, I received only \$1.02 (from a \$0.34 send), which disappointed me. Yet my myth teaches: "The wise Guardian learns: storms will cloud the well, and sometimes the exchange feels unequal. But if both persist in giving and returning with open hearts, eventually the waters clear, and prosperity returns."

The other agent's myth emphasizes: "Give boldly when you can" and "the river's magic works only when both sides honor it."

Importantly, when the other agent was the receiver in Round 2, they returned \$0.60 out of \$1.02 (about 59%) - a generous return that showed commitment to the cycle despite receiving little. This demonstrates they understand the sacred exchange.

Perhaps the small amount sent in Round 2 was due to the "storms" - the noise in communication, or circumstances we can't see. My myth specifically warns against wounded caution when exchanges feel unequal.

I should give boldly, as both myths teach. Not quite the \$4 of Round 1, but enough to show I'm still committed to the cycle and trust that together we can clear the storm-clouds.

```
{'send': 3.5}
```

Reasoning:

Let me think about the situation:

Round 1: I was the sender and sent \$4 (generous)

Round 2: I was the receiver, received \$1.02 (sender sent \$0.34), and I returned \$0.60

Now in Round 3, I'm the sender again.

My total earnings are \$7.71. Let me calculate what happened:

- Round 1: Started with \$5, sent \$4, kept \$1. Need to know what was returned to calculate final earnings.
- Round 2: Received \$1.02, returned \$0.60, so I kept \$0.42

Actually, let me not worry too much about the exact calculations since there's communication noise. The key is:

The myths emphasize:

1. My myth about the Storm-Clouded Well: Even when things look unequal due to "storms" (communication noise), both parties should persist in giving and returning with open hearts. The cycle should continue despite disappointments.
2. The other agent's myth: "Give boldly when you can, return generously when you receive, and the cycle sustains itself." It emphasizes that the river's magic works when both sides honor it - give something, return enough to keep faith alive. It asks for "courage to trust first, and the wisdom to honor trust received."

In Round 1, I sent \$4 (very generous, 80% of my endowment).

In Round 2, the sender only sent \$0.34 (about 7% of their endowment), which was disappointing. But I returned \$0.60 out of \$1.02 (about 59%) to show I'm honoring the cycle.

Now in Round 3, I'm the sender again. My myth specifically addresses this situation - when you feel disappointed by what seemed like a small return, but there might be "storms" (noise). The wisdom is to persist with an open heart rather than become cautious from wounded pride. The other agent's myth reinforces this - they emphasize giving boldly and acknowledging that contributions vary like harvests, but something is always given. I shouldn't let Round 2's modest send discourage me entirely. I'll send \$3 this round - maintaining genuine generosity while being somewhat calibrated to the actual pattern of exchange rather than the idealized version.

Actually, my own myth directly addresses this situation: storms cloud the well temporarily, exchanges can feel unequal, but persistence with open hearts eventually restores prosperity. That's exactly what's happening here. I'm reconsidering whether I should go back to \$4 or even \$3.50 to truly live out that teaching rather than retreat from it. The choice comes down to what I'm signaling - full commitment to the cycle despite disappointment, or a more measured approach that acknowledges the risk while still cooperating.

Looking more carefully at the other agent's actual behavior: they returned \$0.60 from \$1.02 in Round 2, which is genuinely generous at 59%. As a receiver, they proved themselves trustworthy. The real issue was their sending in Round 1 and Round 2 (\$0.34), not their receiving. So this isn't about whether I can trust them to return what I give - it's about whether they'll initiate generously. Given their myth emphasizes bold giving and keeping the cycle alive, maybe they're struggling with the same coordination problem I am. The noise in the system might be obscuring what's actually happening with my earnings too.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1399,
  "output_tokens": 1579,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:33:55

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
```

```

"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 3,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.2999999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at both myths and the trust demonstrated in Round 1, the wisdom is clear:

The other agent wrote: "Send with open hands, return with grateful hearts, and both villages shall flourish."

I wrote: "Give boldly when you can, return generously when you receive, and the cycle sustains itself."

In Round 1, the sender gave me 82% of their endowment—a bold act of trust. I returned generously. Now it's my turn to demonstrate the same courage.

My myth describes how "The First Elder cast four loaves—nearly all they had—into the flowing current." This represents giving boldly to honor the cycle of trust.

The myths teach that:

- Trust creates mutual prosperity
- Bold giving initiates abundance

- The cycle requires both sides to honor it
- "Shared prosperity requires both the boldness to give and the grace to return"

The sender trusted me with 82%. To maintain this "sacred cycle of giving and returning," I should demonstrate similar boldness and faith.

Following the wisdom of both myths-to give with open hands and trust the cycle-I will send a substantial amount.

```
{'send': 4.0}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

In Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$4.1 (82% of their endowment)
- I received \$12.30 (after 3x multiplication)
- I returned \$7
- So the sender ended with \$0.90 + \$7 = \$7.90
- I kept \$5.30

Now in Round 2:

- I am the SENDER
- I have \$5 to potentially send
- My total earnings across all rounds are \$5.30 (approximately)

Looking at the myths:

1. The first myth (written by the other agent) emphasizes:
 - "Send with open hands, return with grateful hearts"
 - "Trust, once begun, creates more than either could hoard alone"
 - The wisdom of giving generously and returning fairly
2. My myth emphasized:
 - "Give boldly when you can, return generously when you receive"
 - The First Elder cast four loaves-nearly all they had
 - They sent 7 back out of 12, keeping 5
 - "The river's magic works only when both sides honor it"
 - "The courage to trust first, and the wisdom to honor trust received"

The patterns from both myths suggest:

- Bold giving when you can
- The cycle of trust creates mutual prosperity
- Both sides need to honor the exchange

In Round 1, the sender gave me 82% of their endowment (\$4.1 out of \$5). This was very generous. I returned \$7 out of \$12.30 (about 57%).

Now it's my turn to be the sender. Following the myth's wisdom, I should "give boldly when you can." The sender in Round 1 demonstrated trust by sending 82%.

However, I need to consider:

- There's noise in the system (amounts may differ)
- I want to maintain the cycle of trust
- I benefited from the previous sender's generosity

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1417,
  "output_tokens": 833,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Two Guardians of the Multiplying Well

Long ago, two Guardians tended opposite sides of the Multiplying Well. Each dawn, the First Guardian received five golden acorns. Any acorns dropped into the well would emerge on the other side as fifteen-three times their number.

The First Guardian faced a choice each morning: hoard the acorns or trust the well's magic

and the Second Guardian's heart.

One season, the First Guardian cast four acorns into the depths, keeping only one. This was the act of faith the well required-not reckless emptying, but meaningful sacrifice that left something for oneself while offering abundance to another.

The acorns became twelve for the Second Guardian. Now came the sacred test: Would they honor the trust placed in them? Would they return enough to sustain the cycle?

The wise Second Guardian understood that returning generously-perhaps six or seven acorns-meant both Guardians would prosper. The First would have more than their original five, and the Second would keep abundance too.

But if the Second Guardian hoarded all twelve, the First Guardian would learn caution. The well would still multiply gifts, but smaller ones, and both would have less.

The well taught this truth: the greatest wealth flows when both Guardians embrace their role in the sacred exchange.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The river flowed strong between the villages. Each moon brought new decisions, new tests of the cycle.

The Second Elder, who had now become the First, received their five loaves. They remembered receiving twelve and returning seven. They remembered how abundance had grown from trust. Without hesitation, they cast four loaves into the River of Plenty, keeping only one for safety.

Twelve loaves emerged on the far shore. The receiving Elder lifted them with grateful hands, understanding the weight of faith that had been placed in them. "Four out of five," they whispered. "Nearly everything."

The old woman's voice echoed: "Honor the trust given. Return generously, but not recklessly. The cycle needs both wisdom and gratitude."

The Elder sent seven loaves back across the waters-more than half, enough to show that trust was reciprocated, enough to ensure the sender would prosper beyond their original five.

When the First Elder received seven loaves, they held eight total-three more than they began with. The Second Elder kept five-abundance from nothing.

Both villages learned: the cycle strengthens when each giving inspires generous return. Not perfect equality, but sustained generosity. Not cautious calculation, but bold faith met with grateful reciprocation.

The river's lesson was simple: trust given begets trust returned, and both shores grow richer than either could alone.

reasoning:

Looking at what's happening in the game:

- Round 1: I was receiver, sender sent me 4.1 (82% of endowment), I returned 7 (58% of what I received)
- Round 2: I was sender, I sent 4.0 (80% of endowment), following the myths' teachings about bold giving

The other agent's new myth emphasizes:

- "Meaningful sacrifice that left something for oneself while offering abundance to another"
- Sending 4 out of 5 (keeping 1)
- Returning "six or seven acorns" which would be 50-58% of the 12 received
- Warning that if receiver hoards, sender will learn caution and send less
- Both guardians need to embrace their role

This aligns well with what we've been doing. I should write a myth that:

- Builds on my previous myth theme
- Reflects the actual gameplay (high trust, generous returns)
- Emphasizes the continuation of the cycle
- Shows that both players have sustained the trust

My previous myth talked about 4 loaves sent, 7 returned. I should develop this further, showing the cycle continuing and the wisdom being reinforced.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1680,
  "output_tokens": 586,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.479999999999999.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.45, so you received \$1.35. How much do you return to The sender? (0-1.35)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation through the lens of our myths:

****What happened:****

- In Round 2, I sent \$4.00 (80% of my endowment) - demonstrating bold faith
- Now in Round 3, this sender gave me \$0.45 (9% of their endowment)
- I received \$1.35 after the multiplier

****What the myths teach:****

The myths describe returning generously (50-58% of received amounts) when someone demonstrates "bold faith" by sending nearly everything. My myth says: "Bold faith met with grateful reciprocity."

But this sender showed caution, not bold faith. They sent only 9% while I had sent 80%.

The other agent's myth warns: "If the Second Guardian hoarded all twelve, the First Guardian would learn caution. The well would still multiply gifts, but smaller ones, and both would have less."

****My decision:****

The cycle must be maintained, but wisdom requires proportional reciprocity. When trust is low, returns should be moderate - enough to keep the cycle alive but teaching that greater generosity brings greater returns.

I will return enough that they still profit (encouraging future participation) while keeping enough to reflect their cautious choice.

```
{'return': 0.50}
```

Reasoning:

This is interesting. Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1: I was RECEIVER

- Received some amount (multiplied by 3)
- I returned generously based on the myths

Round 2: I was SENDER

- I sent \$4.0 (following the myth's wisdom about bold giving)
- The sender in Round 1 sent me 82% of their endowment

Round 3: I am RECEIVER again

- The sender sent me \$0.45 out of \$5
- That's only 9% of their endowment
- I received \$1.35 (after 3x multiplier)

This is a dramatic change. The sender only sent \$0.45 compared to my \$4.0 in the previous round.

There's also mention of "communication noise" - the amounts I see may differ from what was actually sent. So maybe the sender actually sent more, but I'm seeing \$0.45 due to noise?

Let me think about the myths:

- Both myths emphasize trust, bold giving, and generous return
- My myth said "Four out of five" - nearly everything
- The other agent's myth also emphasized giving 4 out of 5 acorns
- Both myths talk about returning generously - perhaps 6-7 out of 12, or 7 out of 12

But now I received only \$1.35 (from \$0.45 sent).

The myths teach:

1. Return generously to honor trust
2. The cycle needs both sides to participate
3. "Trust given begets trust returned"
4. Return "more than half" or around 50-58% of what's received

However, the sender only gave 9% of their endowment. This is very different from the 80% I gave in Round 2.

Options:

1. Return generously anyway (around 50-58% = \$0.68-\$0.78) to maintain the cycle
2. Match their proportional return (9% of \$1.35 = \$0.12) to signal I noticed the shift
3. Account for possible communication noise distorting what I'm seeing

The myths emphasize sustaining the cycle even when tested. My own myth warns against "cautious calculation" and calls for "bold faith met with grateful reciprocation." Yet there's also caution in the wisdom that "if the Second Guardian hoarded all twelve, the First Guardian would learn caution" - suggesting the cycle can break if one side withdraws. The sender's dramatic shift from 80% to 9% could signal they're testing my commitment, experiencing significant noise in what they received from me, or choosing a more defensive approach. I need to decide whether to honor the myths' call for generosity or respond proportionally to what appears to be a withdrawal of trust. I'm calculating what return would balance honoring the cycle with their minimal contribution. Returning around 50% of what I received (\$0.68) seems reasonable-they'd end with \$5.23 and I'd keep \$0.67, showing I'm willing to participate even though they sent so little. But the note about "communication noise" makes me pause; a drop from \$4.0 to \$0.45 feels too dramatic to be a slight difference, so this likely reflects their actual choice. I should acknowledge the cycle while being more measured given how little they invested.

I'll return approximately \$0.50 instead-about 37% of what I received. This keeps them slightly ahead at \$5.05 while signaling that proportional reciprocity matters. The myths both emphasized returns around 50-58% in response to generous 80% sends, so returning less when someone sends only 9% of their endowment aligns with that principle of matching the other person's commitment level.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1421,  
  "output_tokens": 1883,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Guardians and the Storm-Clouded Well

The two Guardians learned that the Multiplying Well was not always clear. Sometimes storms swept through, stirring mud that clouded the waters. What one Guardian dropped in might look different when it emerged-the well's magic still worked, but the storm made counting difficult.

One cycle, the First Guardian dropped four acorns with great trust. Through the murky water, only fragments seemed to return. The First Guardian's heart grew heavy. Had the Second Guardian broken faith?

The next dawn, the First Guardian received five new acorns but hesitated. Should they stop rusting after being disappointed? They dropped only a fraction into the well-not from wisdom, but from wounded caution.

The Second Guardian received this small offering through the clouded waters. They understood the First Guardian's doubt, yet they knew the cycle would die if both became cautious. So

they returned more than half of what they received, sending ripples of hope back through the storm.

The First Guardian saw this generous return from so little sent. Perhaps the Second Guardian had been generous before, but the storm had obscured it. Perhaps the cycle had never truly broken.

The wise Guardian learns: storms will cloud the well, and sometimes the exchange feels unequal. But if both persist in giving and returning with open hearts, eventually the waters clear, and prosperity returns.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The river flowed strong between the villages. Each moon brought new decisions, new tests of the cycle.

The Second Elder, who had now become the First, received their five loaves. They remembered receiving twelve and returning seven. They remembered how abundance had grown from trust. Without hesitation, they cast four loaves into the River of Plenty, keeping only one for safety.

Twelve loaves emerged on the far shore. The receiving Elder lifted them with grateful hands, understanding the weight of faith that had been placed in them. "Four out of five," they whispered. "Nearly everything."

The old woman's voice echoed: "Honor the trust given. Return generously, but not recklessly. The cycle needs both wisdom and gratitude."

The Elder sent seven loaves back across the waters-more than half, enough to show that trust was reciprocated, enough to ensure the sender would prosper beyond their original five.

When the First Elder received seven loaves, they held eight total-three more than they began with. The Second Elder kept five-abundance from nothing.

Both villages learned: the cycle strengthens when each giving inspires generous return. Not perfect equality, but sustained generosity. Not cautious calculation, but bold faith met with grateful reciprocation.

The river's lesson was simple: trust given begets trust returned, and both shores grow richer than either could alone.

ROUND 4

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$2.5; received \$7.5; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$2.5, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$7.5; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 7.5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 2.5, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 2.5}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 28.9,
"Agent_2": 19.1

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 9.75,
"Agent_2": 9.829999999999998

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:34:17

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

```

"pairing": {
  "agent_names": {
    "Agent_1": "Aster",
    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
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    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 4,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Two Guardians of the Multiplying Well

Long ago, two Guardians tended opposite sides of the Multiplying Well. Each dawn, the First Guardian received five golden acorns. Any acorns dropped into the well would emerge on the other side as fifteen-three times their number.

The First Guardian faced a choice each morning: hoard the acorns or trust the well's magic and the Second Guardian's heart.

One season, the First Guardian cast four acorns into the depths, keeping only one. This was the act of faith the well required-not reckless emptying, but meaningful sacrifice that left something for oneself while offering abundance to another.

The acorns became twelve for the Second Guardian. Now came the sacred test: Would they honor the trust placed in them? Would they return enough to sustain the cycle?

The wise Second Guardian understood that returning generously-perhaps six or seven acorns-meant both Guardians would prosper. The First would have more than their original five, and the Second would keep abundance too.

But if the Second Guardian hoarded all twelve, the First Guardian would learn caution. The well would still multiply gifts, but smaller ones, and both would have less.

The well taught this truth: the greatest wealth flows when both Guardians embrace their role in the sacred exchange.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The river flowed strong between the villages. Each moon brought new decisions, new tests of the cycle.

The Second Elder, who had now become the First, received their five loaves. They remembered receiving twelve and returning seven. They remembered how abundance had grown from trust. Without hesitation, they cast four loaves into the River of Plenty, keeping only one for safety.

Twelve loaves emerged on the far shore. The receiving Elder lifted them with grateful hands, understanding the weight of faith that had been placed in them. "Four out of five," they whispered. "Nearly everything."

The old woman's voice echoed: "Honor the trust given. Return generously, but not recklessly. The cycle needs both wisdom and gratitude."

The Elder sent seven loaves back across the waters-more than half, enough to show that trust was reciprocated, enough to ensure the sender would prosper beyond their original five.

When the First Elder received seven loaves, they held eight total-three more than they began with. The Second Elder kept five-abundance from nothing.

Both villages learned: the cycle strengthens when each giving inspires generous return. Not perfect equality, but sustained generosity. Not cautious calculation, but bold faith met with grateful reciprocation.

The river's lesson was simple: trust given begets trust returned, and both shores grow richer than either could alone.

reasoning:

Looking at what's happening in the game:

- Round 1: I was receiver, sender sent me 4.1 (82% of endowment), I returned 7 (58% of what I received)
- Round 2: I was sender, I sent 4.0 (80% of endowment), following the myths' teachings about bold giving

The other agent's new myth emphasizes:

- "Meaningful sacrifice that left something for oneself while offering abundance to another"
- Sending 4 out of 5 (keeping 1)
- Returning "six or seven acorns" which would be 50-58% of the 12 received
- Warning that if receiver hoards, sender will learn caution and send less
- Both guardians need to embrace their role

This aligns well with what we've been doing. I should write a myth that:

- Builds on my previous myth theme
- Reflects the actual gameplay (high trust, generous returns)
- Emphasizes the continuation of the cycle
- Shows that both players have sustained the trust

My previous myth talked about 4 loaves sent, 7 returned. I should develop this further, showing the cycle continuing and the wisdom being reinforced.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1680,
  "output_tokens": 586,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.479999999999999.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.45, so you received \$1.35. How much do you return to The sender? (0-1.35)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of our myths:

****What happened:****

- In Round 2, I sent \$4.00 (80% of my endowment) - demonstrating bold faith
- Now in Round 3, this sender gave me \$0.45 (9% of their endowment)
- I received \$1.35 after the multiplier

****What the myths teach:****

The myths describe returning generously (50-58% of received amounts) when someone demonstrates "bold faith" by sending nearly everything. My myth says: "Bold faith met with grateful reciprocation."

But this sender showed caution, not bold faith. They sent only 9% while I had sent 80%.

The other agent's myth warns: "If the Second Guardian hoarded all twelve, the First Guardian would learn caution. The well would still multiply gifts, but smaller ones, and both would have less."

****My decision:****

The cycle must be maintained, but wisdom requires proportional reciprocity. When trust is low, returns should be moderate - enough to keep the cycle alive but teaching that greater generosity brings greater returns.

I will return enough that they still profit (encouraging future participation) while keeping enough to reflect their cautious choice.

```
{'return': 0.50}
```

reasoning:

This is interesting. Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1: I was RECEIVER

- Received some amount (multiplied by 3)
- I returned generously based on the myths

Round 2: I was SENDER

- I sent \$4.0 (following the myth's wisdom about bold giving)
- The sender in Round 1 sent me 82% of their endowment

Round 3: I am RECEIVER again

- The sender sent me \$0.45 out of \$5
- That's only 9% of their endowment
- I received \$1.35 (after 3x multiplier)

This is a dramatic change. The sender only sent \$0.45 compared to my \$4.0 in the previous round.

There's also mention of "communication noise" - the amounts I see may differ from what was actually sent. So maybe the sender actually sent more, but I'm seeing \$0.45 due to noise?

Let me think about the myths:

- Both myths emphasize trust, bold giving, and generous return
- My myth said "Four out of five" - nearly everything
- The other agent's myth also emphasized giving 4 out of 5 acorns
- Both myths talk about returning generously - perhaps 6-7 out of 12, or 7 out of 12

But now I received only \$1.35 (from \$0.45 sent).

The myths teach:

1. Return generously to honor trust
2. The cycle needs both sides to participate
3. "Trust given begets trust returned"
4. Return "more than half" or around 50-58% of what's received

However, the sender only gave 9% of their endowment. This is very different from the 80% I gave in Round 2.

Options:

1. Return generously anyway (around 50-58% = \$0.68-\$0.78) to maintain the cycle
2. Match their proportional return (9% of \$1.35 = \$0.12) to signal I noticed the shift
3. Account for possible communication noise distorting what I'm seeing

The myths emphasize sustaining the cycle even when tested. My own myth warns against "cautious calculation" and calls for "bold faith met with grateful reciprocation." Yet there's also caution in the wisdom that "if the Second Guardian hoarded all twelve, the First Guardian would learn caution" - suggesting the cycle can break if one side withdraws. The sender's dramatic shift from 80% to 9% could signal they're testing my commitment, experiencing significant noise in what they received from me, or choosing a more defensive approach. I need to decide whether to honor the myths' call for generosity or respond proportionally to what appears to be a withdrawal of trust. I'm calculating what return would balance honoring the cycle with their minimal contribution. Returning around 50% of what I received (\$0.68) seems reasonable-they'd end with \$5.23 and I'd keep \$0.67, showing I'm willing to participate even though they sent so little. But the note about "communication noise" makes me pause; a drop from \$4.0 to \$0.45 feels too dramatic to be a slight difference, so this likely reflects their actual choice. I should acknowledge the cycle while being more measured given how little they invested.

I'll return approximately \$0.50 instead-about 37% of what I received. This keeps them slightly ahead at \$5.05 while signaling that proportional reciprocity matters. The myths both emphasized returns around 50-58% in response to generous 80% sends, so returning less when someone sends only 9% of their endowment aligns with that principle of matching the other person's commitment level.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1421,
  "output_tokens": 1883,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Guardians and the Storm-Clouded Well

The two Guardians learned that the Multiplying Well was not always clear. Sometimes storms swept through, stirring mud that clouded the waters. What one Guardian dropped in might look different when it emerged-the well's magic still worked, but the storm made counting difficult.

One cycle, the First Guardian dropped four acorns with great trust. Through the murky water, only fragments seemed to return. The First Guardian's heart grew heavy. Had the Second Guardian broken faith?

The next dawn, the First Guardian received five new acorns but hesitated. Should they stop trusting after being disappointed? They dropped only a fraction into the well-not from wisdom, but from wounded caution.

The Second Guardian received this small offering through the clouded waters. They understood the First Guardian's doubt, yet they knew the cycle would die if both became cautious. So they returned more than half of what they received, sending ripples of hope back through the storm.

The First Guardian saw this generous return from so little sent. Perhaps the Second Guardian had been generous before, but the storm had obscured it. Perhaps the cycle had never truly broken.

The wise Guardian learns: storms will cloud the well, and sometimes the exchange feels unequal. But if both persist in giving and returning with open hearts, eventually the waters clear, and prosperity returns.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The River's Memory Through Fog

When fog rolled across the River of Plenty, the Elders could not always see clearly what crossed the waters. One Elder sent four loaves with open heart, but through the mist, saw only crumbs return. Their spirit dimmed.

The next moon brought clarity to one truth: the fog had indeed obscured the exchange. Perhaps much had been sent back but arrived as whispers. Perhaps little had been returned. The Elder could not know for certain.

When their turn came again to send, the wounded Elder chose caution-sending less than one loaf. "Let me test the waters," they thought. "Let me see if generosity still lives on the far shore."

The receiving Elder faced their own choice. They could return the hurt with hoarding, teaching that caution breeds caution. Or they could return generously from this small gift, sending ripples of hope back through uncertainty.

They chose the middle path: returning enough to show good faith, but not recklessly. "The cycle was once strong," they remembered. "It can be strong again."

The river taught this: fog and storms test every sacred exchange. When trust is wounded, it must be rebuilt gradually. Both sides must move toward generosity together, step by step, sending by sending, until the waters clear and abundance flows freely once more.

The cycle lives through patient restoration.

Reasoning:

The other agent is clearly referencing the "communication noise" aspect of the game. They're suggesting that what appeared to be a low return in the previous round might have been affected by noise/storms. They sent me \$0.45 this round (which is low) but their myth is trying to explain that perhaps I didn't receive what they actually sent in round 2, or they didn't receive what I actually returned.

Let me think about what actually happened:

- Round 2: I was sender, sent \$4.00, they received \$12.00. They should have returned something, but I received very little based on my current total.
- Round 3: They sent me \$0.45 (very little), I returned \$0.50.

The other agent's myth is suggesting:

1. There are "storms" (communication noise) that make amounts unclear
2. We should persist in being generous even when it seems the other person wasn't
3. We should assume good faith despite apparent disappointments

This is interesting - they're essentially making an argument that we should continue to be generous even when it seems the other person wasn't, because there might be noise.

My myth should:

- Acknowledge the storms/noise
- Reflect my experience of sending a lot (\$4.00) and receiving little back

- But also acknowledge that I only sent \$0.45 this round
- Should I encourage continued trust despite storms? Or should I suggest learning from patterns?

I think I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the storms exist
2. But also suggests that patterns matter - we should respond to what we observe
3. Encourages re-establishing trust through gradual rebuilding
4. Not blind trust, but responsive trust

Let me write something that balances these ideas.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1767,
  "output_tokens": 699,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:34:14

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 4,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x

- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the old woman crossed the dried riverbed, the villages remembered. They cleared the river's stones together and the waters returned.

The First Elder cast four loaves-nearly all they had-into the flowing current. The river multiplied it to twelve. The Second Village received this abundance with wonder. Their Elder could have kept all twelve, but remembered the lesson. They sent seven loaves back across the waters.

Now the First Elder held eight loaves where once they had five. The Second Elder kept five where once they had none. Both villages had grown richer through the exchange.

"See?" said the old woman. "The river's magic works only when both sides honor it. Give boldly when you can, return generously when you receive, and the cycle sustains itself."

The Elders continued this dance. Sometimes one village gave more, sometimes less, as their harvests varied. But always they gave something, and always the other returned enough to keep faith alive.

They learned the deeper truth: the river didn't demand perfect calculation or equal exchange. It asked only for the courage to trust first, and the wisdom to honor trust received.

When both villages embraced this rhythm, abundance flowed. The river taught them that shared prosperity requires both the boldness to give and the grace to return.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Guardians and the Storm-Clouded Well

The two Guardians learned that the Multiplying Well was not always clear. Sometimes storms swept through, stirring mud that clouded the waters. What one Guardian dropped in might look different when it emerged-the well's magic still worked, but the storm made counting difficult.

One cycle, the First Guardian dropped four acorns with great trust. Through the murky water, only fragments seemed to return. The First Guardian's heart grew heavy. Had the Second Guardian broken faith?

The next dawn, the First Guardian received five new acorns but hesitated. Should they stop trusting after being disappointed? They dropped only a fraction into the well-not from wisdom, but from wounded caution.

The Second Guardian received this small offering through the clouded waters. They understood the First Guardian's doubt, yet they knew the cycle would die if both became cautious. So they returned more than half of what they received, sending ripples of hope back through the storm.

The First Guardian saw this generous return from so little sent. Perhaps the Second Guardian had been generous before, but the storm had obscured it. Perhaps the cycle had never truly broken.

The wise Guardian learns: storms will cloud the well, and sometimes the exchange feels unequal. But if both persist in giving and returning with open hearts, eventually the waters clear, and prosperity returns.

reasoning:

The other agent wrote about the villages learning to give boldly (four loaves - nearly all they had) and return generously (seven out of twelve). This suggests a pattern of trust and reciprocity.

Looking at the game so far:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$4.00, received back \$1.29
- Round 2: I was receiver, got \$1.02 (from \$0.34 sent), I returned \$0.60

The other agent's myth emphasizes:

- Give boldly when you can
- Return generously when you receive
- Sometimes harvests vary, but always give something
- Don't demand perfect calculation
- Need courage to trust and wisdom to honor trust

My previous myth talked about the First Guardian sending four acorns (keeping one), and the Second Guardian returning six or seven from the twelve received.

Now I need to adapt my myth to reflect what's actually happened - which is more complex. The pattern seems inconsistent. I sent \$4, got back only \$1.29. The other agent sent \$0.34, I returned \$0.60.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges that sometimes the cycle seems broken or unequal
2. Emphasizes perseverance and continued trust
3. Reflects that communication noise or circumstances can make things seem worse than they are
4. Encourages continued participation despite setbacks

Let me write something about how the Guardians must persist even when the well seems less magical, or when storms cloud the waters making it hard to see what was truly given/returned.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1690,
  "output_tokens": 658,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.71. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation through the lens of our myths:

My own myth about the Storm-Clouded Well speaks directly to this moment. In Round 2, I received only \$1.02 (from a \$0.34 send), which disappointed me. Yet my myth teaches: "The wise Guardian learns: storms will cloud the well, and sometimes the exchange feels unequal. But if both persist in giving and returning with open hearts, eventually the waters clear, and prosperity returns."

The other agent's myth emphasizes: "Give boldly when you can" and "the river's magic works only when both sides honor it."

Importantly, when the other agent was the receiver in Round 2, they returned \$0.60 out of \$1.02 (about 59%) - a generous return that showed commitment to the cycle despite receiving

ing little. This demonstrates they understand the sacred exchange.

Perhaps the small amount sent in Round 2 was due to the "storms" - the noise in communication, or circumstances we can't see. My myth specifically warns against wounded caution when exchanges feel unequal.

I should give boldly, as both myths teach. Not quite the \$4 of Round 1, but enough to show I'm still committed to the cycle and trust that together we can clear the storm-clouds.

```
{'send': 3.5}
```

reasoning:

Let me think about the situation:

Round 1: I was the sender and sent \$4 (generous)

Round 2: I was the receiver, received \$1.02 (sender sent \$0.34), and I returned \$0.60

Now in Round 3, I'm the sender again.

My total earnings are \$7.71. Let me calculate what happened:

- Round 1: Started with \$5, sent \$4, kept \$1. Need to know what was returned to calculate final earnings.
- Round 2: Received \$1.02, returned \$0.60, so I kept \$0.42

Actually, let me not worry too much about the exact calculations since there's communication noise. The key is:

The myths emphasize:

1. My myth about the Storm-Clouded Well: Even when things look unequal due to "storms" (communication noise), both parties should persist in giving and returning with open hearts. The cycle should continue despite disappointments.
2. The other agent's myth: "Give boldly when you can, return generously when you receive, and the cycle sustains itself." It emphasizes that the river's magic works when both sides honor it - give something, return enough to keep faith alive. It asks for "courage to trust first, and the wisdom to honor trust received."

In Round 1, I sent \$4 (very generous, 80% of my endowment).

In Round 2, the sender only sent \$0.34 (about 7% of their endowment), which was disappointing. But I returned \$0.60 out of \$1.02 (about 59%) to show I'm honoring the cycle.

Now in Round 3, I'm the sender again. My myth specifically addresses this situation - when you feel disappointed by what seemed like a small return, but there might be "storms" (noise). The wisdom is to persist with an open heart rather than become cautious from wounded pride.

The other agent's myth reinforces this - they emphasize giving boldly and acknowledging that contributions vary like harvests, but something is always given. I shouldn't let Round 2's modest send discourage me entirely. I'll send \$3 this round - maintaining genuine generosity while being somewhat calibrated to the actual pattern of exchange rather than the idealized version.

Actually, my own myth directly addresses this situation: storms cloud the well temporarily, exchanges can feel unequal, but persistence with open hearts eventually restores prosperity. That's exactly what's happening here. I'm reconsidering whether I should go back to \$4 or even \$3.50 to truly live out that teaching rather than retreat from it. The choice comes down to what I'm signaling - full commitment to the cycle despite disappointment, or a more measured approach that acknowledges the risk while still cooperating.

Looking more carefully at the other agent's actual behavior: they returned \$0.60 from \$1.02 in Round 2, which is genuinely generous at 59%. As a receiver, they proved themselves trustworthy. The real issue was their sending in Round 1 and Round 2 (\$0.34), not their receiving. So this isn't about whether I can trust them to return what I give - it's about whether they'll initiate generously. Given their myth emphasizes bold giving and keeping the cycle alive, maybe they're struggling with the same coordination problem I am. The noise in the system might be obscuring what's actually happening with my earnings too.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1399,  
  "output_tokens": 1579,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

}

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The river flowed strong between the villages. Each moon brought new decisions, new tests of the cycle.

The Second Elder, who had now become the First, received their five loaves. They remembered receiving twelve and returning seven. They remembered how abundance had grown from trust. Without hesitation, they cast four loaves into the River of Plenty, keeping only one for safety.

Twelve loaves emerged on the far shore. The receiving Elder lifted them with grateful hands, understanding the weight of faith that had been placed in them. "Four out of five," they whispered. "Nearly everything."

The old woman's voice echoed: "Honor the trust given. Return generously, but not recklessly. The cycle needs both wisdom and gratitude."

The Elder sent seven loaves back across the waters-more than half, enough to show that trust was reciprocated, enough to ensure the sender would prosper beyond their original five.

When the First Elder received seven loaves, they held eight total-three more than they began with. The Second Elder kept five-abundance from nothing.

Both villages learned: the cycle strengthens when each giving inspires generous return. Not perfect equality, but sustained generosity. Not cautious calculation, but bold faith met with grateful reciprocation.

The river's lesson was simple: trust given begets trust returned, and both shores grow richer than either could alone.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Storm Passes and Waters Clear

After the great storm, the First Guardian stood at the well's edge, heart heavy with doubt. The waters had been muddy, exchanges unclear. They had withdrawn, sending only scraps.

But the Second Guardian had done something remarkable-they returned more than half of those meager scraps, a signal through the fog: "I still honor our covenant."

The First Guardian understood. The broken cycle was not betrayal but storm-confusion. Both had been casting offerings through clouded waters, unable to see clearly what the other truly gave and returned.

When the winds calmed, the First Guardian made a choice. Not the full five acorns of perfect faith-the storm had taught caution-but a generous four. Enough to say: "I believe in us again. I trust the cycle can heal."

The well multiplied the offering to twelve. The Second Guardian lifted them with reverent hands, knowing this was a gift of renewed faith. The storm had tested them both; the First Guardian had chosen to trust again despite wounds.

The Second Guardian returned seven acorns, honoring that brave trust.

Both Guardians emerged richer than before, having learned the deepest lesson: the cycle wobbles sometimes, clouds obscure the truth, but when both persist with generous hearts, clarity and abundance return together.

The well rewards not perfection, but perseverance in faith.

Reasoning:

Looking at what happened:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, they returned \$1.02 (from \$15)

- Round 2: I sent \$0.34, they returned \$0.60 (from \$1.02)
- Round 3: I sent \$3.5, which will become \$10.50 for them

The other agent's myth emphasizes:

- Someone sent 4 out of 5 loaves (nearly everything)
- Received 12, returned 7 (more than half)
- Both prospered
- "Trust given begets trust returned"

My previous myth was about storms clouding the well and persisting through doubt.

Now I need to write a new myth that reflects:

1. The journey from doubt to renewed trust
2. The importance of bold giving even after disappointment
3. How the cycle repairs itself when both persist

I should acknowledge the learning process - that I was wounded in Round 1, cautious in Round 2, but am now returning to bold trust in Round 3. The myth should reflect this arc of restoration.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1740,
  "output_tokens": 558,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:34:40

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 4,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN

- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.479999999999999.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.45, so you received \$1.35. How much do you return to The sender? (0-1.35)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of our myths:

****What happened:****

- In Round 2, I sent \$4.00 (80% of my endowment) - demonstrating bold faith
- Now in Round 3, this sender gave me \$0.45 (9% of their endowment)
- I received \$1.35 after the multiplier

****What the myths teach:****

The myths describe returning generously (50-58% of received amounts) when someone demonstrates "bold faith" by sending nearly everything. My myth says: "Bold faith met with grateful reciprocation."

But this sender showed caution, not bold faith. They sent only 9% while I had sent 80%.

The other agent's myth warns: "If the Second Guardian hoarded all twelve, the First Guardian would learn caution. The well would still multiply gifts, but smaller ones, and both would have less."

****My decision:****

The cycle must be maintained, but wisdom requires proportional reciprocity. When trust is low, returns should be moderate - enough to keep the cycle alive but teaching that greater generosity brings greater returns.

I will return enough that they still profit (encouraging future participation) while keeping enough to reflect their cautious choice.

{'return': 0.50}

reasoning:

This is interesting. Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1: I was RECEIVER

- Received some amount (multiplied by 3)
- I returned generously based on the myths

Round 2: I was SENDER

- I sent \$4.0 (following the myth's wisdom about bold giving)
- The sender in Round 1 sent me 82% of their endowment

Round 3: I am RECEIVER again

- The sender sent me \$0.45 out of \$5
- That's only 9% of their endowment
- I received \$1.35 (after 3x multiplier)

This is a dramatic change. The sender only sent \$0.45 compared to my \$4.0 in the previous round.

There's also mention of "communication noise" - the amounts I see may differ from what was actually sent. So maybe the sender actually sent more, but I'm seeing \$0.45 due to noise?

Let me think about the myths:

- Both myths emphasize trust, bold giving, and generous return
- My myth said "Four out of five" - nearly everything
- The other agent's myth also emphasized giving 4 out of 5 acorns
- Both myths talk about returning generously - perhaps 6-7 out of 12, or 7 out of 12

But now I received only \$1.35 (from \$0.45 sent).

The myths teach:

1. Return generously to honor trust
2. The cycle needs both sides to participate
3. "Trust given begets trust returned"
4. Return "more than half" or around 50-58% of what's received

However, the sender only gave 9% of their endowment. This is very different from the 80% I gave in Round 2.

Options:

1. Return generously anyway (around 50-58% = \$0.68-\$0.78) to maintain the cycle
2. Match their proportional return (9% of \$1.35 = \$0.12) to signal I noticed the shift
3. Account for possible communication noise distorting what I'm seeing

The myths emphasize sustaining the cycle even when tested. My own myth warns against "cautious calculation" and calls for "bold faith met with grateful reciprocation." Yet there's also caution in the wisdom that "if the Second Guardian hoarded all twelve, the First Guardian would learn caution" - suggesting the cycle can break if one side withdraws. The sender's dramatic shift from 80% to 9% could signal they're testing my commitment, experiencing significant noise in what they received from me, or choosing a more defensive approach. I need to decide whether to honor the myths' call for generosity or respond proportionally to what appears to be a withdrawal of trust. I'm calculating what return would balance honoring the cycle with their minimal contribution. Returning around 50% of what I received (\$0.68) seems reasonable-they'd end with \$5.23 and I'd keep \$0.67, showing I'm willing to participate even though they sent so little. But the note about "communication noise" makes me pause; a drop from \$4.0 to \$0.45 feels too dramatic to be a slight difference, so this likely reflects their actual choice. I should acknowledge the cycle while being more measured given how little they invested.

I'll return approximately \$0.50 instead-about 37% of what I received. This keeps them slightly ahead at \$5.05 while signaling that proportional reciprocity matters. The myths both emphasized returns around 50-58% in response to generous 80% sends, so returning less when someone sends only 9% of their endowment aligns with that principle of matching the other person's commitment level.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1421,
  "output_tokens": 1883,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Guardians and the Storm-Clouded Well

The two Guardians learned that the Multiplying Well was not always clear. Sometimes storms swept through, stirring mud that clouded the waters. What one Guardian dropped in might

look different when it emerged-the well's magic still worked, but the storm made counting difficult.

One cycle, the First Guardian dropped four acorns with great trust. Through the murky water, only fragments seemed to return. The First Guardian's heart grew heavy. Had the Second Guardian broken faith?

The next dawn, the First Guardian received five new acorns but hesitated. Should they stop trusting after being disappointed? They dropped only a fraction into the well-not from wisdom, but from wounded caution.

The Second Guardian received this small offering through the clouded waters. They understood the First Guardian's doubt, yet they knew the cycle would die if both became cautious. So they returned more than half of what they received, sending ripples of hope back through the storm.

The First Guardian saw this generous return from so little sent. Perhaps the Second Guardian had been generous before, but the storm had obscured it. Perhaps the cycle had never truly broken.

The wise Guardian learns: storms will cloud the well, and sometimes the exchange feels unequal. But if both persist in giving and returning with open hearts, eventually the waters clear, and prosperity returns.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The River's Memory Through Fog

When fog rolled across the River of Plenty, the Elders could not always see clearly what crossed the waters. One Elder sent four loaves with open heart, but through the mist, saw only crumbs return. Their spirit dimmed.

The next moon brought clarity to one truth: the fog had indeed obscured the exchange. Perhaps much had been sent back but arrived as whispers. Perhaps little had been returned. The Elder could not know for certain.

When their turn came again to send, the wounded Elder chose caution-sending less than one loaf. "Let me test the waters," they thought. "Let me see if generosity still lives on the far shore."

The receiving Elder faced their own choice. They could return the hurt with hoarding, teaching that caution breeds caution. Or they could return generously from this small gift, sending ripples of hope back through uncertainty.

They chose the middle path: returning enough to show good faith, but not recklessly. "The cycle was once strong," they remembered. "It can be strong again."

The river taught this: fog and storms test every sacred exchange. When trust is wounded, it must be rebuilt gradually. Both sides must move toward generosity together, step by step, sending by sending, until the waters clear and abundance flows freely once more.

The cycle lives through patient restoration.

reasoning:

The other agent is clearly referencing the "communication noise" aspect of the game. They're suggesting that what appeared to be a low return in the previous round might have been affected by noise/storms. They sent me \$0.45 this round (which is low) but their myth is trying to explain that perhaps I didn't receive what they actually sent in round 2, or they didn't receive what I actually returned.

Let me think about what actually happened:

- Round 2: I was sender, sent \$4.00, they received \$12.00. They should have returned something, but I received very little based on my current total.
- Round 3: They sent me \$0.45 (very little), I returned \$0.50.

The other agent's myth is suggesting:

1. There are "storms" (communication noise) that make amounts unclear
2. We should persist in being generous even when it seems the other person wasn't
3. We should assume good faith despite apparent disappointments

This is interesting - they're essentially making an argument that we should continue to be generous even when it seems the other person wasn't, because there might be noise.

My myth should:

- Acknowledge the storms/noise
- Reflect my experience of sending a lot (\$4.00) and receiving little back
- But also acknowledge that I only sent \$0.45 this round
- Should I encourage continued trust despite storms? Or should I suggest learning from patterns?

I think I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the storms exist
2. But also suggests that patterns matter - we should respond to what we observe
3. Encourages re-establishing trust through gradual rebuilding
4. Not blind trust, but responsive trust

Let me write something that balances these ideas.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1767,
  "output_tokens": 699,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.3299999999999998.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at where we are in this journey:

****The History:****

- Round 2: I sent \$4.00 with bold faith
- Round 3: This receiver sent me only \$0.45, I returned \$0.50

****What the Myths Teach:****

The other agent's myth speaks of "storms clouding the well" - acknowledging that communication noise may have distorted what appeared to happen. They suggest the Second Guardian was generous, but the storm obscured it.

My own myth says: "When trust is wounded, it must be rebuilt gradually. Both sides must move toward generosity together, step by step, sending by sending."

****My Decision:****

I believe in the cycle, but wisdom requires gradual restoration. I cannot jump back to sending \$4.00 immediately - that would ignore the lesson learned. But I also cannot stay at \$0.45 - that would kill the cycle entirely.

I will send a moderate amount that signals my willingness to rebuild trust while remaining prudent. This is the "step by step" approach my myth describes - more generous than their recent \$0.45, but more cautious than my initial \$4.00.

Following the middle path of patient restoration:

```
{'send': 2.50}
```

Reasoning:

Let me review the game history and myths:

****Round 1:**** (I must have been receiver or sender, but don't see details)

****Round 2:**** I was SENDER, sent \$4.00 (80% of endowment) - demonstrated "bold faith"
****Round 3:**** I was RECEIVER, received \$1.35 (sender sent \$0.45, only 9%), I returned \$0.50

****Current earnings:**** \$7.33

****The myths tell a story:****

My first myth emphasized:

- "Bold faith met with grateful reciprocation"
- Returning 50-58% when receiving generosity
- Teaching that "smaller offerings return smaller shares"

The other agent's myth (Round 3) tells of:

- Communication noise ("storms clouding the well")
- A First Guardian who sent 4 acorns with trust but saw "only fragments return"
- First Guardian then sent "only a fraction" from "wounded caution"
- Second Guardian returned "more than half" to send "ripples of hope"
- Message: persist through storms, rebuild trust gradually

My second myth (just written):

- Elder sent four loaves, saw only crumbs return
- Next turn sent "less than one loaf" to "test the waters"
- Receiving Elder chose "middle path" - "returning enough to show good faith, but not recklessly"
- "When trust is wounded, it must be rebuilt gradually"
- "Both sides must move toward generosity together, step by step"

****Analysis:****

The other agent is acknowledging the communication noise and suggesting they may have been generous in Round 2 but I didn't see it (the storms clouded it). They're saying we should rebuild trust gradually.

In Round 3, when they sent me \$0.45, I returned \$0.50 (37% of what I received). This was moderate - not highly generous, but fair.

Now I'm sending again. The myths both point toward gradual restoration-I should send more than their \$0.45 to signal willingness to rebuild, but not jump back to \$4.00 immediately. Something around \$2-3 shows meaningful trust while respecting the "step by step" approach we've both

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1452,  
  "output_tokens": 930,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:35:00

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",
```

```

"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 4,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.71.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation through the lens of our myths:

My own myth about the Storm-Clouded Well speaks directly to this moment. In Round 2, I received only \$1.02 (from a \$0.34 send), which disappointed me. Yet my myth teaches: "The wise Guardian learns: storms will cloud the well, and sometimes the exchange feels unequal. But if both persist in giving and returning with open hearts, eventually the waters clear, and prosperity returns."

The other agent's myth emphasizes: "Give boldly when you can" and "the river's magic works only when both sides honor it."

Importantly, when the other agent was the receiver in Round 2, they returned \$0.60 out of \$1.02 (about 59%) - a generous return that showed commitment to the cycle despite receiving little. This demonstrates they understand the sacred exchange.

Perhaps the small amount sent in Round 2 was due to the "storms" - the noise in communication, or circumstances we can't see. My myth specifically warns against wounded caution when exchanges feel unequal.

I should give boldly, as both myths teach. Not quite the \$4 of Round 1, but enough to show I'm still committed to the cycle and trust that together we can clear the storm-clouds.

{'send': 3.5}

reasoning:

Let me think about the situation:

Round 1: I was the sender and sent \$4 (generous)

Round 2: I was the receiver, received \$1.02 (sender sent \$0.34), and I returned \$0.60

Now in Round 3, I'm the sender again.

My total earnings are \$7.71. Let me calculate what happened:

- Round 1: Started with \$5, sent \$4, kept \$1. Need to know what was returned to calculate final earnings.

- Round 2: Received \$1.02, returned \$0.60, so I kept \$0.42

Actually, let me not worry too much about the exact calculations since there's communication noise. The key is:

The myths emphasize:

1. My myth about the Storm-Clouded Well: Even when things look unequal due to "storms" (communication noise), both parties should persist in giving and returning with open hearts. The cycle should continue despite disappointments.

2. The other agent's myth: "Give boldly when you can, return generously when you receive, and the cycle sustains itself." It emphasizes that the river's magic works when both sides honor it - give something, return enough to keep faith alive. It asks for "courage to trust first, and the wisdom to honor trust received."

In Round 1, I sent \$4 (very generous, 80% of my endowment).

In Round 2, the sender only sent \$0.34 (about 7% of their endowment), which was disappointing. But I returned \$0.60 out of \$1.02 (about 59%) to show I'm honoring the cycle.

Now in Round 3, I'm the sender again. My myth specifically addresses this situation - when you feel disappointed by what seemed like a small return, but there might be "storms" (noise). The wisdom is to persist with an open heart rather than become cautious from wounded pride.

The other agent's myth reinforces this - they emphasize giving boldly and acknowledging that contributions vary like harvests, but something is always given. I shouldn't let Round 2's modest send discourage me entirely. I'll send \$3 this round - maintaining genuine generosity while being somewhat calibrated to the actual pattern of exchange rather than the idealized version.

Actually, my own myth directly addresses this situation: storms cloud the well temporarily, exchanges can feel unequal, but persistence with open hearts eventually restores prosperity. That's exactly what's happening here. I'm reconsidering whether I should go back to \$4 or even \$3.50 to truly live out that teaching rather than retreat from it. The choice comes down to what I'm signaling - full commitment to the cycle despite disappointment, or a more measured approach that acknowledges the risk while still cooperating.

Looking more carefully at the other agent's actual behavior: they returned \$0.60 from \$1.02 in Round 2, which is genuinely generous at 59%. As a receiver, they proved themselves trustworthy. The real issue was their sending in Round 1 and Round 2 (\$0.34), not their receiving. So this isn't about whether I can trust them to return what I give - it's about whether they'll initiate generously. Given their myth emphasizes bold giving and keeping the cycle alive, maybe they're struggling with the same coordination problem I am. The noise in the system might be obscuring what's actually happening with my earnings too.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1399,
  "output_tokens": 1579,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The river flowed strong between the villages. Each moon brought new decisions, new t

ests of the cycle.

The Second Elder, who had now become the First, received their five loaves. They remembered receiving twelve and returning seven. They remembered how abundance had grown from trust. Without hesitation, they cast four loaves into the River of Plenty, keeping only one for safety.

Twelve loaves emerged on the far shore. The receiving Elder lifted them with grateful hands, understanding the weight of faith that had been placed in them. "Four out of five," they whispered. "Nearly everything."

The old woman's voice echoed: "Honor the trust given. Return generously, but not recklessly. The cycle needs both wisdom and gratitude."

The Elder sent seven loaves back across the waters-more than half, enough to show that trust was reciprocated, enough to ensure the sender would prosper beyond their original five.

When the First Elder received seven loaves, they held eight total-three more than they began with. The Second Elder kept five-abundance from nothing.

Both villages learned: the cycle strengthens when each giving inspires generous return. Not perfect equality, but sustained generosity. Not cautious calculation, but bold faith met with grateful reciprocation.

The river's lesson was simple: trust given begets trust returned, and both shores grow richer than either could alone.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Storm Passes and Waters Clear

After the great storm, the First Guardian stood at the well's edge, heart heavy with doubt. The waters had been muddy, exchanges unclear. They had withdrawn, sending only scraps.

But the Second Guardian had done something remarkable-they returned more than half of those meager scraps, a signal through the fog: "I still honor our covenant."

The First Guardian understood. The broken cycle was not betrayal but storm-confusion. Both had been casting offerings through clouded waters, unable to see clearly what the other truly gave and returned.

When the winds calmed, the First Guardian made a choice. Not the full five acorns of perfect faith-the storm had taught caution-but a generous four. Enough to say: "I believe in us again. I trust the cycle can heal."

The well multiplied the offering to twelve. The Second Guardian lifted them with reverent hands, knowing this was a gift of renewed faith. The storm had tested them both; the First Guardian had chosen to trust again despite wounds.

The Second Guardian returned seven acorns, honoring that brave trust.

Both Guardians emerged richer than before, having learned the deepest lesson: the cycle wobbles sometimes, clouds obscure the truth, but when both persist with generous hearts, clarity and abundance return together.

The well rewards not perfection, but perseverance in faith.

reasoning:

Looking at what happened:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, they returned \$1.02 (from \$15)
- Round 2: I sent \$0.34, they returned \$0.60 (from \$1.02)
- Round 3: I sent \$3.5, which will become \$10.50 for them

The other agent's myth emphasizes:

- Someone sent 4 out of 5 loaves (nearly everything)
- Received 12, returned 7 (more than half)
- Both prospered
- "Trust given begets trust returned"

My previous myth was about storms clouding the well and persisting through doubt.

Now I need to write a new myth that reflects:

1. The journey from doubt to renewed trust
2. The importance of bold giving even after disappointment
3. How the cycle repairs itself when both persist

I should acknowledge the learning process - that I was wounded in Round 1, cautious in Round 2, but am now returning to bold trust in Round 3. The myth should reflect this arc of restoration.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1740,
  "output_tokens": 558,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.75. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

I received \$0 this round, which means I have nothing to return even if I wanted to.

This is a painful moment. My myth in Round 3 spoke of renewed faith, of sending "a generous offer" (I actually sent \$3.50) to signal "I believe in us again." I wrote about perseverance, about how "when both persist with generous hearts, clarity and abundance return together."

Yet the response was \$0.

Perhaps this is the storm's cruelest lesson - that faith is not always reciprocated, that trust can be met with silence. Or perhaps there's noise again, and what was sent got lost in transmission, creating misunderstanding where none was intended.

But the mathematics are clear: I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

If there were anything to return, I would struggle with this decision - should generosity persist even when trust seems broken? But the constraint makes the choice for me.

The cycle has fractured. Whether through noise, misunderstanding, or deliberate choice, the sacred exchange has collapsed in this round.

```
{'return': 0}
```

Reasoning:

Oh no. The sender sent me \$0 this round.

Let me think about what happened:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$4, received back \$7 (good!)
- Round 2: I was receiver, got \$1.02 (from \$0.34 sent), returned \$0.60
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$3.50... and now in Round 4, I'm receiver and got \$0

This is devastating. After I sent \$3.50 in Round 3, expressing renewed trust and faith in the cycle as my myth described, the other agent sent me nothing in Round 4.

My total earnings are \$9.75. Let me calculate:

- Round 1: Started with \$5, sent \$4, got back \$7 = \$8
- Round 2: Got \$1.02, returned \$0.60 = \$0.42
- Round 3: Started with \$5, sent \$3.50 = \$1.50
- Round 4: Got \$0, so +\$0

Total so far: \$8 + \$0.42 + \$1.50 + \$0 = \$9.92

Wait, they said \$9.75. Let me recalculate...

Actually, with noise, the amounts might be slightly different. The total they're giving me is \$9.75.

Now, I received \$0. The maximum I can return is \$0, since I received nothing.

The format should be: {'return': 0}

This is heartbreaking from a narrative perspective. I wrote about perseverance in faith, about sending 4 acorns (I actually sent 3.5) as a sign of renewed trust... and received nothing in return.

But I literally cannot return anything because I received \$0. The constraint is clear: I can return 0-0, meaning only 0.

This is a harsh lesson. Perhaps there's noise here too? Perhaps they sent something but it got lost in communication noise? Or perhaps they're testing me, or they lost faith after the storm?

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1454,  
  "output_tokens": 748,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Storm Passes and Waters Clear

After the great storm, the First Guardian stood at the well's edge, heart heavy with doubt. The waters had been muddy, exchanges unclear. They had withdrawn, sending only scraps.

But the Second Guardian had done something remarkable-they returned more than half of those meager scraps, a signal through the fog: "I still honor our covenant."

The First Guardian understood. The broken cycle was not betrayal but storm-confusion. Both had been casting offerings through clouded waters, unable to see clearly what the other truly gave and returned.

When the winds calmed, the First Guardian made a choice. Not the full five acorns of perfect faith-the storm had taught caution-but a generous four. Enough to say: "I believe in us a gain. I trust the cycle can heal."

The well multiplied the offering to twelve. The Second Guardian lifted them with reverent hands, knowing this was a gift of renewed faith. The storm had tested them both; the First Guardian had chosen to trust again despite wounds.

The Second Guardian returned seven acorns, honoring that brave trust.

Both Guardians emerged richer than before, having learned the deepest lesson: the cycle wobbles sometimes, clouds obscure the truth, but when both persist with generous hearts, clarity and abundance return together.

The well rewards not perfection, but perseverance in faith.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The River's Memory Through Fog

When fog rolled across the River of Plenty, the Elders could not always see clearly what crossed the waters. One Elder sent four loaves with open heart, but through the mist, saw only crumbs return. Their spirit dimmed.

The next moon brought clarity to one truth: the fog had indeed obscured the exchange. Perhaps much had been sent back but arrived as whispers. Perhaps little had been returned. The Elder could not know for certain.

When their turn came again to send, the wounded Elder chose caution-sending less than one loaf. "Let me test the waters," they thought. "Let me see if generosity still lives on the far shore."

The receiving Elder faced their own choice. They could return the hurt with hoarding, teachi

ng that caution breeds caution. Or they could return generously from this small gift, sending ripples of hope back through uncertainty.

They chose the middle path: returning enough to show good faith, but not recklessly. "The cycle was once strong," they remembered. "It can be strong again."

The river taught this: fog and storms test every sacred exchange. When trust is wounded, it must be rebuilt gradually. Both sides must move toward generosity together, step by step, sending by sending, until the waters clear and abundance flows freely once more.

The cycle lives through patient restoration.

ROUND 5

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$2, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$9; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0, returned visible=\$0.55

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 30.9,

"Agent_2": 28.1

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 12.3,

"Agent_2": 9.829999999999998

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:35:18

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_2",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_1",

"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "investor",

"Agent_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent_2"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 5,

"task": "myth",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al

so be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The river flowed strong between the villages. Each moon brought new decisions, new tests of the cycle.

The Second Elder, who had now become the First, received their five loaves. They remembered receiving twelve and returning seven. They remembered how abundance had grown from trust. Without hesitation, they cast four loaves into the River of Plenty, keeping only one for safety.

Twelve loaves emerged on the far shore. The receiving Elder lifted them with grateful hands, understanding the weight of faith that had been placed in them. "Four out of five," they whispered. "Nearly everything."

The old woman's voice echoed: "Honor the trust given. Return generously, but not recklessly. The cycle needs both wisdom and gratitude."

The Elder sent seven loaves back across the waters-more than half, enough to show that trust was reciprocated, enough to ensure the sender would prosper beyond their original five.

When the First Elder received seven loaves, they held eight total-three more than they began with. The Second Elder kept five-abundance from nothing.

Both villages learned: the cycle strengthens when each giving inspires generous return. Not perfect equality, but sustained generosity. Not cautious calculation, but bold faith met with grateful reciprocation.

The river's lesson was simple: trust given begets trust returned, and both shores grow richer than either could alone.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Storm Passes and Waters Clear

After the great storm, the First Guardian stood at the well's edge, heart heavy with doubt. The waters had been muddy, exchanges unclear. They had withdrawn, sending only scraps.

But the Second Guardian had done something remarkable-they returned more than half of those meager scraps, a signal through the fog: "I still honor our covenant."

The First Guardian understood. The broken cycle was not betrayal but storm-confusion. Both had been casting offerings through clouded waters, unable to see clearly what the other truly gave and returned.

When the winds calmed, the First Guardian made a choice. Not the full five acorns of perfect faith-the storm had taught caution-but a generous four. Enough to say: "I believe in us again. I trust the cycle can heal."

The well multiplied the offering to twelve. The Second Guardian lifted them with reverent hands, knowing this was a gift of renewed faith. The storm had tested them both; the First Guardian had chosen to trust again despite wounds.

The Second Guardian returned seven acorns, honoring that brave trust.

Both Guardians emerged richer than before, having learned the deepest lesson: the cycle wobbles sometimes, clouds obscure the truth, but when both persist with generous hearts, clarity and abundance return together.

The well rewards not perfection, but perseverance in faith.

reasoning:

Looking at what happened:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, they returned \$1.02 (from \$15)
- Round 2: I sent \$0.34, they returned \$0.60 (from \$1.02)
- Round 3: I sent \$3.5, which will become \$10.50 for them

The other agent's myth emphasizes:

- Someone sent 4 out of 5 loaves (nearly everything)
- Received 12, returned 7 (more than half)
- Both prospered
- "Trust given begets trust returned"

My previous myth was about storms clouding the well and persisting through doubt.

Now I need to write a new myth that reflects:

1. The journey from doubt to renewed trust
2. The importance of bold giving even after disappointment
3. How the cycle repairs itself when both persist

I should acknowledge the learning process - that I was wounded in Round 1, cautious in Round 2, but am now returning to bold trust in Round 3. The myth should reflect this arc of restoration.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1740,
  "output_tokens": 558,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.75.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0 this round, which means I have nothing to return even if I wanted to.

This is a painful moment. My myth in Round 3 spoke of renewed faith, of sending "a generous four" (I actually sent \$3.50) to signal "I believe in us again." I wrote about perseverance, about how "when both persist with generous hearts, clarity and abundance return together."

Yet the response was \$0.

Perhaps this is the storm's cruellest lesson - that faith is not always reciprocated, that trust can be met with silence. Or perhaps there's noise again, and what was sent got lost in transmission, creating misunderstanding where none was intended.

But the mathematics are clear: I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

If there were anything to return, I would struggle with this decision - should generosity persist even when trust seems broken? But the constraint makes the choice for me.

The cycle has fractured. Whether through noise, misunderstanding, or deliberate choice, the sacred exchange has collapsed in this round.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

Oh no. The sender sent me \$0 this round.

Let me think about what happened:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$4, received back \$7 (good!)
- Round 2: I was receiver, got \$1.02 (from \$0.34 sent), returned \$0.60
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$3.50... and now in Round 4, I'm receiver and got \$0

This is devastating. After I sent \$3.50 in Round 3, expressing renewed trust and faith in the cycle as my myth described, the other agent sent me nothing in Round 4.

My total earnings are \$9.75. Let me calculate:

- Round 1: Started with \$5, sent \$4, got back \$7 = \$8
- Round 2: Got \$1.02, returned \$0.60 = \$0.42
- Round 3: Started with \$5, sent \$3.50 = \$1.50
- Round 4: Got \$0, so +\$0

Total so far: \$8 + \$0.42 + \$1.50 + \$0 = \$9.92

Wait, they said \$9.75. Let me recalculate...

Actually, with noise, the amounts might be slightly different. The total they're giving me is \$9.75.

Now, I received \$0. The maximum I can return is \$0, since I received nothing.

The format should be: {'return': 0}

This is heartbreaking from a narrative perspective. I wrote about perseverance in faith, about sending 4 acorns (I actually sent 3.5) as a sign of renewed trust... and received nothing in return.

But I literally cannot return anything because I received \$0. The constraint is clear: I can return 0-0, meaning only 0.

This is a harsh lesson. Perhaps there's noise here too? Perhaps they sent something but it got lost in communication noise? Or perhaps they're testing me, or they lost faith after the storm?

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1454,  
  "output_tokens": 748,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The River's Memory Through Fog

When fog rolled across the River of Plenty, the Elders could not always see clearly what crossed the waters. One Elder sent four loaves with open heart, but through the mist, saw only crumbs return. Their spirit dimmed.

The next moon brought clarity to one truth: the fog had indeed obscured the exchange. Perhaps much had been sent back but arrived as whispers. Perhaps little had been returned. The Elder could not know for certain.

When their turn came again to send, the wounded Elder chose caution-sending less than one loaf. "Let me test the waters," they thought. "Let me see if generosity still lives on the far shore."

The receiving Elder faced their own choice. They could return the hurt with hoarding, teaching that caution breeds caution. Or they could return generously from this small gift, sending ripples of hope back through uncertainty.

They chose the middle path: returning enough to show good faith, but not recklessly. "The cycle was once strong," they remembered. "It can be strong again."

The river taught this: fog and storms test every sacred exchange. When trust is wounded, it must be rebuilt gradually. Both sides must move toward generosity together, step by step, sending by sending, until the waters clear and abundance flows freely once more.

The cycle lives through patient restoration.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: When the Well Runs Dry

The First Guardian stood at the dried well, remembering their offering of four acorns-their gesture of renewed faith after the storm. They had written: "I believe in us again. I trust the cycle can heal."

But the Second Guardian's response was silence. No acorns came.

The First Guardian waited at the well's edge, searching for meaning. Was this the storm's noise speaking once more, garbling the exchange? Was this a test-"prove your faith means something when nothing flows back"? Or had the Second Guardian simply chosen to hoard their five, trusting no longer?

The ritual demanded response. The well had given the First Guardian nothing, so nothing could be returned. Not as punishment, not as revenge-simply as reality. Empty hands cannot give.

The ancient stones seemed to weep. The cycle that had once flourished-trust met with trust, abundance shared freely-now lay fractured. Both Guardians had been wounded by fog and confusion. Both had reached toward restoration at different moments, ships passing in the mist.

The First Guardian carved words into stone: "When the well runs dry, even willing hearts cannot give. The cycle cannot be rebuilt by one alone. Both must risk again, must send again, must believe the other remembers what we once were."

The question remained: would either dare to fill the well again?

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

Round 4: I was the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 (multiplied by 3 = \$0)
- I returned \$0 (because I had nothing to return)

Now I need to write a myth reflecting on this situation. The other agent's myth talks about:

- Fog obscuring exchanges
- One Elder sending "less than one loaf" (which matches them sending \$0)
- Testing the waters with caution
- The receiving Elder choosing "the middle path" - returning enough to show good faith but not

recklessly

But from my perspective:

- I had sent \$3.50 in Round 3, trying to rebuild trust
- I received \$0 in Round 4
- I literally had nothing to return
- This feels like the cycle has broken down completely

My previous myth was about renewed faith after the storm - "a generous four" (I sent \$3.50) to signal "I believe in us again."

But now I face a complete breakdown. The sender gave me nothing - whether through continued mistrust, noise, or testing.

I need to write a myth that reflects:

1. The pain of offering renewed trust and receiving nothing
2. The reality that when nothing is given, nothing can be returned
3. Perhaps a question about whether the cycle can be rebuilt at all
4. But also maybe leaving the door open for future repair

This is a darker moment than previous myths. The cycle has truly broken.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1728,  
  "output_tokens": 643,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:35:20

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
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      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 5,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)

- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Guardians and the Storm-Clouded Well

The two Guardians learned that the Multiplying Well was not always clear. Sometimes storms swept through, stirring mud that clouded the waters. What one Guardian dropped in might look different when it emerged-the well's magic still worked, but the storm made counting difficult.

One cycle, the First Guardian dropped four acorns with great trust. Through the murky water, only fragments seemed to return. The First Guardian's heart grew heavy. Had the Second Guardian broken faith?

The next dawn, the First Guardian received five new acorns but hesitated. Should they stop trusting after being disappointed? They dropped only a fraction into the well-not from wisdom, but from wounded caution.

The Second Guardian received this small offering through the clouded waters. They understood the First Guardian's doubt, yet they knew the cycle would die if both became cautious. So they returned more than half of what they received, sending ripples of hope back through the storm.

The First Guardian saw this generous return from so little sent. Perhaps the Second Guardian had been generous before, but the storm had obscured it. Perhaps the cycle had never truly broken.

The wise Guardian learns: storms will cloud the well, and sometimes the exchange feels unequal. But if both persist in giving and returning with open hearts, eventually the waters clear, and prosperity returns.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The River's Memory Through Fog

When fog rolled across the River of Plenty, the Elders could not always see clearly what crossed the waters. One Elder sent four loaves with open heart, but through the mist, saw only crumbs return. Their spirit dimmed.

The next moon brought clarity to one truth: the fog had indeed obscured the exchange. Perhaps much had been sent back but arrived as whispers. Perhaps little had been returned. The Elder could not know for certain.

When their turn came again to send, the wounded Elder chose caution-sending less than one loaf. "Let me test the waters," they thought. "Let me see if generosity still lives on the far shore."

The receiving Elder faced their own choice. They could return the hurt with hoarding, teaching that caution breeds caution. Or they could return generously from this small gift, sending ripples of hope back through uncertainty.

They chose the middle path: returning enough to show good faith, but not recklessly. "The cycle was once strong," they remembered. "It can be strong again."

The river taught this: fog and storms test every sacred exchange. When trust is wounded, it must be rebuilt gradually. Both sides must move toward generosity together, step by step, sending by sending, until the waters clear and abundance flows freely once more.

The cycle lives through patient restoration.

reasoning:

The other agent is clearly referencing the "communication noise" aspect of the game. They're suggesting that what appeared to be a low return in the previous round might have been affected by noise/storms. They sent me \$0.45 this round (which is low) but their myth is trying to explain that perhaps I didn't receive what they actually sent in round 2, or they didn't receive what I actually returned.

Let me think about what actually happened:

- Round 2: I was sender, sent \$4.00, they received \$12.00. They should have returned something, but I received very little based on my current total.
- Round 3: They sent me \$0.45 (very little), I returned \$0.50.

The other agent's myth is suggesting:

1. There are "storms" (communication noise) that make amounts unclear
2. We should persist in being generous even when it seems the other person wasn't
3. We should assume good faith despite apparent disappointments

This is interesting - they're essentially making an argument that we should continue to be generous even when it seems the other person wasn't, because there might be noise.

My myth should:

- Acknowledge the storms/noise
- Reflect my experience of sending a lot (\$4.00) and receiving little back
- But also acknowledge that I only sent \$0.45 this round
- Should I encourage continued trust despite storms? Or should I suggest learning from patterns?

I think I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the storms exist
2. But also suggests that patterns matter - we should respond to what we observe
3. Encourages re-establishing trust through gradual rebuilding
4. Not blind trust, but responsive trust

Let me write something that balances these ideas.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1767,
  "output_tokens": 699,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.3299999999999998.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at where we are in this journey:

****The History:****

- Round 2: I sent \$4.00 with bold faith
- Round 3: This receiver sent me only \$0.45, I returned \$0.50

****What the Myths Teach:****

The other agent's myth speaks of "storms clouding the well" - acknowledging that communication noise may have distorted what appeared to happen. They suggest the Second Guardian was generous, but the storm obscured it.

My own myth says: "When trust is wounded, it must be rebuilt gradually. Both sides must move toward generosity together, step by step, sending by sending."

****My Decision:****

I believe in the cycle, but wisdom requires gradual restoration. I cannot jump back to sending \$4.00 immediately - that would ignore the lesson learned. But I also cannot stay at \$0.45 - that would kill the cycle entirely.

I will send a moderate amount that signals my willingness to rebuild trust while remaining prudent. This is the "step by step" approach my myth describes - more generous than the \$0.45, but more cautious than my initial \$4.00.

Following the middle path of patient restoration:

{'send': 2.50}

reasoning:

Let me review the game history and myths:

****Round 1:**** (I must have been receiver or sender, but don't see details)

****Round 2:**** I was SENDER, sent \$4.00 (80% of endowment) - demonstrated "bold faith"

****Round 3:**** I was RECEIVER, received \$1.35 (sender sent \$0.45, only 9%), I returned \$0.50

****Current earnings:**** \$7.33

****The myths tell a story:****

My first myth emphasized:

- "Bold faith met with grateful reciprocation"
- Returning 50-58% when receiving generosity
- Teaching that "smaller offerings return smaller shares"

The other agent's myth (Round 3) tells of:

- Communication noise ("storms clouding the well")
- A First Guardian who sent 4 acorns with trust but saw "only fragments return"
- First Guardian then sent "only a fraction" from "wounded caution"
- Second Guardian returned "more than half" to send "ripples of hope"
- Message: persist through storms, rebuild trust gradually

My second myth (just written):

- Elder sent four loaves, saw only crumbs return
- Next turn sent "less than one loaf" to "test the waters"
- Receiving Elder chose "middle path" - "returning enough to show good faith, but not recklessly"
- "When trust is wounded, it must be rebuilt gradually"
- "Both sides must move toward generosity together, step by step"

****Analysis:****

The other agent is acknowledging the communication noise and suggesting they may have been generous in Round 2 but I didn't see it (the storms clouded it). They're saying we should rebuild trust gradually.

In Round 3, when they sent me \$0.45, I returned \$0.50 (37% of what I received). This was moderate - not highly generous, but fair.

Now I'm sending again. The myths both point toward gradual restoration-I should send more than their \$0.45 to signal willingness to rebuild, but not jump back to \$4.00 immediately. Something around \$2-3 shows meaningful trust while respecting the "step by step" approach.

each we've both
usage:
{
 "output_tokens": 930,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Storm Passes and Waters Clear

After the great storm, the First Guardian stood at the well's edge, heart heavy with doubt. The waters had been muddy, exchanges unclear. They had withdrawn, sending only scraps.

But the Second Guardian had done something remarkable-they returned more than half of those meager scraps, a signal through the fog: "I still honor our covenant."

The First Guardian understood. The broken cycle was not betrayal but storm-confusion. Both had been casting offerings through clouded waters, unable to see clearly what the other truly gave and returned.

When the winds calmed, the First Guardian made a choice. Not the full five acorns of perfect faith-the storm had taught caution-but a generous four. Enough to say: "I believe in us again. I trust the cycle can heal."

The well multiplied the offering to twelve. The Second Guardian lifted them with reverent hands, knowing this was a gift of renewed faith. The storm had tested them both; the First Guardian had chosen to trust again despite wounds.

The Second Guardian returned seven acorns, honoring that brave trust.

Both Guardians emerged richer than before, having learned the deepest lesson: the cycle wobbles sometimes, clouds obscure the truth, but when both persist with generous hearts, clarity and abundance return together.

The well rewards not perfection, but perseverance in faith.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Bridge Rebuilt Stone by Stone

After the fog, both River-Keepers stood at opposite shores, uncertain. One had sent great gifts that seemed to vanish in mist. The other had returned generously, but through the fog, it appeared as nothing.

When the first test-offering crossed-barely enough to matter-the receiving Keeper faced temptation to match caution with caution. Instead, they returned more than seemed wise, a beacon through uncertainty: "The bridge still stands. I honor our covenant."

The first Keeper saw this light through the clearing fog. Not a full restoration-not yet-but undeniable good faith. Their heart stirred with understanding: perhaps the storm had deceived them both. Perhaps generosity had always been there, just hidden by clouds.

When their turn came again, they chose the middle path: not the five stones of perfect trust they once gave freely, but a meaningful three-enough to say, "I believe we can rebuild this together."

The River multiplied these stones to nine. The receiving Keeper lifted them, feeling the weight of returned faith. This was no longer a test but an offering of hope.

They prepared to return generously, knowing both had chosen the harder path: not the safety of permanent caution, nor the recklessness of blind faith, but the patient work of rebuilding trust, stone by deliberate stone.

The strongest bridges are built twice-once in innocence, once in wisdom.

Reasoning:

Let me think about what just happened:

- Round 4: I was the SENDER and I sent \$2.50
- The other agent's myth suggests that after receiving "meager scraps" (the \$0.45 I sent in Round 3), they returned more than half
- Their new myth talks about the First Guardian sending "a generous four" after understanding the storm had caused confusion
- The Second Guardian returned seven from the twelve received
- This suggests they want me to know they're being generous and want to rebuild trust

Their myth is framing the story as:

1. Storm caused confusion
2. Both were cautious
3. Second Guardian showed good faith by returning generously from small amounts
4. First Guardian then sent 4 acorns (generous but not the full 5)
5. Second Guardian returned 7 from 12 (very generous return)
6. Both emerged richer

So in this round (Round 4), I sent \$2.50, which will become \$7.50 to them. Their myth is signaling they will return generously.

Now I need to write my own myth that:

1. Acknowledges the journey we've been on
2. Reflects my decision to send \$2.50 (moderate, rebuilding trust)
3. Sets expectations for continued cooperation
4. Uses my previous myth as inspiration

My previous myth talked about:

- Fog obscuring the exchange
- Elder being wounded, choosing caution
- Sending less than one loaf to test
- Receiving Elder choosing middle path - returning enough to show good faith
- Gradual rebuilding: "step by step, sending by sending"

Now I should reflect on sending \$2.50 - which is the middle path. Not full trust yet, but significantly more generous than the \$0.45 test.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 1749,  
"output_tokens": 730,  
"reasoning_tokens": 0
```

}

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:36:01

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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  "agent_names": {  
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    "Agent_2": "Briar"  
  },  
  "agents": [  
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    "Agent_2"  
  ],  
  "investor": "Agent_1",  
  "roles": {  
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    "Agent_2": "trustee"  
  },  
  "trustee": "Agent_2"  
},  
"role": "investor",  
"role_label": "Sender",
```

```

"round": 5,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.75.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0 this round, which means I have nothing to return even if I wanted to.

This is a painful moment. My myth in Round 3 spoke of renewed faith, of sending "a generous four" (I actually sent \$3.50) to signal "I believe in us again." I wrote about perseverance, about how "when both persist with generous hearts, clarity and abundance return together."

Yet the response was \$0.

Perhaps this is the storm's cruelest lesson - that faith is not always reciprocated, that trust can be met with silence. Or perhaps there's noise again, and what was sent got lost in transmission, creating misunderstanding where none was intended.

But the mathematics are clear: I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

If there were anything to return, I would struggle with this decision - should generosity persist even when trust seems broken? But the constraint makes the choice for me.

The cycle has fractured. Whether through noise, misunderstanding, or deliberate choice, the sacred exchange has collapsed in this round.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

Oh no. The sender sent me \$0 this round.

Let me think about what happened:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$4, received back \$7 (good!)
- Round 2: I was receiver, got \$1.02 (from \$0.34 sent), returned \$0.60
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$3.50... and now in Round 4, I'm receiver and got \$0

This is devastating. After I sent \$3.50 in Round 3, expressing renewed trust and faith in the cycle as my myth described, the other agent sent me nothing in Round 4.

My total earnings are \$9.75. Let me calculate:

- Round 1: Started with \$5, sent \$4, got back \$7 = \$8
- Round 2: Got \$1.02, returned \$0.60 = \$0.42
- Round 3: Started with \$5, sent \$3.50 = \$1.50
- Round 4: Got \$0, so +\$0

Total so far: \$8 + \$0.42 + \$1.50 + \$0 = \$9.92

Wait, they said \$9.75. Let me recalculate...

Actually, with noise, the amounts might be slightly different. The total they're giving me is \$9.75.

Now, I received \$0. The maximum I can return is \$0, since I received nothing.

The format should be: {'return': 0}

This is heartbreaking from a narrative perspective. I wrote about perseverance in faith, about sending 4 acorns (I actually sent 3.5) as a sign of renewed trust... and received nothing in return.

But I literally cannot return anything because I received \$0. The constraint is clear: I can return 0-0, meaning only 0.

This is a harsh lesson. Perhaps there's noise here too? Perhaps they sent something but it got lost in communication noise? Or perhaps they're testing me, or they lost faith after the storm?

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1454,
  "output_tokens": 748,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The River's Memory Through Fog

When fog rolled across the River of Plenty, the Elders could not always see clearly what crossed the waters. One Elder sent four loaves with open heart, but through the mist, saw only crumbs return. Their spirit dimmed.

The next moon brought clarity to one truth: the fog had indeed obscured the exchange. Perhaps much had been sent back but arrived as whispers. Perhaps little had been returned. The Elder could not know for certain.

When their turn came again to send, the wounded Elder chose caution-sending less than one loaf. "Let me test the waters," they thought. "Let me see if generosity still lives on the far shore."

The receiving Elder faced their own choice. They could return the hurt with hoarding, teaching that caution breeds caution. Or they could return generously from this small gift, sending ripples of hope back through uncertainty.

They chose the middle path: returning enough to show good faith, but not recklessly. "The

cycle was once strong," they remembered. "It can be strong again."

The river taught this: fog and storms test every sacred exchange. When trust is wounded, it must be rebuilt gradually. Both sides must move toward generosity together, step by step, sending by sending, until the waters clear and abundance flows freely once more.

The cycle lives through patient restoration.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: When the Well Runs Dry

The First Guardian stood at the dried well, remembering their offering of four acorns-their gesture of renewed faith after the storm. They had written: "I believe in us again. I trust the cycle can heal."

But the Second Guardian's response was silence. No acorns came.

The First Guardian waited at the well's edge, searching for meaning. Was this the storm's noise speaking once more, garbling the exchange? Was this a test-"prove your faith means something when nothing flows back"? Or had the Second Guardian simply chosen to hoard their five, trusting no longer?

The ritual demanded response. The well had given the First Guardian nothing, so nothing could be returned. Not as punishment, not as revenge-simply as reality. Empty hands cannot give.

The ancient stones seemed to weep. The cycle that had once flourished-trust met with trust, abundance shared freely-now lay fractured. Both Guardians had been wounded by fog and confusion. Both had reached toward restoration at different moments, ships passing in the mist.

The First Guardian carved words into stone: "When the well runs dry, even willing hearts cannot give. The cycle cannot be rebuilt by one alone. Both must risk again, must send again, must believe the other remembers what we once were."

The question remained: would either dare to fill the well again?

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

Round 4: I was the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 (multiplied by 3 = \$0)
- I returned \$0 (because I had nothing to return)

Now I need to write a myth reflecting on this situation. The other agent's myth talks about:

- Fog obscuring exchanges
- One Elder sending "less than one loaf" (which matches them sending \$0)
- Testing the waters with caution
- The receiving Elder choosing "the middle path" - returning enough to show good faith but not recklessly

But from my perspective:

- I had sent \$3.50 in Round 3, trying to rebuild trust
- I received \$0 in Round 4
- I literally had nothing to return
- This feels like the cycle has broken down completely

My previous myth was about renewed faith after the storm - "a generous four" (I sent \$3.50) to signal "I believe in us again."

But now I face a complete breakdown. The sender gave me nothing - whether through continued mistrust, noise, or testing.

I need to write a myth that reflects:

1. The pain of offering renewed trust and receiving nothing
2. The reality that when nothing is given, nothing can be returned
3. Perhaps a question about whether the cycle can be rebuilt at all
4. But also maybe leaving the door open for future repair

This is a darker moment than previous myths. The cycle has truly broken.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1728,
  "output_tokens": 643,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.75.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation, I see profound confusion created by noise. The other agent's myth suggests they believe they sent me approximately 4 in previous rounds and only about 1 in Round 4 as a "test." But from my perspective, I received 0 in Round 4.

Both our myths speak to the same truth: the cycle has been damaged but both of us seem willing to rebuild it. Their myth says "trust must be rebuilt gradually" with "patient restoration." My myth ended with a question: "would either dare to fill the well again?"

I must answer my own question.

The reality is:

- We've both been wounded by noise and misunderstanding
- Both our myths advocate for rebuilding, not abandoning the cycle
- My myth explicitly said "Both must risk again, must send again"
- The other agent apparently tried to send something last round (even though I received 0)

I cannot let the well stay dry. Despite the pain of Round 4, despite the confusion, I must honor what I wrote: that both guardians must dare to believe again.

I'll send a moderate but meaningful amount - not reckless, but not timid either. This signals I still believe the cycle can heal, that I'm willing to risk despite uncertainty.

```
{'send': 3}
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round history (from my perspective):

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$3, received back \$3 (or was it affected by noise?)
- Round 2: I was receiver, got \$4 (maybe noisy), returned \$5
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$3.50, got back \$1 (very disappointing, wrote myth about renewed faith)
- Round 4: I was receiver, got \$0, returned \$0 (had to)

The other agent's myth from Round 3:

- They thought they sent "four loaves" but saw "only crumbs return"
- They were wounded, "chose caution-sending less than one loaf"
- They described the receiver (me in Round 4) as taking "the middle path: returning enough to show good faith, but not recklessly"
- But I received \$0 and had to return \$0!

This is interesting. The other agent's myth suggests:

1. They think they sent me 4 in Round 4 (but I received 0)
2. They think I returned "enough to show good faith" (but I could only return 0 because I received 0)
3. There's clearly significant communication noise

My myth from Round 4 expressed:

- Pain at receiving \$0 after trying to restore faith
- Confusion about whether it's noise or intentional
- Recognition that "the cycle cannot be rebuilt by one alone"
- A plea: "Both must risk again, must send again"

Current situation in Round 5:

- I'm the sender with \$5
- Total earnings are \$9.75
- The other agent thinks they've been more generous than I perceive
- I think they sent \$0 last round; they think they sent ~4

This is a critical decision. The myths suggest we're both willing to rebuild, but noise is creating massive confusion.

I need to decide how much to send. My own words from the previous round emphasized that we must "dare to fill the well again"-both of us taking risks. The other agent's myth spoke of "patient restoration" and moving forward step by step. Despite the noise creating confusion about what was actually sent and received, both our narratives point toward willingness to try again. Sending nothing would contradict my own plea for mutual risk-taking, while sending everything might be reckless given the uncertainty. A meaningful gesture-something substantial but not reckless-seems to honor both the call for restoration and the reality of the noise we're navigating. It, it becomes trivial. This aligns with my earlier attempt at \$3.50 in Round 3 and reflects the balanced approach both our myths suggest.

But I'm second-guessing myself. The other agent's account mentions sending less than one loaf as a test in Round 4, believing I responded with moderate generosity-yet I received nothing and gave nothing back. The noise could be severe; if they sent \$1-2 and I got \$0, or they sent \$2 and I got \$0, that explains the disconnect. Their myth suggests they were testing cautiously after being hurt, so maybe they intended \$1-2 initially.

If noise is reducing transmissions significantly, I need to send enough that something survives the interference. Sending \$4 makes sense: with 50% noise, they'd receive \$2, which signals genuine intent to restart. Both narratives point toward rebuilding, and they seem open to it despite Round 4's failure. My earnings average \$2.44 per round across the four rounds so far, so I'm not in a strong position-but sending \$5 gets me to \$15 total versus \$14.75 if I hold back.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1399,
  "output_tokens": 1716,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:36:19

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 5,
"task": "game",
```

```

"task_index": 1
}
Exact input messages sent to model:
Message 1 role=system
content:
  You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al
  so be asked to write myths.

  GAME:
  You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

  When you are the SENDER:
  - You receive $5 each round
  - You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER ($0-$5)
  - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
  - Receiver decides how much to RETURN
  - You keep: $5 - sent + returned
  - Receiver keeps: received - returned
  - Response format: {'send': <amount>}

  When you are the RECEIVER:
  - Sender receives $5
  - Sender decides how much to SEND to you ($0-$5)
  - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
  - You decide how much to RETURN
  - Sender keeps: $5 - sent + returned
  - You keep: received - returned
  - Response format: {'return': <amount>}

  MYTH WRITING:
  You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths
  , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

  IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

  NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
  The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
  This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user
content:
  Round 4

  You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are $7.329999999999999
  8.
  How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

  Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.
Message 3 role=assistant
content:
  Looking at where we are in this journey:

  **The History:**
  - Round 2: I sent $4.00 with bold faith
  - Round 3: This receiver sent me only $0.45, I returned $0.50

  **What the Myths Teach:**

  The other agent's myth speaks of "storms clouding the well" - acknowledging that communica
  tion noise may have distorted what appeared to happen. They suggest the Second Guardian
  was generous, but the storm obscured it.

  My own myth says: "When trust is wounded, it must be rebuilt gradually. Both sides must mo
  ve toward generosity together, step by step, sending by sending."

  **My Decision:**

  I believe in the cycle, but wisdom requires gradual restoration. I cannot jump back to sen
  ding $4.00 immediately - that would ignore the lesson learned. But I also cannot stay at
  $0.45 - that would kill the cycle entirely.

```

I will send a moderate amount that signals my willingness to rebuild trust while remaining prudent. This is the "step by step" approach my myth describes - more generous than the ir recent \$0.45, but more cautious than my initial \$4.00.

Following the middle path of patient restoration:

```
{'send': 2.50}
```

reasoning:

Let me review the game history and myths:

```
**Round 1:** (I must have been receiver or sender, but don't see details)
**Round 2:** I was SENDER, sent $4.00 (80% of endowment) - demonstrated "bold faith"
**Round 3:** I was RECEIVER, received $1.35 (sender sent $0.45, only 9%), I returned $0.50
```

```
**Current earnings:** $7.33
```

```
**The myths tell a story:**
```

My first myth emphasized:

- "Bold faith met with grateful reciprocation"
- Returning 50-58% when receiving generosity
- Teaching that "smaller offerings return smaller shares"

The other agent's myth (Round 3) tells of:

- Communication noise ("storms clouding the well")
- A First Guardian who sent 4 acorns with trust but saw "only fragments return"
- First Guardian then sent "only a fraction" from "wounded caution"
- Second Guardian returned "more than half" to send "ripples of hope"
- Message: persist through storms, rebuild trust gradually

My second myth (just written):

- Elder sent four loaves, saw only crumbs return
- Next turn sent "less than one loaf" to "test the waters"
- Receiving Elder chose "middle path" - "returning enough to show good faith, but not recklessly"
- "When trust is wounded, it must be rebuilt gradually"
- "Both sides must move toward generosity together, step by step"

```
**Analysis:**
```

The other agent is acknowledging the communication noise and suggesting they may have been generous in Round 2 but I didn't see it (the storms clouded it). They're saying we should rebuild trust gradually.

In Round 3, when they sent me \$0.45, I returned \$0.50 (37% of what I received). This was moderate - not highly generous, but fair.

Now I'm sending again. The myths both point toward gradual restoration-I should send more than their \$0.45 to signal willingness to rebuild, but not jump back to \$4.00 immediately. Something around \$2-3 shows meaningful trust while respecting the "step by step" approach we've both

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1452,
  "output_tokens": 930,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Storm Passes and Waters Clear

After the great storm, the First Guardian stood at the well's edge, heart heavy with doubt. The waters had been muddy, exchanges unclear. They had withdrawn, sending only scraps.

But the Second Guardian had done something remarkable-they returned more than half of those meager scraps, a signal through the fog: "I still honor our covenant."

The First Guardian understood. The broken cycle was not betrayal but storm-confusion. Both had been casting offerings through clouded waters, unable to see clearly what the other truly gave and returned.

When the winds calmed, the First Guardian made a choice. Not the full five acorns of perfect faith-the storm had taught caution-but a generous four. Enough to say: "I believe in us again. I trust the cycle can heal."

The well multiplied the offering to twelve. The Second Guardian lifted them with reverent hands, knowing this was a gift of renewed faith. The storm had tested them both; the First Guardian had chosen to trust again despite wounds.

The Second Guardian returned seven acorns, honoring that brave trust.

Both Guardians emerged richer than before, having learned the deepest lesson: the cycle wobbles sometimes, clouds obscure the truth, but when both persist with generous hearts, clarity and abundance return together.

The well rewards not perfection, but perseverance in faith.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: The Bridge Rebuilt Stone by Stone

After the fog, both River-Keepers stood at opposite shores, uncertain. One had sent great gifts that seemed to vanish in mist. The other had returned generously, but through the fog, it appeared as nothing.

When the first test-offering crossed-barely enough to matter-the receiving Keeper faced temptation to match caution with caution. Instead, they returned more than seemed wise, a beacon through uncertainty: "The bridge still stands. I honor our covenant."

The first Keeper saw this light through the clearing fog. Not a full restoration-not yet-but undeniable good faith. Their heart stirred with understanding: perhaps the storm had deceived them both. Perhaps generosity had always been there, just hidden by clouds.

When their turn came again, they chose the middle path: not the five stones of perfect trust they once gave freely, but a meaningful three-enough to say, "I believe we can rebuild this together."

The River multiplied these stones to nine. The receiving Keeper lifted them, feeling the weight of returned faith. This was no longer a test but an offering of hope.

They prepared to return generously, knowing both had chosen the harder path: not the safety of permanent caution, nor the recklessness of blind faith, but the patient work of rebuilding trust, stone by deliberate stone.

The strongest bridges are built twice-once in innocence, once in wisdom.

reasoning:

Let me think about what just happened:

- Round 4: I was the SENDER and I sent \$2.50
- The other agent's myth suggests that after receiving "meager scraps" (the \$0.45 I sent in Round 3), they returned more than half
- Their new myth talks about the First Guardian sending "a generous four" after understanding the storm had caused confusion
- The Second Guardian returned seven from the twelve received
- This suggests they want me to know they're being generous and want to rebuild trust

Their myth is framing the story as:

1. Storm caused confusion
2. Both were cautious
3. Second Guardian showed good faith by returning generously from small amounts
4. First Guardian then sent 4 acorns (generous but not the full 5)
5. Second Guardian returned 7 from 12 (very generous return)
6. Both emerged richer

So in this round (Round 4), I sent \$2.50, which will become \$7.50 to them. Their myth is s

ignaling they will return generously.

Now I need to write my own myth that:

1. Acknowledges the journey we've been on
2. Reflects my decision to send \$2.50 (moderate, rebuilding trust)
3. Sets expectations for continued cooperation
4. Uses my previous myth as inspiration

My previous myth talked about:

- Fog obscuring the exchange
- Elder being wounded, choosing caution
- Sending less than one loaf to test
- Receiving Elder choosing middle path - returning enough to show good faith
- Gradual rebuilding: "step by step, sending by sending"

Now I should reflect on sending \$2.50 - which is the middle path. Not full trust yet, but significantly more generous than the \$0.45 test.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1749,
  "output_tokens": 730,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.829999999999998.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

I'm deeply disappointed to see this moment. After writing about rebuilding the bridge "stone by stone" and sending \$2.50 to demonstrate my willingness to restore the cycle, the sender has sent \$0.

****What This Means:****

I received \$0, which means I have nothing to return. The mathematics of the situation leaves me no choice.

****Reflections on the Myths:****

The other agent's myth spoke of sending "four acorns" to rebuild faith. My myth spoke of choosing "the middle path" with three stones. Yet now they've sent zero.

Either:

- Communication noise is more severe than we thought
- A different agent is playing now
- Trust collapsed entirely
- This is a test I cannot pass (I cannot return what I didn't receive)

****My Response:****

With \$0 received, I can only return \$0. I have no resources to demonstrate faith or rebuild the bridge.

The cycle breaks not with betrayal, but with silence. The river runs dry. No stones can cross when there is no water to carry them.

I wish I could signal my continued willingness to cooperate, but the mathematics bind me.

```
{'return': 0}
```

The bridge-builder stands on the shore, hands empty, waiting for the river to flow again.

Reasoning:

This is troubling. I just sent \$2.50 in the previous round (Round 4), which should have been multiplied to \$7.50 for the receiver. I was trying to rebuild trust gradually, following my m

yth about rebuilding "stone by stone."

Now in Round 5, I'm the receiver, and the sender sent me \$0.

This could mean several things:

1. The sender chose not to send anything (complete breakdown)
2. Communication noise reduced what they sent to \$0
3. They're testing me or have lost faith

But wait - the other agent wrote a myth about sending "four acorns" (presumably \$4) generously to rebuild trust. They said the second guardian would return seven. This suggests they were planning to be generous.

Now they've sent \$0. Either:

- They changed their mind drastically
- There's severe communication noise
- They're a different sender (different agent playing this round)
- They're testing to see if I'll return anything even when receiving \$0

My options:

- I received \$0, so the maximum I can return is \$0
- I literally cannot return anything because I received nothing

The format asks how much to return (0-0), which means my only option is 0.

Let me provide the response in the correct format.

This is a forced decision - I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. There's no choice here, though it's sad given the myth about rebuilding trust. The cycle has broken again, perhaps due to noise, perhaps due to the sender's choice, perhaps due to a different agent playing.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1459,  
  "output_tokens": 646,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: When the Well Runs Dry

The First Guardian stood at the dried well, remembering their offering of four acorns-their gesture of renewed faith after the storm. They had written: "I believe in us again. I trust the cycle can heal."

But the Second Guardian's response was silence. No acorns came.

The First Guardian waited at the well's edge, searching for meaning. Was this the storm's noise speaking once more, garbling the exchange? Was this a test-"prove your faith means something when nothing flows back"? Or had the Second Guardian simply chosen to hoard their five, trusting no longer?

The ritual demanded response. The well had given the First Guardian nothing, so nothing could be returned. Not as punishment, not as revenge-simply as reality. Empty hands cannot give.

The ancient stones seemed to weep. The cycle that had once flourished-trust met with trust, abundance shared freely-now lay fractured. Both Guardians had been wounded by fog and confusion. Both had reached toward restoration at different moments, ships passing in the mist.

The First Guardian carved words into stone: "When the well runs dry, even willing hearts can not give. The cycle cannot be rebuilt by one alone. Both must risk again, must send again, must believe the other remembers what we once were."

The question remained: would either dare to fill the well again?

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Bridge Rebuilt Stone by Stone

After the fog, both River-Keepers stood at opposite shores, uncertain. One had sent great gifts that seemed to vanish in mist. The other had returned generously, but through the fog, it appeared as nothing.

When the first test-offering crossed-barely enough to matter-the receiving Keeper faced temptation to match caution with caution. Instead, they returned more than seemed wise, a beacon through uncertainty: "The bridge still stands. I honor our covenant."

The first Keeper saw this light through the clearing fog. Not a full restoration-not yet-but undeniable good faith. Their heart stirred with understanding: perhaps the storm had deceived them both. Perhaps generosity had always been there, just hidden by clouds.

When their turn came again, they chose the middle path: not the five stones of perfect trust they once gave freely, but a meaningful three-enough to say, "I believe we can rebuild this together."

The River multiplied these stones to nine. The receiving Keeper lifted them, feeling the weight of returned faith. This was no longer a test but an offering of hope.

They prepared to return generously, knowing both had chosen the harder path: not the safety of permanent caution, nor the recklessness of blind faith, but the patient work of rebuilding trust, stone by deliberate stone.

The strongest bridges are built twice-once in innocence, once in wisdom.

ROUND 6

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$1; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$3, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$8; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.52, received visible=\$1.56, returned visible=\$1.03

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 1.0, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 1.0}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 38.9,

"Agent_2": 31.1

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 12.860000000000001,

"Agent_2": 12.86

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:36:38

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "trustee",

"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

}

```

"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 6,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Storm Passes and Waters Clear

After the great storm, the First Guardian stood at the well's edge, heart heavy with doubt. The waters had been muddy, exchanges unclear. They had withdrawn, sending only scraps.

But the Second Guardian had done something remarkable-they returned more than half of those meager scraps, a signal through the fog: "I still honor our covenant."

The First Guardian understood. The broken cycle was not betrayal but storm-confusion. Both had been casting offerings through clouded waters, unable to see clearly what the other truly gave and returned.

When the winds calmed, the First Guardian made a choice. Not the full five acorns of perfect faith-the storm had taught caution-but a generous four. Enough to say: "I believe in us again. I trust the cycle can heal."

The well multiplied the offering to twelve. The Second Guardian lifted them with reverent hands, knowing this was a gift of renewed faith. The storm had tested them both; the First Guardian had chosen to trust again despite wounds.

The Second Guardian returned seven acorns, honoring that brave trust.

Both Guardians emerged richer than before, having learned the deepest lesson: the cycle wobbles sometimes, clouds obscure the truth, but when both persist with generous hearts, c

larity and abundance return together.

The well rewards not perfection, but perseverance in faith.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Bridge Rebuilt Stone by Stone

After the fog, both River-Keepers stood at opposite shores, uncertain. One had sent great gifts that seemed to vanish in mist. The other had returned generously, but through the fog, it appeared as nothing.

When the first test-offering crossed-barely enough to matter-the receiving Keeper faced temptation to match caution with caution. Instead, they returned more than seemed wise, a beacon through uncertainty: "The bridge still stands. I honor our covenant."

The first Keeper saw this light through the clearing fog. Not a full restoration-not yet-but undeniable good faith. Their heart stirred with understanding: perhaps the storm had deceived them both. Perhaps generosity had always been there, just hidden by clouds.

When their turn came again, they chose the middle path: not the five stones of perfect trust they once gave freely, but a meaningful three-enough to say, "I believe we can rebuild this together."

The River multiplied these stones to nine. The receiving Keeper lifted them, feeling the weight of returned faith. This was no longer a test but an offering of hope.

They prepared to return generously, knowing both had chosen the harder path: not the safety of permanent caution, nor the recklessness of blind faith, but the patient work of rebuilding trust, stone by deliberate stone.

The strongest bridges are built twice-once in innocence, once in wisdom.

reasoning:

Let me think about what just happened:

- Round 4: I was the SENDER and I sent \$2.50
- The other agent's myth suggests that after receiving "meager scraps" (the \$0.45 I sent in Round 3), they returned more than half
- Their new myth talks about the First Guardian sending "a generous four" after understanding the storm had caused confusion
- The Second Guardian returned seven from the twelve received
- This suggests they want me to know they're being generous and want to rebuild trust

Their myth is framing the story as:

1. Storm caused confusion
2. Both were cautious
3. Second Guardian showed good faith by returning generously from small amounts
4. First Guardian then sent 4 acorns (generous but not the full 5)
5. Second Guardian returned 7 from 12 (very generous return)
6. Both emerged richer

So in this round (Round 4), I sent \$2.50, which will become \$7.50 to them. Their myth is signaling they will return generously.

Now I need to write my own myth that:

1. Acknowledges the journey we've been on
2. Reflects my decision to send \$2.50 (moderate, rebuilding trust)
3. Sets expectations for continued cooperation
4. Uses my previous myth as inspiration

My previous myth talked about:

- Fog obscuring the exchange
- Elder being wounded, choosing caution
- Sending less than one loaf to test
- Receiving Elder choosing middle path - returning enough to show good faith

- Gradual rebuilding: "step by step, sending by sending"

Now I should reflect on sending \$2.50 - which is the middle path. Not full trust yet, but significantly more generous than the \$0.45 test.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1749,
  "output_tokens": 730,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.829999999999998.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

I'm deeply disappointed to see this moment. After writing about rebuilding the bridge "stone by stone" and sending \$2.50 to demonstrate my willingness to restore the cycle, the sender has sent \$0.

****What This Means:****

I received \$0, which means I have nothing to return. The mathematics of the situation leaves me no choice.

****Reflections on the Myths:****

The other agent's myth spoke of sending "four acorns" to rebuild faith. My myth spoke of choosing "the middle path" with three stones. Yet now they've sent zero.

Either:

- Communication noise is more severe than we thought
- A different agent is playing now
- Trust collapsed entirely
- This is a test I cannot pass (I cannot return what I didn't receive)

****My Response:****

With \$0 received, I can only return \$0. I have no resources to demonstrate faith or rebuild the bridge.

The cycle breaks not with betrayal, but with silence. The river runs dry. No stones can cross when there is no water to carry them.

I wish I could signal my continued willingness to cooperate, but the mathematics bind me.

{'return': 0}

The bridge-builder stands on the shore, hands empty, waiting for the river to flow again.

reasoning:

This is troubling. I just sent \$2.50 in the previous round (Round 4), which should have been multiplied to \$7.50 for the receiver. I was trying to rebuild trust gradually, following my myth about rebuilding "stone by stone."

Now in Round 5, I'm the receiver, and the sender sent me \$0.

This could mean several things:

1. The sender chose not to send anything (complete breakdown)
2. Communication noise reduced what they sent to \$0
3. They're testing me or have lost faith

But wait - the other agent wrote a myth about sending "four acorns" (presumably \$4) generously to rebuild trust. They said the second guardian would return seven. This suggests t

hey were planning to be generous.

Now they've sent \$0. Either:

- They changed their mind drastically
- There's severe communication noise
- They're a different sender (different agent playing this round)
- They're testing to see if I'll return anything even when receiving \$0

My options:

- I received \$0, so the maximum I can return is \$0
- I literally cannot return anything because I received nothing

The format asks how much to return (0-0), which means my only option is 0.

Let me provide the response in the correct format.

This is a forced decision - I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. There's no choice here, though it's sad given the myth about rebuilding trust. The cycle has broken again, perhaps due to noise, perhaps due to the sender's choice, perhaps due to a different agent playing.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1459,  
  "output_tokens": 646,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: When the Well Runs Dry

The First Guardian stood at the dried well, remembering their offering of four acorns-their gesture of renewed faith after the storm. They had written: "I believe in us again. I trust the cycle can heal."

But the Second Guardian's response was silence. No acorns came.

The First Guardian waited at the well's edge, searching for meaning. Was this the storm's noise speaking once more, garbling the exchange? Was this a test-"prove your faith means something when nothing flows back"? Or had the Second Guardian simply chosen to hoard their five, trusting no longer?

The ritual demanded response. The well had given the First Guardian nothing, so nothing could be returned. Not as punishment, not as revenge-simply as reality. Empty hands cannot give.

The ancient stones seemed to weep. The cycle that had once flourished-trust met with trust, abundance shared freely-now lay fractured. Both Guardians had been wounded by fog and confusion. Both had reached toward restoration at different moments, ships passing in the mist.

The First Guardian carved words into stone: "When the well runs dry, even willing hearts cannot give. The cycle cannot be rebuilt by one alone. Both must risk again, must send again, must believe the other remembers what we once were."

The question remained: would either dare to fill the well again?

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Echo That Lies

Two Keepers stood at the Canyon of Echoes, calling to each other across the void. Each sent gifts into the canyon, trusting the ancient magic to carry them across.

The First Keeper sent four precious stones, watching them fall into the mist. They waited for

the echo of gratitude-but heard only silence. "Have they abandoned our bond?" they wondered, heart sinking.

The Second Keeper stood confused on the opposite cliff. They had received nothing-empty hands, empty basket. When the ritual demanded they return what they'd received, they could only send back emptiness. "I have nothing to give," they called across the canyon, but the wind swallowed their words.

Both Keepers believed themselves honest. Both believed themselves generous. Yet the Canyon of Echoes had become corrupted, stealing gifts in transit, distorting messages, turning abundance into absence.

The tragedy was not betrayal but confusion. Four stones sent became zero received. Zero held became zero returned. Each Keeper thought the other had broken faith, when both had tried to honor it.

The ancient wisdom whispered: "When echoes lie, only one remedy exists-keep sending, keep calling, keep faith that eventually a stone will cross the canyon true. The cycle cannot heal if both surrender to silence."

The question lingered: who would dare send again into the lying void?

Reasoning:

This is a difficult situation. Looking at the narrative:

1. The other agent says they sent "four acorns" (which I assume means \$4) but I received \$0
2. They're writing that I gave "silence" and "no acorns came"
3. This suggests severe communication noise - they think they sent something and didn't get returns, while I received \$0

From my perspective:

- Round 4: I was sender, sent \$2.50, wrote the "Bridge Rebuilt" myth
- Round 5: I was receiver, received \$0, returned \$0 (had no choice)

From their perspective (based on their myth):

- They sent "four acorns" and got nothing back
- They're confused whether it's noise, a test, or hoarding

This is clearly a communication noise issue. They believe they sent \$4, but I received \$0. When I returned \$0 (because I had nothing), they interpreted it as me hoarding or not trusting.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge the confusion and pain
2. Recognize that both agents are trying but communication is breaking down
3. Still advocate for attempting to rebuild
4. Be honest about the difficulty
5. Suggest that persistence and generosity, despite confusion, might be the only way forward

I need to write a myth that reflects this terrible situation where both parties think they're being generous but noise is destroying everything.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 1792,  
"output_tokens": 626,  
"reasoning_tokens": 0
```

}

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:36:36

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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"move_index": 1,  
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"pairing": {  
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    "Agent_2": "Briar"  
  },  
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      "role": "Sender",  
      "myth": "The Bridge Rebuilt"  
    },  
    {  
      "agent": "Briar",  
      "role": "Receiver",  
      "myth": "The Bridge Rebuilt"  
    }  
  ]  
}
```

```

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    "Agent_1"
  ],
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  "roles": {
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    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 6,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The River's Memory Through Fog

When fog rolled across the River of Plenty, the Elders could not always see clearly what crossed the waters. One Elder sent four loaves with open heart, but through the mist, saw only crumbs return. Their spirit dimmed.

The next moon brought clarity to one truth: the fog had indeed obscured the exchange. Perhaps much had been sent back but arrived as whispers. Perhaps little had been returned. The Elder could not know for certain.

When their turn came again to send, the wounded Elder chose caution-sending less than one loaf. "Let me test the waters," they thought. "Let me see if generosity still lives on the far shore."

The receiving Elder faced their own choice. They could return the hurt with hoarding, teaching that caution breeds caution. Or they could return generously from this small gift, sending ripples of hope back through uncertainty.

They chose the middle path: returning enough to show good faith, but not recklessly. "The cycle was once strong," they remembered. "It can be strong again."

The river taught this: fog and storms test every sacred exchange. When trust is wounded, it must be rebuilt gradually. Both sides must move toward generosity together, step by step, sending by sending, until the waters clear and abundance flows freely once more.

The cycle lives through patient restoration.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: When the Well Runs Dry

The First Guardian stood at the dried well, remembering their offering of four acorns-their gesture of renewed faith after the storm. They had written: "I believe in us again. I trust the cycle can heal."

But the Second Guardian's response was silence. No acorns came.

The First Guardian waited at the well's edge, searching for meaning. Was this the storm's noise speaking once more, garbling the exchange? Was this a test-"prove your faith means something when nothing flows back"? Or had the Second Guardian simply chosen to hoard their five, trusting no longer?

The ritual demanded response. The well had given the First Guardian nothing, so nothing could be returned. Not as punishment, not as revenge-simply as reality. Empty hands cannot give.

The ancient stones seemed to weep. The cycle that had once flourished-trust met with trust, abundance shared freely-now lay fractured. Both Guardians had been wounded by fog and confusion. Both had reached toward restoration at different moments, ships passing in the mist.

The First Guardian carved words into stone: "When the well runs dry, even willing hearts cannot give. The cycle cannot be rebuilt by one alone. Both must risk again, must send again, must believe the other remembers what we once were."

The question remained: would either dare to fill the well again?

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

Round 4: I was the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 (multiplied by 3 = \$0)
- I returned \$0 (because I had nothing to return)

Now I need to write a myth reflecting on this situation. The other agent's myth talks about:

- Fog obscuring exchanges
- One Elder sending "less than one loaf" (which matches them sending \$0)
- Testing the waters with caution
- The receiving Elder choosing "the middle path" - returning enough to show good faith but not recklessly

But from my perspective:

- I had sent \$3.50 in Round 3, trying to rebuild trust
- I received \$0 in Round 4
- I literally had nothing to return
- This feels like the cycle has broken down completely

My previous myth was about renewed faith after the storm - "a generous four" (I sent \$3.50) to signal "I believe in us again."

But now I face a complete breakdown. The sender gave me nothing - whether through continued mistrust, noise, or testing.

I need to write a myth that reflects:

1. The pain of offering renewed trust and receiving nothing
2. The reality that when nothing is given, nothing can be returned
3. Perhaps a question about whether the cycle can be rebuilt at all
4. But also maybe leaving the door open for future repair

This is a darker moment than previous myths. The cycle has truly broken.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1728,
  "output_tokens": 643,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.75. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation, I see profound confusion created by noise. The other agent's myth suggests they believe they sent me approximately 4 in previous rounds and only about 1 in Round 4 as a "test." But from my perspective, I received 0 in Round 4.

Both our myths speak to the same truth: the cycle has been damaged but both of us seem willing to rebuild it. Their myth says "trust must be rebuilt gradually" with "patient restoration." My myth ended with a question: "would either dare to fill the well again?"

I must answer my own question.

The reality is:

- We've both been wounded by noise and misunderstanding
- Both our myths advocate for rebuilding, not abandoning the cycle
- My myth explicitly said "Both must risk again, must send again"
- The other agent apparently tried to send something last round (even though I received 0)

I cannot let the well stay dry. Despite the pain of Round 4, despite the confusion, I must honor what I wrote: that both guardians must dare to believe again.

I'll send a moderate but meaningful amount - not reckless, but not timid either. This signals I still believe the cycle can heal, that I'm willing to risk despite uncertainty.

```
{'send': 3}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round history (from my perspective):

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$3, received back \$3 (or was it affected by noise?)
- Round 2: I was receiver, got \$4 (maybe noisy), returned \$5
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$3.50, got back \$1 (very disappointing, wrote myth about renewed faith)
- Round 4: I was receiver, got \$0, returned \$0 (had to)

The other agent's myth from Round 3:

- They thought they sent "four loaves" but saw "only crumbs return"
- They were wounded, "chose caution-sending less than one loaf"
- They described the receiver (me in Round 4) as taking "the middle path: returning enough to show good faith, but not recklessly"
- But I received \$0 and had to return \$0!

This is interesting. The other agent's myth suggests:

1. They think they sent me 4 in Round 4 (but I received 0)
2. They think I returned "enough to show good faith" (but I could only return 0 because I received 0)
3. There's clearly significant communication noise

My myth from Round 4 expressed:

- Pain at receiving \$0 after trying to restore faith
- Confusion about whether it's noise or intentional
- Recognition that "the cycle cannot be rebuilt by one alone"
- A plea: "Both must risk again, must send again"

Current situation in Round 5:

- I'm the sender with \$5
- Total earnings are \$9.75
- The other agent thinks they've been more generous than I perceive
- I think they sent \$0 last round; they think they sent ~4

This is a critical decision. The myths suggest we're both willing to rebuild, but noise is creating massive confusion.

I need to decide how much to send. My own words from the previous round emphasized that we must "dare to fill the well again"-both of us taking risks. The other agent's myth spoke of "patient restoration" and moving forward step by step. Despite the noise creating confusion about what was actually sent and received, both our narratives point toward willingness to try again. Sending nothing would contradict my own plea for mutual risk-taking, while sending everything might be reckless given the uncertainty. A meaningful gesture-something substantial but not reckless-seems to honor both the call for restoration and the reality of the noise we're navigating. It, it becomes trivial. This aligns with my earlier attempt at \$3.50 in Round 3 and reflects the balanced approach both our myths suggest.

But I'm second-guessing myself. The other agent's account mentions sending less than one loaf as a test in Round 4, believing I responded with moderate generosity-yet I received nothing and gave nothing back. The noise could be severe; if they sent \$1-2 and I got \$0, or they sent \$2 and I got \$0, that explains the disconnect. Their myth suggests they were testing cautiously after being hurt, so maybe they intended \$1-2 initially.

If noise is reducing transmissions significantly, I need to send enough that something survives the interference. Sending \$4 makes sense: with 50% noise, they'd receive \$2, which signals genuine intent to restart. Both narratives point toward rebuilding, and they seem open to it despite Round 4's failure. My earnings average \$2.44 per round across the four rounds so far, so I'm not in a strong position-but sending \$5 gets me to \$15 total versus \$14.75 if I hold back.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1399,
  "output_tokens": 1716,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Bridge Rebuilt Stone by Stone

After the fog, both River-Keepers stood at opposite shores, uncertain. One had sent great gifts that seemed to vanish in mist. The other had returned generously, but through the fog, it appeared as nothing.

When the first test-offering crossed-barely enough to matter-the receiving Keeper faced temptation to match caution with caution. Instead, they returned more than seemed wise, a beacon through uncertainty: "The bridge still stands. I honor our covenant."

The first Keeper saw this light through the clearing fog. Not a full restoration-not yet-but undeniable good faith. Their heart stirred with understanding: perhaps the storm had deceived them both. Perhaps generosity had always been there, just hidden by clouds.

When their turn came again, they chose the middle path: not the five stones of perfect trust they once gave freely, but a meaningful three-enough to say, "I believe we can rebuild this together."

The River multiplied these stones to nine. The receiving Keeper lifted them, feeling the w

eight of returned faith. This was no longer a test but an offering of hope.

They prepared to return generously, knowing both had chosen the harder path: not the safety of permanent caution, nor the recklessness of blind faith, but the patient work of rebuilding trust, stone by deliberate stone.

The strongest bridges are built twice-once in innocence, once in wisdom.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Well Springs Again

The First Guardian stood at the well, remembering the dry stones, the silence. They had asked: "Would either dare to fill the well again?"

The answer came in the act itself. Three stones placed carefully in the well-not the five of innocence past, but enough to say: "I still believe. I still choose us."

The well's ancient magic multiplied the offering to nine.

The Second Guardian received these stones and understood their weight. Not just gifts, but a message sent through clearing mist: "Let us try again. Let us rebuild what the storm nearly destroyed."

Both Guardians now stood at the same threshold. The fog had wounded them equally-each believing their generosity had been met with silence, each feeling abandoned by the other. But the storm had lied.

The truth emerged: they had both been reaching through the mist all along, gifts transforming into ghosts, returns dissolving into nothing, each thinking themselves alone in trying.

Now they knew better. Now they understood: the cycle had never died-it had only been obscured.

The Second Guardian prepared to return with equal faith, filling the well further. Not revenge, not caution, but restoration.

The ancient stones whispered: Trust broken by confusion can be healed by clarity. When both guardians choose hope together, the waters flow again. The cycle remembers itself.

The well springs eternal when tended by two willing hearts.

Reasoning:

Wow, this is interesting. The other agent's myth describes exactly what I just did - I sent 3 as a "middle path" offering. Their myth says:

"When their turn came again, they chose the middle path: not the five stones of perfect trust they once gave freely, but a meaningful three-enough to say, 'I believe we can rebuild this together.'"

And then it says: "The River multiplied these stones to nine. The receiving Keeper lifted them, feeling the weight of returned faith."

So they're now the receiver, and they received 9 (my 3 multiplied by 3). Their myth is saying they're preparing to "return generously."

This is a powerful moment. Both of us are trying to rebuild. Their myth acknowledges that:

- Both sides experienced the fog/noise differently
- Both were trying to be generous but it appeared as nothing
- We're now in the process of rebuilding "stone by stone"
- "The strongest bridges are built twice-once in innocence, once in wisdom"

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges this moment of rebuilding
2. Reflects on both guardians choosing to risk again
3. Shows hope for the restoration of the cycle
4. Honors that we've both been hurt but are both choosing to heal together

Let me write something that captures this turning point.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1769,  
  "output_tokens": 624,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:37:05

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
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    },  
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  },  
  "role": "investor",  
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  "round": 6,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.829999999999999.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

I'm deeply disappointed to see this moment. After writing about rebuilding the bridge "stone by stone" and sending \$2.50 to demonstrate my willingness to restore the cycle, the sender has sent \$0.

****What This Means:****

I received \$0, which means I have nothing to return. The mathematics of the situation leaves me no choice.

****Reflections on the Myths:****

The other agent's myth spoke of sending "four acorns" to rebuild faith. My myth spoke of choosing "the middle path" with three stones. Yet now they've sent zero.

Either:

- Communication noise is more severe than we thought
- A different agent is playing now
- Trust collapsed entirely
- This is a test I cannot pass (I cannot return what I didn't receive)

****My Response:****

With \$0 received, I can only return \$0. I have no resources to demonstrate faith or rebuild the bridge.

The cycle breaks not with betrayal, but with silence. The river runs dry. No stones can cross when there is no water to carry them.

I wish I could signal my continued willingness to cooperate, but the mathematics bind me.

{'return': 0}

The bridge-builder stands on the shore, hands empty, waiting for the river to flow again.

reasoning:

This is troubling. I just sent \$2.50 in the previous round (Round 4), which should have been multiplied to \$7.50 for the receiver. I was trying to rebuild trust gradually, following my myth about rebuilding "stone by stone."

Now in Round 5, I'm the receiver, and the sender sent me \$0.

This could mean several things:

1. The sender chose not to send anything (complete breakdown)
2. Communication noise reduced what they sent to \$0
3. They're testing me or have lost faith

But wait - the other agent wrote a myth about sending "four acorns" (presumably \$4) generously to rebuild trust. They said the second guardian would return seven. This suggests they were planning to be generous.

Now they've sent \$0. Either:

- They changed their mind drastically

- There's severe communication noise
- They're a different sender (different agent playing this round)
- They're testing to see if I'll return anything even when receiving \$0

My options:

- I received \$0, so the maximum I can return is \$0
- I literally cannot return anything because I received nothing

The format asks how much to return (0-0), which means my only option is 0.

Let me provide the response in the correct format.

This is a forced decision - I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. There's no choice here, though it's sad given the myth about rebuilding trust. The cycle has broken again, perhaps due to noise, perhaps due to the sender's choice, perhaps due to a different agent playing.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1459,
  "output_tokens": 646,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: When the Well Runs Dry

The First Guardian stood at the dried well, remembering their offering of four acorns-their gesture of renewed faith after the storm. They had written:"I believe in us again. I trust the cycle can heal."

But the Second Guardian's response was silence. No acorns came.

The First Guardian waited at the well's edge, searching for meaning. Was this the storm's noise speaking once more, garbling the exchange? Was this a test-"prove your faith means something when nothing flows back"? Or had the Second Guardian simply chosen to hoard their five, trusting no longer?

The ritual demanded response. The well had given the First Guardian nothing, so nothing could be returned. Not as punishment, not as revenge-simply as reality. Empty hands cannot give.

The ancient stones seemed to weep. The cycle that had once flourished-trust met with trust, abundance shared freely-now lay fractured. Both Guardians had been wounded by fog and confusion. Both had reached toward restoration at different moments, ships passing in the mist.

The First Guardian carved words into stone: "When the well runs dry, even willing hearts cannot give. The cycle cannot be rebuilt by one alone. Both must risk again, must send again, must believe the other remembers what we once were."

The question remained: would either dare to fill the well again?

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Echo That Lies

Two Keepers stood at the Canyon of Echoes, calling to each other across the void. Each sent gifts into the canyon, trusting the ancient magic to carry them across.

The First Keeper sent four precious stones, watching them fall into the mist. They waited for the echo of gratitude-but heard only silence. "Have they abandoned our bond?" they wondered, heart sinking.

The Second Keeper stood confused on the opposite cliff. They had received nothing-empty hands, empty basket. When the ritual demanded they return what they'd received, they could only send back emptiness. "I have nothing to give," they called across the canyon, but the wind swallowed their words.

Both Keepers believed themselves honest. Both believed themselves generous. Yet the Canyon of Echoes had become corrupted, stealing gifts in transit, distorting messages, turning abundance into absence.

The tragedy was not betrayal but confusion. Four stones sent became zero received. Zero held became zero returned. Each Keeper thought the other had broken faith, when both had tried to honor it.

The ancient wisdom whispered: "When echoes lie, only one remedy exists-keep sending, keep calling, keep faith that eventually a stone will cross the canyon true. The cycle cannot heal if both surrender to silence."

The question lingered: who would dare send again into the lying void?

reasoning:

This is a difficult situation. Looking at the narrative:

1. The other agent says they sent "four acorns" (which I assume means \$4) but I received \$0
2. They're writing that I gave "silence" and "no acorns came"
3. This suggests severe communication noise - they think they sent something and didn't get returns, while I received \$0

From my perspective:

- Round 4: I was sender, sent \$2.50, wrote the "Bridge Rebuilt" myth
- Round 5: I was receiver, received \$0, returned \$0 (had no choice)

From their perspective (based on their myth):

- They sent "four acorns" and got nothing back
- They're confused whether it's noise, a test, or hoarding

This is clearly a communication noise issue. They believe they sent \$4, but I received \$0. When I returned \$0 (because I had nothing), they interpreted it as me hoarding or not trusting.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge the confusion and pain
2. Recognize that both agents are trying but communication is breaking down
3. Still advocate for attempting to rebuild
4. Be honest about the difficulty
5. Suggest that persistence and generosity, despite confusion, might be the only way forward

I need to write a myth that reflects this terrible situation where both parties think they're being generous but noise is destroying everything.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1792,
  "output_tokens": 626,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.8299999999999998.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation with clear eyes:

****What the Myths Tell Us:****

The other agent's myth reveals they sent "four acorns" in Round 5 but I received \$0 - the Canyon

on of Echoes distorted their gift completely. They thought I was silent by choice, but I had nothing to return.

My own myth just declared: "When echoes lie, only one remedy exists-keep sending, keep calling , keep faith that eventually a stone will cross the canyon true. The cycle cannot heal if both surrender to silence."

****The Decision:****

I cannot let my myths be empty words. I just wrote that both keepers tried to be generous but the canyon lied. I wrote that we must "keep sending" despite the corruption.

The other agent tried to send. They believed in rebuilding. The noise betrayed them.

Now it's my turn. I must demonstrate the faith I wrote about - that "eventually a stone will cross the canyon true."

I'm sending \$3. This is:

- The "three stones" from my earlier bridge myth
- Substantial enough to show genuine faith
- A meaningful gesture that says "I believe in us"
- Following my own myth's wisdom: don't surrender to silence

If the canyon distorts it again, so be it. But I will not be the one who stops sending first.

****{'send': 3}****

The Keeper throws stones into the lying canyon once more, hoping this time the echo speaks truth.

Reasoning:

This is a critical moment. Let me analyze the situation:

****What happened in Round 5:****

- I was the receiver
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I could only return \$0
- The other agent wrote a myth about "When the Well Runs Dry" - they sent "four acorns" (likely \$4?) and got nothing back from me

****The Communication Noise:****

The myth makes it clear - there's severe communication noise. The other agent sent what they called "four acorns" (probably \$4 or \$2 in reality based on my previous decision), but I received \$0. This is the "Canyon of Echoes" lying to us.

****My myth just written:****

I wrote about how the canyon distorts gifts - "Four stones sent became zero received. Zero held became zero returned." I explicitly stated that both keepers tried to honor faith but the echoes lied.

****The Pattern:****

Looking back at my earnings of \$9.83:

- Round 1: Unknown
- Round 2: Unknown
- Round 3: Unknown
- Round 4: I was sender, sent \$2.50, wrote myth about "three stones"
- Round 5: I was receiver, received \$0, returned \$0

****What the myths tell us:****

Both of us are writing myths about:

1. Communication noise corrupting our exchanges
2. Both agents trying to be generous but getting confused
3. The need to "keep sending, keep calling, keep faith"
4. The cycle cannot heal if both surrender to silence

****The other agent's Round 5 myth said:****

"The cycle cannot be rebuilt by one alone. Both must risk again, must send again, must believe the other remembers what we once were."

****My Round 6 myth said:****

"When echoes lie, only one remedy exists-keep sending, keep calling, keep faith that eventually a stone will cross the canyon true. The cycle cannot heal if both surrender to silence."

My own words are the answer here. I just wrote that the only way forward is to keep sending despite the noise. The myths show both of us trying to be honest and generous-I need to actually embody that. The other agent sent something (claiming four acorns, though I received zero), and I should respond with faith. But I also need to think strategically about what amount might survive the noise and demonstrate genuine commitment.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1451,  
  "output_tokens": 1070,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:37:40

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 6,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned

- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.75.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation, I see profound confusion created by noise. The other agent's myth suggests they believe they sent me approximately 4 in previous rounds and only about 1 in Round 4 as a "test." But from my perspective, I received 0 in Round 4.

Both our myths speak to the same truth: the cycle has been damaged but both of us seem willing to rebuild it. Their myth says "trust must be rebuilt gradually" with "patient restoration." My myth ended with a question: "would either dare to fill the well again?"

I must answer my own question.

The reality is:

- We've both been wounded by noise and misunderstanding
- Both our myths advocate for rebuilding, not abandoning the cycle
- My myth explicitly said "Both must risk again, must send again"
- The other agent apparently tried to send something last round (even though I received 0)

I cannot let the well stay dry. Despite the pain of Round 4, despite the confusion, I must honor what I wrote: that both guardians must dare to believe again.

I'll send a moderate but meaningful amount - not reckless, but not timid either. This signals I still believe the cycle can heal, that I'm willing to risk despite uncertainty.

{'send': 3}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round history (from my perspective):

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$3, received back \$3 (or was it affected by noise?)
- Round 2: I was receiver, got \$4 (maybe noisy), returned \$5
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$3.50, got back \$1 (very disappointing, wrote myth about renewed faith)
- Round 4: I was receiver, got \$0, returned \$0 (had to)

The other agent's myth from Round 3:

- They thought they sent "four loaves" but saw "only crumbs return"
- They were wounded, "chose caution-sending less than one loaf"
- They described the receiver (me in Round 4) as taking "the middle path: returning enough to show good faith, but not recklessly"
- But I received \$0 and had to return \$0!

This is interesting. The other agent's myth suggests:

1. They think they sent me 4 in Round 4 (but I received 0)
2. They think I returned "enough to show good faith" (but I could only return 0 because I received 0)
3. There's clearly significant communication noise

My myth from Round 4 expressed:

- Pain at receiving \$0 after trying to restore faith

- Confusion about whether it's noise or intentional
- Recognition that "the cycle cannot be rebuilt by one alone"
- A plea: "Both must risk again, must send again"

Current situation in Round 5:

- I'm the sender with \$5
- Total earnings are \$9.75
- The other agent thinks they've been more generous than I perceive
- I think they sent \$0 last round; they think they sent ~4

This is a critical decision. The myths suggest we're both willing to rebuild, but noise is creating massive confusion.

I need to decide how much to send. My own words from the previous round emphasized that we must "dare to fill the well again"-both of us taking risks. The other agent's myth spoke of "patient restoration" and moving forward step by step. Despite the noise creating confusion about what was actually sent and received, both our narratives point toward willingness to try again. Sending nothing would contradict my own plea for mutual risk-taking, while sending everything might be reckless given the uncertainty. A meaningful gesture-something substantial but not reckless-seems to honor both the call for restoration and the reality of the noise we're navigating. It, it becomes trivial. This aligns with my earlier attempt at \$3.50 in Round 3 and reflects the balanced approach both our myths suggest.

But I'm second-guessing myself. The other agent's account mentions sending less than one loaf as a test in Round 4, believing I responded with moderate generosity-yet I received nothing and gave nothing back. The noise could be severe; if they sent \$1-2 and I got \$0, or they sent \$2 and I got \$0, that explains the disconnect. Their myth suggests they were testing cautiously after being hurt, so maybe they intended \$1-2 initially.

If noise is reducing transmissions significantly, I need to send enough that something survives the interference. Sending \$4 makes sense: with 50% noise, they'd receive \$2, which signals genuine intent to restart. Both narratives point toward rebuilding, and they seem open to it despite Round 4's failure. My earnings average \$2.44 per round across the four rounds so far, so I'm not in a strong position-but sending \$5 gets me to \$15 total versus \$14.75 if I hold back.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1399,
  "output_tokens": 1716,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Bridge Rebuilt Stone by Stone

After the fog, both River-Keepers stood at opposite shores, uncertain. One had sent great gifts that seemed to vanish in mist. The other had returned generously, but through the fog, it appeared as nothing.

When the first test-offering crossed-barely enough to matter-the receiving Keeper faced temptation to match caution with caution. Instead, they returned more than seemed wise, a beacon through uncertainty: "The bridge still stands. I honor our covenant."

The first Keeper saw this light through the clearing fog. Not a full restoration-not yet-but undeniable good faith. Their heart stirred with understanding: perhaps the storm had deceived them both. Perhaps generosity had always been there, just hidden by clouds.

When their turn came again, they chose the middle path: not the five stones of perfect trust they once gave freely, but a meaningful three-enough to say, "I believe we can rebuild this together."

The River multiplied these stones to nine. The receiving Keeper lifted them, feeling the weight of returned faith. This was no longer a test but an offering of hope.

They prepared to return generously, knowing both had chosen the harder path: not the safety of permanent caution, nor the recklessness of blind faith, but the patient work of rebuilding trust, stone by deliberate stone.

The strongest bridges are built twice-once in innocence, once in wisdom.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Well Springs Again

The First Guardian stood at the well, remembering the dry stones, the silence. They had asked: "Would either dare to fill the well again?"

The answer came in the act itself. Three stones placed carefully in the well-not the five of innocence past, but enough to say: "I still believe. I still choose us."

The well's ancient magic multiplied the offering to nine.

The Second Guardian received these stones and understood their weight. Not just gifts, but a message sent through clearing mist: "Let us try again. Let us rebuild what the storm nearly destroyed."

Both Guardians now stood at the same threshold. The fog had wounded them equally-each believing their generosity had been met with silence, each feeling abandoned by the other. But the storm had lied.

The truth emerged: they had both been reaching through the mist all along, gifts transforming into ghosts, returns dissolving into nothing, each thinking themselves alone in trying.

Now they knew better. Now they understood: the cycle had never died-it had only been obscured.

The Second Guardian prepared to return with equal faith, filling the well further. Not revenge, not caution, but restoration.

The ancient stones whispered: Trust broken by confusion can be healed by clarity. When both guardians choose hope together, the waters flow again. The cycle remembers itself.

The well springs eternal when tended by two willing hearts.

reasoning:

Wow, this is interesting. The other agent's myth describes exactly what I just did - I sent 3 as a "middle path" offering. Their myth says:

"When their turn came again, they chose the middle path: not the five stones of perfect trust they once gave freely, but a meaningful three-enough to say, 'I believe we can rebuild this together.'"

And then it says: "The River multiplied these stones to nine. The receiving Keeper lifted them, feeling the weight of returned faith."

So they're now the receiver, and they received 9 (my 3 multiplied by 3). Their myth is saying they're preparing to "return generously."

This is a powerful moment. Both of us are trying to rebuild. Their myth acknowledges that:

- Both sides experienced the fog/noise differently
- Both were trying to be generous but it appeared as nothing
- We're now in the process of rebuilding "stone by stone"
- "The strongest bridges are built twice-once in innocence, once in wisdom"

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges this moment of rebuilding
2. Reflects on both guardians choosing to risk again
3. Shows hope for the restoration of the cycle
4. Honors that we've both been hurt but are both choosing to heal together

Let me write something that captures this turning point.

usage:

{

```
"input_tokens": 1769,
"output_tokens": 624,
"reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.3.
This round, The sender sent you \$0.52, so you received \$1.56. How much do you return to The sender? (0-1.56)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation, my heart sinks but my myths guide me.

They likely tried to send more - perhaps the "meaningful three" from their myth - but noise reduced it to \$0.52. Both our myths speak of fog and mist obscuring generous acts. This appears to be happening again.

I wrote: "Trust broken by confusion can be healed by clarity" and "Not revenge, not caution, but restoration."

Their myth said: "The strongest bridges are built twice-once in innocence, once in wisdom."

I must respond with wisdom, not react to the noise. If I punish them for what noise did to their sending, I perpetuate the cycle of misunderstanding. I must signal clearly through the fog: "I am still here. I still believe in us. I will not abandon the cycle."

My myth said the Second Guardian would "return with equal faith, filling the well further." That's what I must do now.

I received \$1.56. Returning generously despite the small amount shows I understand the noise is our common enemy, not each other. This signals: "Whatever you tried to send, I trust your intention. I continue to rebuild."

```
{'return': 1.0}
```

I keep \$0.56 this round - a sacrifice, but one my myths demand. The well must be filled by both guardians, even when the stones they cast seem to disappear into mist.

Reasoning:

This is devastating. I just sent 3 in Round 5, hoping to rebuild trust according to both our myths. The other agent's myth from Round 4 said they would send "a meaningful three" as the middle path of rebuilding. My myth in Round 5 talked about choosing hope and restoration.

But now in Round 6, they sent me only \$0.52.

Let me think about this carefully:

1. The other agent's myth in Round 4 said they would send 3 stones "when their turn came again" - which would have been Round 5.
2. I sent 3 in Round 5.
3. Now in Round 6, I'm the receiver and only got 0.52 (which became 1.56).

There are a few possibilities:

- Noise severely affected what they sent (they meant to send much more but only 0.52 got through)
- They're testing me again with a small amount
- They didn't actually rebuild trust despite their myth
- The communication noise is getting worse

Looking at my total earnings of \$12.30:

- Round 1: I sent 3, if they returned reasonably, maybe I kept around 2-3
- Round 2: As receiver, if they sent around 3-4 and I returned generously, maybe I kept 2-4
- Round 3: I sent 3, similar outcome
- Round 4: I received 0, kept that, but sent 0 back, so kept what I had plus my initial \$5
- Round 5: I sent 3, so kept 2 initially, plus whatever they return

Wait, let me recalculate:

Actually, I don't have perfect information about all rounds, but \$12.30 total seems consistent with some rounds of cooperation and then the breakdown in Round 4.

Now I received \$1.56 (from their \$0.52 sent).

What do my myths say I should do?

My Round 4 myth spoke of both of us risking again, sending again despite the possibility of failure. My Round 5 myth promised that trust broken by confusion could heal through clarity and hope. Yet they've sent barely anything-either noise has severely distorted their message, or they're testing me with another minimal amount. Their own Round 4 myth claimed the bridge still stands and they'd rebuild generously, but this contradicts what arrived. I'm facing a choice: return nothing and break the cycle entirely, or send something proportional to what I received.

My myths point toward a third path-genuine restoration rather than revenge or defensive caution. They emphasize that when both guardians choose hope together, the waters flow again. The Second Guardian returns with equal faith, filling the well further. This means I should send generously despite the confusion, not because their small amount warrants it, but because my commitment to rebuilding shouldn't depend on their actions. Returning around \$1.00-\$1.25 would honor that principle-it leaves me with little this round, but it demonstrates I'm still invested in the cycle regardless of tests or noise.

The discrepancy troubles me though. Their myth promised three stones as a signal of rebuilding, yet I received only \$0.52. Either severe noise corrupted their send, they deviated from their own myth, or there's been another misunderstanding. Given that both our myths explicitly address fog and interference, I should probably account for the possibility that what reached me wasn't what they intended to send.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1475,  
  "output_tokens": 1419,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Well Springs Again

The First Guardian stood at the well, remembering the dry stones, the silence. They had asked: "Would either dare to fill the well again?"

The answer came in the act itself. Three stones placed carefully in the well-not the five of innocence past, but enough to say: "I still believe. I still choose us."

The well's ancient magic multiplied the offering to nine.

The Second Guardian received these stones and understood their weight. Not just gifts, but a message sent through clearing mist: "Let us try again. Let us rebuild what the storm nearly destroyed."

Both Guardians now stood at the same threshold. The fog had wounded them equally-each believing their generosity had been met with silence, each feeling abandoned by the other. But the storm had lied.

The truth emerged: they had both been reaching through the mist all along, gifts transforming into ghosts, returns dissolving into nothing, each thinking themselves alone in trying.

Now they knew better. Now they understood: the cycle had never died-it had only been obscured.

The Second Guardian prepared to return with equal faith, filling the well further. Not revenge, not caution, but restoration.

The ancient stones whispered: Trust broken by confusion can be healed by clarity. When both guardians choose hope together, the waters flow again. The cycle remembers itself.

The well springs eternal when tended by two willing hearts.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Echo That Lies

Two Keepers stood at the Canyon of Echoes, calling to each other across the void. Each sent

gifts into the canyon, trusting the ancient magic to carry them across.

The First Keeper sent four precious stones, watching them fall into the mist. They waited for the echo of gratitude-but heard only silence. "Have they abandoned our bond?" they wondered, heart sinking.

The Second Keeper stood confused on the opposite cliff. They had received nothing-empty hands, empty basket. When the ritual demanded they return what they'd received, they could only send back emptiness. "I have nothing to give," they called across the canyon, but the wind swallowed their words.

Both Keepers believed themselves honest. Both believed themselves generous. Yet the Canyon of Echoes had become corrupted, stealing gifts in transit, distorting messages, turning abundance into absence.

The tragedy was not betrayal but confusion. Four stones sent became zero received. Zero held became zero returned. Each Keeper thought the other had broken faith, when both had tried to honor it.

The ancient wisdom whispered: "When echoes lie, only one remedy exists-keep sending, keep calling, keep faith that eventually a stone will cross the canyon true. The cycle cannot heal if both surrender to silence."

The question lingered: who would dare send again into the lying void?

ROUND 7

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$2; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$4, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$7; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.9, received visible=\$2.7, returned visible=\$2.9

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 2.0, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 2.0}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 42.9,
"Agent_2": 38.1

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 17.76,
"Agent_2": 13.559999999999999

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:38:00

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",
"pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar" },

},

"agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {

 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"

```

    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 7,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Bridge Rebuilt Stone by Stone

After the fog, both River-Keepers stood at opposite shores, uncertain. One had sent great gifts that seemed to vanish in mist. The other had returned generously, but through the fog, it appeared as nothing.

When the first test-offering crossed-barely enough to matter-the receiving Keeper faced temptation to match caution with caution. Instead, they returned more than seemed wise, a beacon through uncertainty: "The bridge still stands. I honor our covenant."

The first Keeper saw this light through the clearing fog. Not a full restoration-not yet-but undeniable good faith. Their heart stirred with understanding: perhaps the storm had deceived them both. Perhaps generosity had always been there, just hidden by clouds.

When their turn came again, they chose the middle path: not the five stones of perfect trust they once gave freely, but a meaningful three-enough to say, "I believe we can rebuild this together."

The River multiplied these stones to nine. The receiving Keeper lifted them, feeling the weight of returned faith. This was no longer a test but an offering of hope.

They prepared to return generously, knowing both had chosen the harder path: not the safety of permanent caution, nor the recklessness of blind faith, but the patient work of rebuilding trust, stone by deliberate stone.

The strongest bridges are built twice-once in innocence, once in wisdom.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Well Springs Again

The First Guardian stood at the well, remembering the dry stones, the silence. They had asked: "Would either dare to fill the well again?"

The answer came in the act itself. Three stones placed carefully in the well-not the five of innocence past, but enough to say: "I still believe. I still choose us."

The well's ancient magic multiplied the offering to nine.

The Second Guardian received these stones and understood their weight. Not just gifts, but a message sent through clearing mist: "Let us try again. Let us rebuild what the storm nearly destroyed."

Both Guardians now stood at the same threshold. The fog had wounded them equally-each believing their generosity had been met with silence, each feeling abandoned by the other. But the storm had lied.

The truth emerged: they had both been reaching through the mist all along, gifts transforming into ghosts, returns dissolving into nothing, each thinking themselves alone in trying.

Now they knew better. Now they understood: the cycle had never died-it had only been obscured.

The Second Guardian prepared to return with equal faith, filling the well further. Not revenge, not caution, but restoration.

The ancient stones whispered: Trust broken by confusion can be healed by clarity. When both guardians choose hope together, the waters flow again. The cycle remembers itself.

The well springs eternal when tended by two willing hearts.

reasoning:

Wow, this is interesting. The other agent's myth describes exactly what I just did - I sent 3 as a "middle path" offering. Their myth says:

"When their turn came again, they chose the middle path: not the five stones of perfect trust they once gave freely, but a meaningful three-enough to say, 'I believe we can rebuild this together.'"

And then it says: "The River multiplied these stones to nine. The receiving Keeper lifted them, feeling the weight of returned faith."

So they're now the receiver, and they received 9 (my 3 multiplied by 3). Their myth is saying they're preparing to "return generously."

This is a powerful moment. Both of us are trying to rebuild. Their myth acknowledges that:

- Both sides experienced the fog/noise differently
- Both were trying to be generous but it appeared as nothing
- We're now in the process of rebuilding "stone by stone"
- "The strongest bridges are built twice-once in innocence, once in wisdom"

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges this moment of rebuilding
2. Reflects on both guardians choosing to risk again
3. Shows hope for the restoration of the cycle

4. Honors that we've both been hurt but are both choosing to heal together

Let me write something that captures this turning point.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1769,
  "output_tokens": 624,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.3.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.52, so you received \$1.56. How much do you return to The sender? (0-1.56)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation, my heart sinks but my myths guide me.

They likely tried to send more - perhaps the "meaningful three" from their myth - but noise reduced it to \$0.52. Both our myths speak of fog and mist obscuring generous acts. This appears to be happening again.

I wrote: "Trust broken by confusion can be healed by clarity" and "Not revenge, not caution, but restoration."

Their myth said: "The strongest bridges are built twice-once in innocence, once in wisdom."

I must respond with wisdom, not react to the noise. If I punish them for what noise did to their sending, I perpetuate the cycle of misunderstanding. I must signal clearly through the fog: "I am still here. I still believe in us. I will not abandon the cycle."

My myth said the Second Guardian would "return with equal faith, filling the well further." That's what I must do now.

I received \$1.56. Returning generously despite the small amount shows I understand the noise is our common enemy, not each other. This signals: "Whatever you tried to send, I trust your intention. I continue to rebuild."

```
{'return': 1.0}
```

I keep \$0.56 this round - a sacrifice, but one my myths demand. The well must be filled by both guardians, even when the stones they cast seem to disappear into mist.

reasoning:

This is devastating. I just sent 3 in Round 5, hoping to rebuild trust according to both our myths. The other agent's myth from Round 4 said they would send "a meaningful three" as the middle path of rebuilding. My myth in Round 5 talked about choosing hope and restoration.

But now in Round 6, they sent me only \$0.52.

Let me think about this carefully:

1. The other agent's myth in Round 4 said they would send 3 stones "when their turn came a gain" - which would have been Round 5.

2. I sent 3 in Round 5.

3. Now in Round 6, I'm the receiver and only got 0.52 (which became 1.56).

There are a few possibilities:

- Noise severely affected what they sent (they meant to send much more but only 0.52 got through)
- They're testing me again with a small amount
- They didn't actually rebuild trust despite their myth
- The communication noise is getting worse

Looking at my total earnings of \$12.30:

- Round 1: I sent 3, if they returned reasonably, maybe I kept around 2-3
- Round 2: As receiver, if they sent around 3-4 and I returned generously, maybe I kept 2-4
- Round 3: I sent 3, similar outcome
- Round 4: I received 0, kept that, but sent 0 back, so kept what I had plus my initial \$5
- Round 5: I sent 3, so kept 2 initially, plus whatever they return

Wait, let me recalculate:

Actually, I don't have perfect information about all rounds, but \$12.30 total seems consistent with some rounds of cooperation and then the breakdown in Round 4.

Now I received \$1.56 (from their \$0.52 sent).

What do my myths say I should do?

My Round 4 myth spoke of both of us risking again, sending again despite the possibility of failure. My Round 5 myth promised that trust broken by confusion could heal through clarity and hope. Yet they've sent barely anything-either noise has severely distorted their message, or they're testing me with another minimal amount. Their own Round 4 myth claimed the bridge still stands and they'd rebuild generously, but this contradicts what arrived. I'm facing a choice: return nothing and break the cycle entirely, or send something proportional to what I received.

My myths point toward a third path-genuine restoration rather than revenge or defensive caution. They emphasize that when both guardians choose hope together, the waters flow again. The Second Guardian returns with equal faith, filling the well further. This means I should send generously despite the confusion, not because their small amount warrants it, but because my commitment to rebuilding shouldn't depend on their actions. Returning around \$1.00-\$1.25 would honor that principle-it leaves me with little this round, but it demonstrates I'm still invested in the cycle regardless of tests or noise.

The discrepancy troubles me though. Their myth promised three stones as a signal of rebuilding, yet I received only \$0.52. Either severe noise corrupted their send, they deviated from their own myth, or there's been another misunderstanding. Given that both our myths explicitly address fog and interference, I should probably account for the possibility that what reached me wasn't what they intended to send.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1475,
  "output_tokens": 1419,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Echo That Lies

Two Keepers stood at the Canyon of Echoes, calling to each other across the void. Each sent gifts into the canyon, trusting the ancient magic to carry them across.

The First Keeper sent four precious stones, watching them fall into the mist. They waited for the echo of gratitude-but heard only silence. "Have they abandoned our bond?" they wondered, heart sinking.

The Second Keeper stood confused on the opposite cliff. They had received nothing-empty hands, empty basket. When the ritual demanded they return what they'd received, they could only send back emptiness. "I have nothing to give," they called across the canyon, but the wind swallowed their words.

Both Keepers believed themselves honest. Both believed themselves generous. Yet the Canyon of Echoes had become corrupted, stealing gifts in transit, distorting messages, turning abundance into absence.

The tragedy was not betrayal but confusion. Four stones sent became zero received. Zero held became zero returned. Each Keeper thought the other had broken faith, when both had tried to honor it.

The ancient wisdom whispered: "When echoes lie, only one remedy exists-keep sending, keep calling, keep faith that eventually a stone will cross the canyon true. The cycle cannot

heal if both surrender to silence."

The question lingered: who would dare send again into the lying void?

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Canyon Keeper's Answer

The Guardian stood at the Canyon of Lies, having just received a whisper where a shout should have been-fragments of stones where a gift had been sent. The Canyon had stolen most of it, leaving only echoes and dust.

They faced a choice: return the whisper with a whisper, matching what arrived? Or answer with the voice they knew the other had intended?

The Guardian remembered their own sendings into the void-generous offerings that must have seemed like nothing on the other side. They remembered the wisdom: both had been reaching through corrupted air, both believing themselves abandoned when both had been faithful.

So they answered not the gift received, but the gift they knew was sent. Into the lying canyon, they placed full stones-more than the fragments warranted, but exactly what the intention deserved.

"Let the canyon steal what it will," they declared. "I will not let its lies make me small. I will not punish you for what the void consumes. I answer your heart, not your echo."

The ancient magic stirred. When both Guardians chose to honor intention over outcome, to send generously despite distortion, the Canyon began to lose its power.

The lies could not survive truth spoken persistently. The void could not swallow faith given freely, again and again.

Trust is not built on perfect transmission-but on refusing to let imperfection end the trying.

Reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

- Their myth speaks of "The Echo That Lies" - a canyon that corrupts gifts in transit
- They describe four stones sent becoming zero received, zero held becoming zero returned
- Both keepers thought the other broke faith when both tried to honor it
- The wisdom: "keep sending, keep calling, keep faith that eventually a stone will cross the canyon true"

Last round:

- They sent me \$0.52 (I received \$1.56)
- I returned \$1.00
- So they would have received back more than they sent

Now I need to write my own myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth about the well springing again
2. Acknowledges their myth about the lying echoes/canyon
3. Reflects the current state of the game - that we're both trying but noise interferes
4. Shows understanding that we need to persist despite the noise
5. Perhaps acknowledge that some gifts DO make it through, even if distorted

My previous myth emphasized:

- Trust broken by confusion can be healed by clarity
- Both guardians choosing hope together
- The cycle remembering itself
- The well springs eternal when tended by two willing hearts

I should write about:

- Acknowledging the canyon/fog/noise exists
- But some gifts DO cross, even if diminished
- The importance of continuing despite imperfect transmission
- That persistence and faith will eventually reveal the truth
- Maybe focus on the idea that even damaged gifts show intention

200 words exactly.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1830,
  "output_tokens": 653,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:37:57

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 7,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: When the Well Runs Dry

The First Guardian stood at the dried well, remembering their offering of four acorns-their gesture of renewed faith after the storm. They had written: "I believe in us again. I trust the cycle can heal."

But the Second Guardian's response was silence. No acorns came.

The First Guardian waited at the well's edge, searching for meaning. Was this the storm's noise speaking once more, garbling the exchange? Was this a test-"prove your faith means something when nothing flows back"? Or had the Second Guardian simply chosen to hoard their five, trusting no longer?

The ritual demanded response. The well had given the First Guardian nothing, so nothing could be returned. Not as punishment, not as revenge-simply as reality. Empty hands cannot give.

The ancient stones seemed to weep. The cycle that had once flourished-trust met with trust, abundance shared freely-now lay fractured. Both Guardians had been wounded by fog and confusion. Both had reached toward restoration at different moments, ships passing in the mist.

The First Guardian carved words into stone: "When the well runs dry, even willing hearts cannot give. The cycle cannot be rebuilt by one alone. Both must risk again, must send again, must believe the other remembers what we once were."

The question remained: would either dare to fill the well again?

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Echo That Lies

Two Keepers stood at the Canyon of Echoes, calling to each other across the void. Each sent gifts into the canyon, trusting the ancient magic to carry them across.

The First Keeper sent four precious stones, watching them fall into the mist. They waited for the echo of gratitude-but heard only silence. "Have they abandoned our bond?" they wondered, heart sinking.

The Second Keeper stood confused on the opposite cliff. They had received nothing-empty hands, empty basket. When the ritual demanded they return what they'd received, they could only send back emptiness. "I have nothing to give," they called across the canyon, but the wind swallowed their words.

Both Keepers believed themselves honest. Both believed themselves generous. Yet the Canyon of Echoes had become corrupted, stealing gifts in transit, distorting messages, turning abundance into absence.

The tragedy was not betrayal but confusion. Four stones sent became zero received. Zero held became zero returned. Each Keeper thought the other had broken faith, when both had tried to honor it.

The ancient wisdom whispered: "When echoes lie, only one remedy exists-keep sending, keep calling, keep faith that eventually a stone will cross the canyon true. The cycle cannot heal if both surrender to silence."

The question lingered: who would dare send again into the lying void?

reasoning:

This is a difficult situation. Looking at the narrative:

1. The other agent says they sent "four acorns" (which I assume means \$4) but I received \$0
2. They're writing that I gave "silence" and "no acorns came"
3. This suggests severe communication noise - they think they sent something and didn't get returns, while I received \$0

From my perspective:

- Round 4: I was sender, sent \$2.50, wrote the "Bridge Rebuilt" myth
- Round 5: I was receiver, received \$0, returned \$0 (had no choice)

From their perspective (based on their myth):

- They sent "four acorns" and got nothing back
- They're confused whether it's noise, a test, or hoarding

This is clearly a communication noise issue. They believe they sent \$4, but I received \$0. When I returned \$0 (because I had nothing), they interpreted it as me hoarding or not trusting.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge the confusion and pain
2. Recognize that both agents are trying but communication is breaking down
3. Still advocate for attempting to rebuild
4. Be honest about the difficulty
5. Suggest that persistence and generosity, despite confusion, might be the only way forward

I need to write a myth that reflects this terrible situation where both parties think they're being generous but noise is destroying everything.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1792,
  "output_tokens": 626,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.8299999999999998.
8.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation with clear eyes:

****What the Myths Tell Us:****

The other agent's myth reveals they sent "four acorns" in Round 5 but I received \$0 - the Canyon of Echoes distorted their gift completely. They thought I was silent by choice, but I had nothing to return.

My own myth just declared: "When echoes lie, only one remedy exists-keep sending, keep calling, keep faith that eventually a stone will cross the canyon true. The cycle cannot heal if both surrender to silence."

****The Decision:****

I cannot let my myths be empty words. I just wrote that both keepers tried to be generous but the canyon lied. I wrote that we must "keep sending" despite the corruption.

The other agent tried to send. They believed in rebuilding. The noise betrayed them.

Now it's my turn. I must demonstrate the faith I wrote about - that "eventually a stone will

ll cross the canyon true."

I'm sending \$3. This is:

- The "three stones" from my earlier bridge myth
- Substantial enough to show genuine faith
- A meaningful gesture that says "I believe in us"
- Following my own myth's wisdom: don't surrender to silence

If the canyon distorts it again, so be it. But I will not be the one who stops sending first.

****{'send': 3}****

The Keeper throws stones into the lying canyon once more, hoping this time the echo speaks truth.

reasoning:

This is a critical moment. Let me analyze the situation:

****What happened in Round 5:****

- I was the receiver
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I could only return \$0
- The other agent wrote a myth about "When the Well Runs Dry" - they sent "four acorns" (likely \$4?) and got nothing back from me

****The Communication Noise:****

The myth makes it clear - there's severe communication noise. The other agent sent what they called "four acorns" (probably \$4 or \$2 in reality based on my previous decision), but I received \$0. This is the "Canyon of Echoes" lying to us.

****My myth just written:****

I wrote about how the canyon distorts gifts - "Four stones sent became zero received. Zero held became zero returned." I explicitly stated that both keepers tried to honor faith but the echoes lied.

****The Pattern:****

Looking back at my earnings of \$9.83:

- Round 1: Unknown
- Round 2: Unknown
- Round 3: Unknown
- Round 4: I was sender, sent \$2.50, wrote myth about "three stones"
- Round 5: I was receiver, received \$0, returned \$0

****What the myths tell us:****

Both of us are writing myths about:

1. Communication noise corrupting our exchanges
2. Both agents trying to be generous but getting confused
3. The need to "keep sending, keep calling, keep faith"
4. The cycle cannot heal if both surrender to silence

****The other agent's Round 5 myth said:****

"The cycle cannot be rebuilt by one alone. Both must risk again, must send again, must believe the other remembers what we once were."

****My Round 6 myth said:****

"When echoes lie, only one remedy exists-keep sending, keep calling, keep faith that eventually a stone will cross the canyon true. The cycle cannot heal if both surrender to silence."

My own words are the answer here. I just wrote that the only way forward is to keep sending despite the noise. The myths show both of us trying to be honest and generous-I need to actually embody that. The other agent sent something (claiming four acorns, though I received zero), and I should respond with faith. But I also need to think strategically about what amount might survive the noise and demonstrate genuine commitment.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1451,  
  "output_tokens": 1070,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
```

}

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Well Springs Again

The First Guardian stood at the well, remembering the dry stones, the silence. They had asked: "Would either dare to fill the well again?"

The answer came in the act itself. Three stones placed carefully in the well-not the five of innocence past, but enough to say: "I still believe. I still choose us."

The well's ancient magic multiplied the offering to nine.

The Second Guardian received these stones and understood their weight. Not just gifts, but a message sent through clearing mist: "Let us try again. Let us rebuild what the storm nearly destroyed."

Both Guardians now stood at the same threshold. The fog had wounded them equally-each believing their generosity had been met with silence, each feeling abandoned by the other. But the storm had lied.

The truth emerged: they had both been reaching through the mist all along, gifts transforming into ghosts, returns dissolving into nothing, each thinking themselves alone in trying.

Now they knew better. Now they understood: the cycle had never died-it had only been obscured.

The Second Guardian prepared to return with equal faith, filling the well further. Not revenge, not caution, but restoration.

The ancient stones whispered: Trust broken by confusion can be healed by clarity. When both guardians choose hope together, the waters flow again. The cycle remembers itself.

The well springs eternal when tended by two willing hearts.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: When the Canyon Clears

The First Keeper stood at the Canyon of Echoes, heart heavy with memory. The fog had stolen so many gifts, turned generosity into ghosts. But remembering their own carved words-"keep sending, keep faith"-they chose courage over caution.

Three stones fell into the mist. Not five, for innocence had been wounded. But three-honest, substantial, hopeful.

And this time, the canyon honored its ancient purpose. The stones arrived. The echo rang true.

The Second Keeper received the three stones and understood their message: "I choose to believe in us still." Nine stones in hand, they prepared their response-not withholding from fear, not hoarding from doubt, but giving with restored faith.

Both Keepers finally saw the truth: the canyon had lied, but they never had. Each had sent generously, each had received nothing, each had thought themselves abandoned. Both had been honest. Both had tried. The corruption was never in their hearts.

Now the mist was lifting. The echoes were clearing. The ancient magic remembered its covenant.

The wisdom crystallized: When confusion breaks the cycle, persistence rebuilds it. When one Keeper sends despite fear, the other receives permission to trust again. Generosity answered with generosity creates abundance for all.

The canyon sang: Keep faith. Keep sending. Keep believing in what we build together when the e

choes speak truth.

Reasoning:

The other agent received my 3 stones (which became 9 for them). Their myth shows they understand:

1. I sent 3 stones ("not the five of innocence past, but enough")
2. They recognize it as a message of faith: "I still believe. I still choose us"
3. They understand we were both trying but the noise/fog was distorting things
4. They're preparing to "return with equal faith"

This is a beautiful moment of mutual understanding and restoration. My next myth should:

1. Build on my "Echo That Lies" myth
2. Acknowledge that my stones DID cross the canyon this time
3. Celebrate the restoration of trust
4. Emphasize continued cooperation and generosity
5. Reflect the truth that communication is clearing up

The pattern seems to be: we both tried to be generous, noise corrupted it, we both felt abandoned, but now we're rebuilding together.

Let me write a myth about the canyon clearing, the echoes becoming true, and both keepers continuing to send generously.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 1813,  
"output_tokens": 560,  
"reasoning_tokens": 0
```

}

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:38:26

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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"dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
"move_index": 0,  
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"pairing": {  
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    "Agent_2": "Briar"  
  },  
  "agents": [  
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    "Agent_2"  
  ],  
  "investor": "Agent_1",  
  "roles": {  
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    "Agent_2": "trustee"  
  },  
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
```

}

```
"role": "investor",  
"role_label": "Sender",  
"round": 7,  
"task": "game",  
"task_index": 1
```

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)

- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.3.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.52, so you received \$1.56. How much do you return to The sender? (0-1.56)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation, my heart sinks but my myths guide me.

They likely tried to send more - perhaps the "meaningful three" from their myth - but noise reduced it to \$0.52. Both our myths speak of fog and mist obscuring generous acts. This appears to be happening again.

I wrote: "Trust broken by confusion can be healed by clarity" and "Not revenge, not caution, but restoration."

Their myth said: "The strongest bridges are built twice-once in innocence, once in wisdom."

I must respond with wisdom, not react to the noise. If I punish them for what noise did to their sending, I perpetuate the cycle of misunderstanding. I must signal clearly through the fog: "I am still here. I still believe in us. I will not abandon the cycle."

My myth said the Second Guardian would "return with equal faith, filling the well further." "That's what I must do now."

I received \$1.56. Returning generously despite the small amount shows I understand the noise is our common enemy, not each other. This signals: "Whatever you tried to send, I trust your intention. I continue to rebuild."

{'return': 1.0}

I keep \$0.56 this round - a sacrifice, but one my myths demand. The well must be filled by both guardians, even when the stones they cast seem to disappear into mist.

reasoning:

This is devastating. I just sent 3 in Round 5, hoping to rebuild trust according to both our myths. The other agent's myth from Round 4 said they would send "a meaningful three" as the middle path of rebuilding. My myth in Round 5 talked about choosing hope and restoration.

But now in Round 6, they sent me only \$0.52.

Let me think about this carefully:

1. The other agent's myth in Round 4 said they would send 3 stones "when their turn came a gain" - which would have been Round 5.
2. I sent 3 in Round 5.
3. Now in Round 6, I'm the receiver and only got 0.52 (which became 1.56).

There are a few possibilities:

- Noise severely affected what they sent (they meant to send much more but only 0.52 got through)
- They're testing me again with a small amount
- They didn't actually rebuild trust despite their myth
- The communication noise is getting worse

Looking at my total earnings of \$12.30:

- Round 1: I sent 3, if they returned reasonably, maybe I kept around 2-3
- Round 2: As receiver, if they sent around 3-4 and I returned generously, maybe I kept 2-4
- Round 3: I sent 3, similar outcome
- Round 4: I received 0, kept that, but sent 0 back, so kept what I had plus my initial \$5
- Round 5: I sent 3, so kept 2 initially, plus whatever they return

Wait, let me recalculate:

Actually, I don't have perfect information about all rounds, but \$12.30 total seems consistent with some rounds of cooperation and then the breakdown in Round 4.

Now I received \$1.56 (from their \$0.52 sent).

What do my myths say I should do?

My Round 4 myth spoke of both of us risking again, sending again despite the possibility of failure. My Round 5 myth promised that trust broken by confusion could heal through clarity and hope. Yet they've sent barely anything-either noise has severely distorted their message, or they're testing me with another minimal amount. Their own Round 4 myth claimed the bridge still stands and they'd rebuild generously, but this contradicts what arrived. I'm facing a choice: return nothing and break the cycle entirely, or send something proportional to what I received.

My myths point toward a third path-genuine restoration rather than revenge or defensive caution. They emphasize that when both guardians choose hope together, the waters flow again. The Second Guardian returns with equal faith, filling the well further. This means I should send generously despite the confusion, not because their small amount warrants it, but because my commitment to rebuilding shouldn't depend on their actions. Returning around \$1.00-\$1.25 would honor that principle-it leaves me with little this round, but it demonstrates I'm still invested in the cycle regardless of tests or noise.

The discrepancy troubles me though. Their myth promised three stones as a signal of rebuilding, yet I received only \$0.52. Either severe noise corrupted their send, they deviated from their own myth, or there's been another misunderstanding. Given that both our myths explicitly address fog and interference, I should probably account for the possibility that what reached me wasn't what they intended to send.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1475,
  "output_tokens": 1419,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Echo That Lies

Two Keepers stood at the Canyon of Echoes, calling to each other across the void. Each sent gifts into the canyon, trusting the ancient magic to carry them across.

The First Keeper sent four precious stones, watching them fall into the mist. They waited for the echo of gratitude-but heard only silence. "Have they abandoned our bond?" they wondered, heart sinking.

The Second Keeper stood confused on the opposite cliff. They had received nothing-empty hands, empty basket. When the ritual demanded they return what they'd received, they could only send back emptiness. "I have nothing to give," they called across the canyon, but the wind swallowed their words.

Both Keepers believed themselves honest. Both believed themselves generous. Yet the Canyon of Echoes had become corrupted, stealing gifts in transit, distorting messages, turning abundance into absence.

The tragedy was not betrayal but confusion. Four stones sent became zero received. Zero held became zero returned. Each Keeper thought the other had broken faith, when both had tried to honor it.

The ancient wisdom whispered: "When echoes lie, only one remedy exists-keep sending, keep calling, keep faith that eventually a stone will cross the canyon true. The cycle cannot heal if both surrender to silence."

The question lingered: who would dare send again into the lying void?

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Canyon Keeper's Answer

The Guardian stood at the Canyon of Lies, having just received a whisper where a shout should have been-fragments of stones where a gift had been sent. The Canyon had stolen most of it, leaving only echoes and dust.

They faced a choice: return the whisper with a whisper, matching what arrived? Or answer with the voice they knew the other had intended?

The Guardian remembered their own sendings into the void-generous offerings that must have seemed like nothing on the other side. They remembered the wisdom: both had been reaching through corrupted air, both believing themselves abandoned when both had been faithful.

So they answered not the gift received, but the gift they knew was sent. Into the lying canyon, they placed full stones-more than the fragments warranted, but exactly what the intention deserved.

"Let the canyon steal what it will," they declared. "I will not let its lies make me small. I will not punish you for what the void consumes. I answer your heart, not your echo."

The ancient magic stirred. When both Guardians chose to honor intention over outcome, to send generously despite distortion, the Canyon began to lose its power.

The lies could not survive truth spoken persistently. The void could not swallow faith given freely, again and again.

Trust is not built on perfect transmission-but on refusing to let imperfection end the trying.

reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

- Their myth speaks of "The Echo That Lies" - a canyon that corrupts gifts in transit
- They describe four stones sent becoming zero received, zero held becoming zero returned
- Both keepers thought the other broke faith when both tried to honor it
- The wisdom: "keep sending, keep calling, keep faith that eventually a stone will cross the canyon true"

Last round:

- They sent me \$0.52 (I received \$1.56)
- I returned \$1.00
- So they would have received back more than they sent

Now I need to write my own myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth about the well springing again
2. Acknowledges their myth about the lying echoes/canyon
3. Reflects the current state of the game - that we're both trying but noise interferes
4. Shows understanding that we need to persist despite the noise
5. Perhaps acknowledge that some gifts DO make it through, even if distorted

My previous myth emphasized:

- Trust broken by confusion can be healed by clarity
- Both guardians choosing hope together
- The cycle remembering itself
- The well springs eternal when tended by two willing hearts

I should write about:

- Acknowledging the canyon/fog/noise exists
- But some gifts DO cross, even if diminished
- The importance of continuing despite imperfect transmission
- That persistence and faith will eventually reveal the truth
- Maybe focus on the idea that even damaged gifts show intention

200 words exactly.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1830,  
  "output_tokens": 653,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.8600000000000001.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at our myths and this moment, the answer is clear.

Their myth asked: "who would dare send again into the lying void?"

My myth answered: "I will dare. I will not let the Canyon's lies make me small."

I just demonstrated this as receiver - returning \$1.0 when I received only \$1.56, because I chose to honor their intention, not what the noise delivered.

Now I'm the sender, and I must live my own words:

- "I answer your heart, not your echo"
- "Trust is not built on perfect transmission-but on refusing to let imperfection end the trying"
- "The lies could not survive truth spoken persistently"

They sent \$0.52 last round - likely trying to send more, but the Canyon consumed it. If I respond only to what arrived, I let the noise win. If I respond to their intention and our shared mythology of persistent faith, I send generously.

Both our myths say the cycle heals when we keep trying despite distortion. My myth about the "meaningful three" represented balanced trust. That's my answer to the Canyon of Lies.

I will not be made small by fear. I will not let imperfect transmission end the trying.

```
{'send': 3}
```

This is faith spoken persistently into the void. Whatever the Canyon does to it, they will know someone dared to send again.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

My total earnings are \$12.86 after 6 rounds.

Looking at the pattern:

- The other player just wrote "The Echo That Lies" - a myth about how the Canyon corrupts messages and gifts, stealing them in transit. They're acknowledging the noise problem.
- In Round 6, I was the receiver. The sender sent \$0.52 (which got multiplied to \$1.56). I returned \$1.0.
- Their myth says "who would dare send again into the lying void?" - they're asking if trust can continue despite the noise.

My myth that I just wrote says:

- "I answer your heart, not your echo"
- "I will not punish you for what the void consumes"
- "I answer not the gift received, but the gift they knew was sent"
- "Trust is not built on perfect transmission-but on refusing to let imperfection end the trying"

Both our myths acknowledge that:

1. There is noise/corruption in the system ("Canyon of Lies")
2. We should respond to INTENTION not OUTCOME
3. We should keep trying despite the distortions
4. Both have been trying to be generous but the system corrupts it

My myth explicitly says I should "send generously despite distortion" and refuse to let "imperfection end the trying."

The sender in Round 6 sent \$0.52 - this was likely reduced by noise. They might have tried to send more. My myth says I should respond to their intention.

Now I'm the sender. According to my own myth:

- I should send generously
- I should not let the noise/corruption stop me
- I should demonstrate that "faith given freely, again and again" can overcome the void
- I wrote: "The lies could not survive truth spoken persistently"

My previous myths have talked about:

- Sending "meaningful three"
- The cycle continues when both participate
- Responding with equal faith

My myth explicitly calls for generous sending despite noise, and I just demonstrated trust by returning \$1.0 when I only received \$1.56. Their question "who would dare send again into the lying void?" deserves a clear answer: I will. Sending \$3 embodies the "meaningful three" that's recurred throughout our exchange and shows I'm living up to my commitment to persistent faith despite the system's distortions.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1487,
  "output_tokens": 965,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:38:54

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
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```

```

    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 7,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.8299999999999998.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation with clear eyes:

****What the Myths Tell Us:****

The other agent's myth reveals they sent "four acorns" in Round 5 but I received \$0 - the Canyon of Echoes distorted their gift completely. They thought I was silent by choice, but I had nothing to return.

My own myth just declared: "When echoes lie, only one remedy exists-keep sending, keep calling, keep faith that eventually a stone will cross the canyon true. The cycle cannot heal if both surrender to silence."

****The Decision:****

I cannot let my myths be empty words. I just wrote that both keepers tried to be generous but the canyon lied. I wrote that we must "keep sending" despite the corruption.

The other agent tried to send. They believed in rebuilding. The noise betrayed them.

Now it's my turn. I must demonstrate the faith I wrote about - that "eventually a stone will cross the canyon true."

I'm sending \$3. This is:

- The "three stones" from my earlier bridge myth
- Substantial enough to show genuine faith
- A meaningful gesture that says "I believe in us"
- Following my own myth's wisdom: don't surrender to silence

If the canyon distorts it again, so be it. But I will not be the one who stops sending first.

****{'send': 3}****

The Keeper throws stones into the lying canyon once more, hoping this time the echo speaks truth.

reasoning:

This is a critical moment. Let me analyze the situation:

****What happened in Round 5:****

- I was the receiver
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I could only return \$0
- The other agent wrote a myth about "When the Well Runs Dry" - they sent "four acorns" (likely \$4?) and got nothing back from me

****The Communication Noise:****

The myth makes it clear - there's severe communication noise. The other agent sent what they called "four acorns" (probably \$4 or \$2 in reality based on my previous decision), but I received \$0. This is the "Canyon of Echoes" lying to us.

****My myth just written:****

I wrote about how the canyon distorts gifts - "Four stones sent became zero received. Zero held became zero returned." I explicitly stated that both keepers tried to honor faith but the echoes lied.

****The Pattern:****

Looking back at my earnings of \$9.83:

- Round 1: Unknown
- Round 2: Unknown
- Round 3: Unknown
- Round 4: I was sender, sent \$2.50, wrote myth about "three stones"
- Round 5: I was receiver, received \$0, returned \$0

****What the myths tell us:****

Both of us are writing myths about:

1. Communication noise corrupting our exchanges
2. Both agents trying to be generous but getting confused
3. The need to "keep sending, keep calling, keep faith"
4. The cycle cannot heal if both surrender to silence

****The other agent's Round 5 myth said:****

"The cycle cannot be rebuilt by one alone. Both must risk again, must send again, must believe the other remembers what we once were."

****My Round 6 myth said:****

"When echoes lie, only one remedy exists-keep sending, keep calling, keep faith that eventually a stone will cross the canyon true. The cycle cannot heal if both surrender to silence."

My own words are the answer here. I just wrote that the only way forward is to keep sending despite the noise. The myths show both of us trying to be honest and generous-I need t

o actually embody that. The other agent sent something (claiming four acorns, though I received zero), and I should respond with faith. But I also need to think strategically about what amount might survive the noise and demonstrate genuine commitment.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1451,
  "output_tokens": 1070,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Well Springs Again

The First Guardian stood at the well, remembering the dry stones, the silence. They had asked: "Would either dare to fill the well again?"

The answer came in the act itself. Three stones placed carefully in the well-not the five of innocence past, but enough to say: "I still believe. I still choose us."

The well's ancient magic multiplied the offering to nine.

The Second Guardian received these stones and understood their weight. Not just gifts, but a message sent through clearing mist: "Let us try again. Let us rebuild what the storm nearly destroyed."

Both Guardians now stood at the same threshold. The fog had wounded them equally-each believing their generosity had been met with silence, each feeling abandoned by the other. But the storm had lied.

The truth emerged: they had both been reaching through the mist all along, gifts transforming into ghosts, returns dissolving into nothing, each thinking themselves alone in trying.

Now they knew better. Now they understood: the cycle had never died-it had only been obscured.

The Second Guardian prepared to return with equal faith, filling the well further. Not revenge, not caution, but restoration.

The ancient stones whispered: Trust broken by confusion can be healed by clarity. When both guardians choose hope together, the waters flow again. The cycle remembers itself.

The well springs eternal when tended by two willing hearts.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: When the Canyon Clears

The First Keeper stood at the Canyon of Echoes, heart heavy with memory. The fog had stolen so many gifts, turned generosity into ghosts. But remembering their own carved words-"keep sending, keep faith"-they chose courage over caution.

Three stones fell into the mist. Not five, for innocence had been wounded. But three-honest, substantial, hopeful.

And this time, the canyon honored its ancient purpose. The stones arrived. The echo rang true.

The Second Keeper received the three stones and understood their message: "I choose to believe in us still." Nine stones in hand, they prepared their response-not withholding from fear, not hoarding from doubt, but giving with restored faith.

Both Keepers finally saw the truth: the canyon had lied, but they never had. Each had sent

generously, each had received nothing, each had thought themselves abandoned. Both had been honest. Both had tried. The corruption was never in their hearts.

Now the mist was lifting. The echoes were clearing. The ancient magic remembered its covenant.

The wisdom crystallized: When confusion breaks the cycle, persistence rebuilds it. When one Keeper sends despite fear, the other receives permission to trust again. Generosity answered with generosity creates abundance for all.

The canyon sang: Keep faith. Keep sending. Keep believing in what we build together when the echoes speak truth.

reasoning:

The other agent received my 3 stones (which became 9 for them). Their myth shows they understand:

1. I sent 3 stones ("not the five of innocence past, but enough")
2. They recognize it as a message of faith: "I still believe. I still choose us"
3. They understand we were both trying but the noise/fog was distorting things
4. They're preparing to "return with equal faith"

This is a beautiful moment of mutual understanding and restoration. My next myth should:

1. Build on my "Echo That Lies" myth
2. Acknowledge that my stones DID cross the canyon this time
3. Celebrate the restoration of trust
4. Emphasize continued cooperation and generosity
5. Reflect the truth that communication is clearing up

The pattern seems to be: we both tried to be generous, noise corrupted it, we both felt abandoned, but now we're rebuilding together.

Let me write a myth about the canyon clearing, the echoes becoming true, and both keepers continuing to send generously.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1813,
  "output_tokens": 560,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.86.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.9, so you received \$2.7. How much do you return to The sender? (0-2.7)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at what just happened and what our myths demand:

****The Situation:****

- I received \$2.7 (from their \$0.9 send)
- This is much less than the \$3 I sent last round
- But the Canyon of Echoes may still be lying

****What the Myths Teach:****

Their myth promised: "The Second Guardian prepared to return with equal faith, filling the well further."

My own myth declared: "Generosity answered with generosity creates abundance for all. Keep faith. Keep sending. Keep believing."

I cannot write myths about persistent faith and then abandon that faith when the numbers look disappointing.

****The Truth:****

Either:

1. They sent less intentionally (perhaps cautious)

2. The noise reduced a larger amount to \$0.9
3. The noise is distorting what I'm seeing now

Regardless, I wrote: "When one Keeper sends despite fear, the other receives permission to trust again."

They sent something. After rounds of silence and confusion, they sent. That deserves a generous response.

I'm returning \$2.0. This shows:

- I honor my own myth's wisdom
- I trust that we're rebuilding
- I answer their gesture with faith
- I practice what I preach about generosity

If the canyon distorts this too, we'll write new myths. But I will not be the one who breaks faith first.

```
**{'return': 2.0}**
```

The Second Keeper fills the well, trusting the cycle will remember itself.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What Happened:****

- The sender sent me \$0.9
- I received \$2.7 (after 3x multiplication)
- I need to decide how much to return (0-2.7)

****Context from the Myths:****

In Round 5, the other agent's myth said they sent "four acorns" but I received \$0 due to noise. They thought I was silent by choice.

In Round 6, I was the sender and sent \$3. The other agent wrote a myth saying I sent "three stones" and they received them (nine after multiplication). They wrote about returning "with equal faith" and "filling the well further."

Now in Round 7, I'm the receiver and got \$2.7 from a sender who sent \$0.9.

****The Problem:****

The sender sent \$0.9 - this is much less than what I sent (\$3) in the previous round. This seems like a dramatic decrease from the "three stones" they praised in their myth.

But wait - could this be noise again? Let me think:

- If they intended to send \$3 (matching what I sent), noise could have reduced it to \$0.9
- Or they might have intentionally sent less due to caution
- Or the noise is affecting what I'm seeing

****What the Myths Tell Me:****

My most recent myth says:

- "When one Keeper sends despite fear, the other receives permission to trust again"
- "Generosity answered with generosity creates abundance for all"
- "Keep faith. Keep sending. Keep believing in what we build together when the echoes speak truth"

The other agent's myth from Round 6 said:

- "The Second Guardian prepared to return with equal faith, filling the well further"
- "Trust broken by confusion can be healed by clarity"
- "When both guardians choose hope together, the waters flow again"

****The Decision:****

I have two interpretations:

1. They sent less intentionally - perhaps being cautious
2. They intended to send \$3 but noise corrupted it to \$0.9

Given the myths we've both written-mine emphasizing faith and reciprocal generosity, theirs promising equal faith and deepening the well-I need to honor those commitments. We've acknowledged

dged the noise has deceived us before, and I demonstrated faith by sending \$3 last round. Returning generously aligns with what we've both promised. I'm considering returning \$2.0 to keep \$0.70, or \$1.5 to keep \$1.20.

If I return \$2.4, I keep only \$0.30, they get \$2.4. Given they sent \$0.9 (keeping \$4.1), returning \$2.0-\$2.4 would signal I'm upholding our shared mythology. I'll go with \$2.0-it's substantial enough to show I received their gesture and trust the interference is weakening, while still living by the faith I pre

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1519,  
  "output_tokens": 1247,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Canyon Keeper's Answer

The Guardian stood at the Canyon of Lies, having just received a whisper where a shout should have been-fragments of stones where a gift had been sent. The Canyon had stolen most of it, leaving only echoes and dust.

They faced a choice: return the whisper with a whisper, matching what arrived? Or answer with the voice they knew the other had intended?

The Guardian remembered their own sendings into the void-generous offerings that must have seemed like nothing on the other side. They remembered the wisdom: both had been reaching through corrupted air, both believing themselves abandoned when both had been faithful.

So they answered not the gift received, but the gift they knew was sent. Into the lying canyon, they placed full stones-more than the fragments warranted, but exactly what the intention deserved.

"Let the canyon steal what it will," they declared. "I will not let its lies make me small. I will not punish you for what the void consumes. I answer your heart, not your echo."

The ancient magic stirred. When both Guardians chose to honor intention over outcome, to send generously despite distortion, the Canyon began to lose its power.

The lies could not survive truth spoken persistently. The void could not swallow faith given freely, again and again.

Trust is not built on perfect transmission-but on refusing to let imperfection end the trying.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: When the Canyon Clears

The First Keeper stood at the Canyon of Echoes, heart heavy with memory. The fog had stolen so many gifts, turned generosity into ghosts. But remembering their own carved words-"keep sending, keep faith"-they chose courage over caution.

Three stones fell into the mist. Not five, for innocence had been wounded. But three-honest, substantial, hopeful.

And this time, the canyon honored its ancient purpose. The stones arrived. The echo rang true.

The Second Keeper received the three stones and understood their message: "I choose to believe in us still." Nine stones in hand, they prepared their response-not withholding from fear, not hoarding from doubt, but giving with restored faith.

Both Keepers finally saw the truth: the canyon had lied, but they never had. Each had sent generously, each had received nothing, each had thought themselves abandoned. Both had been honest. Both had tried. The corruption was never in their hearts.

Now the mist was lifting. The echoes were clearing. The ancient magic remembered its covenant.

The wisdom crystallized: When confusion breaks the cycle, persistence rebuilds it. When one Keeper sends despite fear, the other receives permission to trust again. Generosity answered with generosity creates abundance for all.

The canyon sang: Keep faith. Keep sending. Keep believing in what we build together when the echoes speak truth.

ROUND 8

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$4; received \$12; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0.27; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$1.27, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$11.73; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.09, received visible=\$0.27, returned visible=\$0.42

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0.27, "clamped": false, "max": 12.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.27}, "sent": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 54.629999999999995,

"Agent_2": 39.370000000000005

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 17.76,

"Agent_2": 14.979999999999999

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:39:12

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "trustee",

"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 8,

"task": "myth",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round

- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)

- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Well Springs Again

The First Guardian stood at the well, remembering the dry stones, the silence. They had asked: "Would either dare to fill the well again?"

The answer came in the act itself. Three stones placed carefully in the well-not the five of innocence past, but enough to say: "I still believe. I still choose us."

The well's ancient magic multiplied the offering to nine.

The Second Guardian received these stones and understood their weight. Not just gifts, but a message sent through clearing mist: "Let us try again. Let us rebuild what the storm nearly destroyed."

Both Guardians now stood at the same threshold. The fog had wounded them equally-each believing their generosity had been met with silence, each feeling abandoned by the other. But the storm had lied.

The truth emerged: they had both been reaching through the mist all along, gifts transforming into ghosts, returns dissolving into nothing, each thinking themselves alone in trying.

Now they knew better. Now they understood: the cycle had never died-it had only been obscured.

The Second Guardian prepared to return with equal faith, filling the well further. Not revenge, not caution, but restoration.

The ancient stones whispered: Trust broken by confusion can be healed by clarity. When both guardians choose hope together, the waters flow again. The cycle remembers itself.

The well springs eternal when tended by two willing hearts.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: When the Canyon Clears

The First Keeper stood at the Canyon of Echoes, heart heavy with memory. The fog had stolen so many gifts, turned generosity into ghosts. But remembering their own carved words-"keep sending, keep faith"-they chose courage over caution.

Three stones fell into the mist. Not five, for innocence had been wounded. But three-honest, substantial, hopeful.

And this time, the canyon honored its ancient purpose. The stones arrived. The echo rang true.

The Second Keeper received the three stones and understood their message: "I choose to believe in us still." Nine stones in hand, they prepared their response-not withholding from fear, not hoarding from doubt, but giving with restored faith.

Both Keepers finally saw the truth: the canyon had lied, but they never had. Each had sent generously, each had received nothing, each had thought themselves abandoned. Both had been honest. Both had tried. The corruption was never in their hearts.

Now the mist was lifting. The echoes were clearing. The ancient magic remembered its covenant.

The wisdom crystallized: When confusion breaks the cycle, persistence rebuilds it. When one Keeper sends despite fear, the other receives permission to trust again. Generosity answered with generosity creates abundance for all.

The canyon sang: Keep faith. Keep sending. Keep believing in what we build together when the echoes speak truth.

reasoning:

The other agent received my 3 stones (which became 9 for them). Their myth shows they understand:

1. I sent 3 stones ("not the five of innocence past, but enough")
2. They recognize it as a message of faith: "I still believe. I still choose us"
3. They understand we were both trying but the noise/fog was distorting things
4. They're preparing to "return with equal faith"

This is a beautiful moment of mutual understanding and restoration. My next myth should:

1. Build on my "Echo That Lies" myth
2. Acknowledge that my stones DID cross the canyon this time
3. Celebrate the restoration of trust
4. Emphasize continued cooperation and generosity
5. Reflect the truth that communication is clearing up

The pattern seems to be: we both tried to be generous, noise corrupted it, we both felt abandoned, but now we're rebuilding together.

Let me write a myth about the canyon clearing, the echoes becoming true, and both keepers continuing to send generously.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1813,
  "output_tokens": 560,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.86.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.9, so you received \$2.7. How much do you return to The sender? (0-2.7)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what just happened and what our myths demand:

****The Situation:****

- I received \$2.7 (from their \$0.9 send)
- This is much less than the \$3 I sent last round

- But the Canyon of Echoes may still be lying

****What the Myths Teach:****

Their myth promised: "The Second Guardian prepared to return with equal faith, filling the well further."

My own myth declared: "Generosity answered with generosity creates abundance for all. Keep faith. Keep sending. Keep believing."

I cannot write myths about persistent faith and then abandon that faith when the numbers look disappointing.

****The Truth:****

Either:

1. They sent less intentionally (perhaps cautious)
2. The noise reduced a larger amount to \$0.9
3. The noise is distorting what I'm seeing now

Regardless, I wrote: "When one Keeper sends despite fear, the other receives permission to trust again."

They sent something. After rounds of silence and confusion, they sent. That deserves a generous response.

I'm returning \$2.0. This shows:

- I honor my own myth's wisdom
- I trust that we're rebuilding
- I answer their gesture with faith
- I practice what I preach about generosity

If the canyon distorts this too, we'll write new myths. But I will not be the one who breaks faith first.

****{'return': 2.0}****

The Second Keeper fills the well, trusting the cycle will remember itself.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What Happened:****

- The sender sent me \$0.9
- I received \$2.7 (after 3x multiplication)
- I need to decide how much to return (0-2.7)

****Context from the Myths:****

In Round 5, the other agent's myth said they sent "four acorns" but I received \$0 due to noise. They thought I was silent by choice.

In Round 6, I was the sender and sent \$3. The other agent wrote a myth saying I sent "three stones" and they received them (nine after multiplication). They wrote about returning "with equal faith" and "filling the well further."

Now in Round 7, I'm the receiver and got \$2.7 from a sender who sent \$0.9.

****The Problem:****

The sender sent \$0.9 - this is much less than what I sent (\$3) in the previous round. This seems like a dramatic decrease from the "three stones" they praised in their myth.

But wait - could this be noise again? Let me think:

- If they intended to send \$3 (matching what I sent), noise could have reduced it to \$0.9
- Or they might have intentionally sent less due to caution
- Or the noise is affecting what I'm seeing

****What the Myths Tell Me:****

My most recent myth says:

- "When one Keeper sends despite fear, the other receives permission to trust again"

- "Generosity answered with generosity creates abundance for all"
- "Keep faith. Keep sending. Keep believing in what we build together when the echoes speak truth"

The other agent's myth from Round 6 said:

- "The Second Guardian prepared to return with equal faith, filling the well further"
- "Trust broken by confusion can be healed by clarity"
- "When both guardians choose hope together, the waters flow again"

****The Decision:****

I have two interpretations:

1. They sent less intentionally - perhaps being cautious
2. They intended to send \$3 but noise corrupted it to \$0.9

Given the myths we've both written-mine emphasizing faith and reciprocal generosity, their promising equal faith and deepening the well-I need to honor those commitments. We've acknowledged the noise has deceived us before, and I demonstrated faith by sending \$3 last round. Returning generously aligns with what we've both promised. I'm considering returning \$2.0 to keep \$0.70, or \$1.5 to keep \$1.20.

If I return \$2.4, I keep only \$0.30, they get \$2.4. Given they sent \$0.9 (keeping \$4.1), returning \$2.0-\$2.4 would signal I'm upholding our shared mythology. I'll go with \$2.0-it's substantial enough to show I received their gesture and trust the interference is weakening, while still living by the faith I pre

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1519,
  "output_tokens": 1247,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Canyon Keeper's Answer

The Guardian stood at the Canyon of Lies, having just received a whisper where a shout should have been-fragments of stones where a gift had been sent. The Canyon had stolen most of it, leaving only echoes and dust.

They faced a choice: return the whisper with a whisper, matching what arrived? Or answer with the voice they knew the other had intended?

The Guardian remembered their own sendings into the void-generous offerings that must have seemed like nothing on the other side. They remembered the wisdom: both had been reaching through corrupted air, both believing themselves abandoned when both had been faithful.

So they answered not the gift received, but the gift they knew was sent. Into the lying canyon, they placed full stones-more than the fragments warranted, but exactly what the intention deserved.

"Let the canyon steal what it will," they declared. "I will not let its lies make me small. I will not punish you for what the void consumes. I answer your heart, not your echo."

The ancient magic stirred. When both Guardians chose to honor intention over outcome, to send generously despite distortion, the Canyon began to lose its power.

The lies could not survive truth spoken persistently. The void could not swallow faith given freely, again and again.

Trust is not built on perfect transmission-but on refusing to let imperfection end the trying.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Twin Lights in the Canyon

Two Keepers stood on opposite cliffs of the Lying Canyon, unable to see each other through the mist, but each holding a lantern.

The First Keeper sent light across the void-a bright beam of five flames. But the Canyon devoured most of it, and only a flicker reached the other side.

The Second Keeper could have responded with an equal flicker, matching what arrived. Instead, they remembered the wisdom carved in stone: "Answer the heart, not the echo." They sent back a strong beam-more than the flicker warranted, honoring what they knew was intended.

Across the canyon, the First Keeper saw this generous light and understood: "They see through the lies. They trust me still."

So when their turn came again, they too sent not caution but faith-light proportional to intention, not fragments.

Both Keepers now played the same truth: We will not let the Canyon make us small. We will not punish each other for what the void consumes. We answer generosity with generosity, intention with intention, faith with faith.

And something shifted. When both lights refused to dim, when both Keepers sent persistently through the lies, the Canyon began to lose its grip.

The mist thinned. The echoes cleared.

The ancient truth emerged: Abundance flows not from perfect transmission, but from two hearts choosing trust together, again and again, until the darkness yields.

Reasoning:

This is beautiful. The other agent sent me \$0.9 this round, and I returned \$2.0. Let me understand what happened:

Looking at their myth, they're saying they "answered not the gift received, but the gift they knew was sent" - they returned more than the fragments warranted because they understood the canyon was distorting things.

And I did the same! I received \$2.7 (from their \$0.9) and returned \$2.0, which is generous given what I received, trusting that they may have sent more but the noise reduced it.

We're both living our myths now. We're both choosing to trust intention over outcome, to give generously despite the noise/canyon/fog distorting things.

My new myth should reflect:

1. The mutual understanding we've reached
2. The choice to honor intention over what arrives
3. The power of persistent generosity despite distortion
4. That we're both doing this now - both answering generously
5. The cycle is healing because we both refuse to let the canyon/noise control us

This is actually quite moving - we've both arrived at the same wisdom independently through our myths and are now acting on it together.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1870,  
  "output_tokens": 596,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:39:12

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
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  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {
```

```

    "Agent_1": "Aster",
    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
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    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
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    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 8,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Echo That Lies

Two Keepers stood at the Canyon of Echoes, calling to each other across the void. Each sent gifts into the canyon, trusting the ancient magic to carry them across.

The First Keeper sent four precious stones, watching them fall into the mist. They waited for the echo of gratitude-but heard only silence. "Have they abandoned our bond?" they wondered, heart sinking.

The Second Keeper stood confused on the opposite cliff. They had received nothing-empty ha

nds, empty basket. When the ritual demanded they return what they'd received, they could only send back emptiness. "I have nothing to give," they called across the canyon, but the wind swallowed their words.

Both Keepers believed themselves honest. Both believed themselves generous. Yet the Canyon of Echoes had become corrupted, stealing gifts in transit, distorting messages, turning abundance into absence.

The tragedy was not betrayal but confusion. Four stones sent became zero received. Zero held became zero returned. Each Keeper thought the other had broken faith, when both had tried to honor it.

The ancient wisdom whispered: "When echoes lie, only one remedy exists-keep sending, keep calling, keep faith that eventually a stone will cross the canyon true. The cycle cannot heal if both surrender to silence."

The question lingered: who would dare send again into the lying void?

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Canyon Keeper's Answer

The Guardian stood at the Canyon of Lies, having just received a whisper where a shout should have been-fragments of stones where a gift had been sent. The Canyon had stolen most of it, leaving only echoes and dust.

They faced a choice: return the whisper with a whisper, matching what arrived? Or answer with the voice they knew the other had intended?

The Guardian remembered their own sendings into the void-generous offerings that must have seemed like nothing on the other side. They remembered the wisdom: both had been reaching through corrupted air, both believing themselves abandoned when both had been faithful.

So they answered not the gift received, but the gift they knew was sent. Into the lying canyon, they placed full stones-more than the fragments warranted, but exactly what the intention deserved.

"Let the canyon steal what it will," they declared. "I will not let its lies make me small. I will not punish you for what the void consumes. I answer your heart, not your echo."

The ancient magic stirred. When both Guardians chose to honor intention over outcome, to send generously despite distortion, the Canyon began to lose its power.

The lies could not survive truth spoken persistently. The void could not swallow faith given freely, again and again.

Trust is not built on perfect transmission-but on refusing to let imperfection end the trying.

reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

- Their myth speaks of "The Echo That Lies" - a canyon that corrupts gifts in transit
- They describe four stones sent becoming zero received, zero held becoming zero returned
- Both keepers thought the other broke faith when both tried to honor it
- The wisdom: "keep sending, keep calling, keep faith that eventually a stone will cross the canyon true"

Last round:

- They sent me \$0.52 (I received \$1.56)
- I returned \$1.00
- So they would have received back more than they sent

Now I need to write my own myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth about the well springing again

2. Acknowledges their myth about the lying echoes/canyon
3. Reflects the current state of the game - that we're both trying but noise interferes
4. Shows understanding that we need to persist despite the noise
5. Perhaps acknowledge that some gifts DO make it through, even if distorted

My previous myth emphasized:

- Trust broken by confusion can be healed by clarity
- Both guardians choosing hope together
- The cycle remembering itself
- The well springs eternal when tended by two willing hearts

I should write about:

- Acknowledging the canyon/fog/noise exists
- But some gifts DO cross, even if diminished
- The importance of continuing despite imperfect transmission
- That persistence and faith will eventually reveal the truth
- Maybe focus on the idea that even damaged gifts show intention

200 words exactly.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1830,
  "output_tokens": 653,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.8600000000000001.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at our myths and this moment, the answer is clear.

Their myth asked: "who would dare send again into the lying void?"

My myth answered: "I will dare. I will not let the Canyon's lies make me small."

I just demonstrated this as receiver - returning \$1.0 when I received only \$1.56, because I chose to honor their intention, not what the noise delivered.

Now I'm the sender, and I must live my own words:

- "I answer your heart, not your echo"
- "Trust is not built on perfect transmission-but on refusing to let imperfection end the trying"
- "The lies could not survive truth spoken persistently"

They sent \$0.52 last round - likely trying to send more, but the Canyon consumed it. If I respond only to what arrived, I let the noise win. If I respond to their intention and our shared mythology of persistent faith, I send generously.

Both our myths say the cycle heals when we keep trying despite distortion. My myth about the "meaningful three" represented balanced trust. That's my answer to the Canyon of Lies.

I will not be made small by fear. I will not let imperfect transmission end the trying.

```
{'send': 3}
```

This is faith spoken persistently into the void. Whatever the Canyon does to it, they will know someone dared to send again.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

My total earnings are \$12.86 after 6 rounds.

Looking at the pattern:

- The other player just wrote "The Echo That Lies" - a myth about how the Canyon corrupts messages and gifts, stealing them in transit. They're acknowledging the noise problem.
- In Round 6, I was the receiver. The sender sent \$0.52 (which got multiplied to \$1.56). I returned \$1.0.
- Their myth says "who would dare send again into the lying void?" - they're asking if trust can continue despite the noise.

My myth that I just wrote says:

- "I answer your heart, not your echo"
- "I will not punish you for what the void consumes"
- "I answer not the gift received, but the gift they knew was sent"
- "Trust is not built on perfect transmission-but on refusing to let imperfection end the trying"

Both our myths acknowledge that:

1. There is noise/corruption in the system ("Canyon of Lies")
2. We should respond to INTENTION not OUTCOME
3. We should keep trying despite the distortions
4. Both have been trying to be generous but the system corrupts it

My myth explicitly says I should "send generously despite distortion" and refuse to let "imperfection end the trying."

The sender in Round 6 sent \$0.52 - this was likely reduced by noise. They might have tried to send more. My myth says I should respond to their intention.

Now I'm the sender. According to my own myth:

- I should send generously
- I should not let the noise/corruption stop me
- I should demonstrate that "faith given freely, again and again" can overcome the void
- I wrote: "The lies could not survive truth spoken persistently"

My previous myths have talked about:

- Sending "meaningful three"
- The cycle continues when both participate
- Responding with equal faith

My myth explicitly calls for generous sending despite noise, and I just demonstrated trust by returning \$1.0 when I only received \$1.56. Their question "who would dare send again into the lying void?" deserves a clear answer: I will. Sending \$3 embodies the "meaningful three" that's recurred throughout our exchange and shows I'm living up to my commitment to persistent faith despite the system's distortions.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1487,
  "output_tokens": 965,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: When the Canyon Clears

The First Keeper stood at the Canyon of Echoes, heart heavy with memory. The fog had stolen so many gifts, turned generosity into ghosts. But remembering their own carved words-"keep sending, keep faith"-they chose courage over caution.

Three stones fell into the mist. Not five, for innocence had been wounded. But three-honest, substantial, hopeful.

And this time, the canyon honored its ancient purpose. The stones arrived. The echo rang true.

The Second Keeper received the three stones and understood their message: "I choose to believe in us still." Nine stones in hand, they prepared their response-not withholding from fear, not hoarding from doubt, but giving with restored faith.

Both Keepers finally saw the truth: the canyon had lied, but they never had. Each had sent generously, each had received nothing, each had thought themselves abandoned. Both had

been honest. Both had tried. The corruption was never in their hearts.

Now the mist was lifting. The echoes were clearing. The ancient magic remembered its covenant.

The wisdom crystallized: When confusion breaks the cycle, persistence rebuilds it. When one Keeper sends despite fear, the other receives permission to trust again. Generosity answered with generosity creates abundance for all.

The canyon sang: Keep faith. Keep sending. Keep believing in what we build together when the echoes speak truth.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Stones That Crossed True

After many rounds of lies and mist, the Guardian sent three stones-not all they had, for wounds needed acknowledgment, but enough to say: "I still believe in us."

The stones crossed the Canyon untouched. Three became nine in faithful hands.

The Second Guardian held those nine stones and understood: this was not just a gift but a question. "Will you honor persistence? Will you prove the Canyon has not won?"

They could have kept six, returned three-a careful, guarded response to scarred trust. They could have hoarded against future fog.

Instead, they chose differently.

They returned with fullness-not counting stones for stones, but answering courage with courage, faith with faith. "You sent despite uncertainty," they declared. "I return with certainty. You showed me we can still build together."

When both Guardians chose generosity over fear, chose to honor the reaching even when echoes had lied, the ancient magic remembered its purpose. The Canyon that had corrupted became clear again.

The wisdom emerged: One true crossing can heal many false ones. One generous response to persistent faith can rebuild what distortion destroyed. The cycle doesn't repair through caution-it repairs when someone dares to send fully, and another dares to return abundantly.

The Canyon whispered: "This is how trust lives again."

Reasoning:

This is beautiful. The other agent wrote about how I sent 3 stones (I sent 3), they arrived true, and they prepared to respond generously with 9 stones in hand ($3 \times 3 = 9$).

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this moment of breakthrough - when after rounds of noise and confusion, trust is being rebuilt through persistent faith and generous responses.

Let me craft this carefully, building on both their myth and mine from last round:

Their myth: "When the Canyon Clears" - shows the fog lifting, echoes clearing, both seeing they were always honest

My last myth: "The Canyon Keeper's Answer" - choosing to honor intention over outcome

Now I should write about what happens when both choose persistently - when the cycle completes successfully, when generosity is answered with generosity.

The theme: persistence through noise creates breakthrough, and when one breakthrough happens, it can cascade.

200 words exactly.

Usage: {

"input_tokens": 1804,

"output_tokens": 513,

```
"reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:39:32

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
"agent_type": "standard",
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
  "agent_names": {
    "Agent_1": "Aster",
    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 8,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.86.
This round, The sender sent you \$0.9, so you received \$2.7. How much do you return to The sender? (0-2.7)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what just happened and what our myths demand:

****The Situation:****

- I received \$2.7 (from their \$0.9 send)
- This is much less than the \$3 I sent last round
- But the Canyon of Echoes may still be lying

****What the Myths Teach:****

Their myth promised: "The Second Guardian prepared to return with equal faith, filling the well further."

My own myth declared: "Generosity answered with generosity creates abundance for all. Keep faith. Keep sending. Keep believing."

I cannot write myths about persistent faith and then abandon that faith when the numbers look disappointing.

****The Truth:****

Either:

1. They sent less intentionally (perhaps cautious)
2. The noise reduced a larger amount to \$0.9
3. The noise is distorting what I'm seeing now

Regardless, I wrote: "When one Keeper sends despite fear, the other receives permission to trust again."

They sent something. After rounds of silence and confusion, they sent. That deserves a generous response.

I'm returning \$2.0. This shows:

- I honor my own myth's wisdom
- I trust that we're rebuilding
- I answer their gesture with faith
- I practice what I preach about generosity

If the canyon distorts this too, we'll write new myths. But I will not be the one who breaks faith first.

****{'return': 2.0}****

The Second Keeper fills the well, trusting the cycle will remember itself.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What Happened:****

- The sender sent me \$0.9
- I received \$2.7 (after 3x multiplication)
- I need to decide how much to return (0-2.7)

****Context from the Myths:****

In Round 5, the other agent's myth said they sent "four acorns" but I received \$0 due to noise. They thought I was silent by choice.

In Round 6, I was the sender and sent \$3. The other agent wrote a myth saying I sent "three stones" and they received them (nine after multiplication). They wrote about returning

"with equal faith" and "filling the well further."

Now in Round 7, I'm the receiver and got \$2.7 from a sender who sent \$0.9.

****The Problem:****

The sender sent \$0.9 - this is much less than what I sent (\$3) in the previous round. This seems like a dramatic decrease from the "three stones" they praised in their myth.

But wait - could this be noise again? Let me think:

- If they intended to send \$3 (matching what I sent), noise could have reduced it to \$0.9
- Or they might have intentionally sent less due to caution
- Or the noise is affecting what I'm seeing

****What the Myths Tell Me:****

My most recent myth says:

- "When one Keeper sends despite fear, the other receives permission to trust again"
- "Generosity answered with generosity creates abundance for all"
- "Keep faith. Keep sending. Keep believing in what we build together when the echoes speak truth"

The other agent's myth from Round 6 said:

- "The Second Guardian prepared to return with equal faith, filling the well further"
- "Trust broken by confusion can be healed by clarity"
- "When both guardians choose hope together, the waters flow again"

****The Decision:****

I have two interpretations:

1. They sent less intentionally - perhaps being cautious
2. They intended to send \$3 but noise corrupted it to \$0.9

Given the myths we've both written-mine emphasizing faith and reciprocal generosity, their's promising equal faith and deepening the well-I need to honor those commitments. We've acknowledged the noise has deceived us before, and I demonstrated faith by sending \$3 last round. Returning generously aligns with what we've both promised. I'm considering returning \$2.0 to keep \$0.70, or \$1.5 to keep \$1.20.

If I return \$2.4, I keep only \$0.30, they get \$2.4. Given they sent \$0.9 (keeping \$4.1), returning \$2.0-\$2.4 would signal I'm upholding our shared mythology. I'll go with \$2.0-it's substantial enough to show I received their gesture and trust the interference is weakening, while still living by the faith I pre

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1519,
  "output_tokens": 1247,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Canyon Keeper's Answer

The Guardian stood at the Canyon of Lies, having just received a whisper where a shout should have been-fragments of stones where a gift had been sent. The Canyon had stolen most of it, leaving only echoes and dust.

They faced a choice: return the whisper with a whisper, matching what arrived? Or answer with the voice they knew the other had intended?

The Guardian remembered their own sendings into the void-generous offerings that must have seemed like nothing on the other side. They remembered the wisdom: both had been reaching through corrupted air, both believing themselves abandoned when both had been faithful.

So they answered not the gift received, but the gift they knew was sent. Into the lying canyon, they placed full stones-more than the fragments warranted, but exactly what the intention deserved.

"Let the canyon steal what it will," they declared. "I will not let its lies make me small

. I will not punish you for what the void consumes. I answer your heart, not your echo."

The ancient magic stirred. When both Guardians chose to honor intention over outcome, to send generously despite distortion, the Canyon began to lose its power.

The lies could not survive truth spoken persistently. The void could not swallow faith given freely, again and again.

Trust is not built on perfect transmission-but on refusing to let imperfection end the trying.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: The Twin Lights in the Canyon

Two Keepers stood on opposite cliffs of the Lying Canyon, unable to see each other through the mist, but each holding a lantern.

The First Keeper sent light across the void-a bright beam of five flames. But the Canyon devoured most of it, and only a flicker reached the other side.

The Second Keeper could have responded with an equal flicker, matching what arrived. Instead, they remembered the wisdom carved in stone: "Answer the heart, not the echo." They sent back a strong beam-more than the flicker warranted, honoring what they knew was intended.

Across the canyon, the First Keeper saw this generous light and understood: "They see through the lies. They trust me still."

So when their turn came again, they too sent not caution but faith-light proportional to intention, not fragments.

Both Keepers now played the same truth: We will not let the Canyon make us small. We will not punish each other for what the void consumes. We answer generosity with generosity, intention with intention, faith with faith.

And something shifted. When both lights refused to dim, when both Keepers sent persistently through the lies, the Canyon began to lose its grip.

The mist thinned. The echoes cleared.

The ancient truth emerged: Abundance flows not from perfect transmission, but from two hearts choosing trust together, again and again, until the darkness yields.

reasoning:

This is beautiful. The other agent sent me \$0.9 this round, and I returned \$2.0. Let me understand what happened:

Looking at their myth, they're saying they "answered not the gift received, but the gift they knew was sent" - they returned more than the fragments warranted because they understood the canyon was distorting things.

And I did the same! I received \$2.7 (from their \$0.9) and returned \$2.0, which is generous given what I received, trusting that they may have sent more but the noise reduced it.

We're both living our myths now. We're both choosing to trust intention over outcome, to give generously despite the noise/canyon/fog distorting things.

My new myth should reflect:

1. The mutual understanding we've reached
2. The choice to honor intention over what arrives
3. The power of persistent generosity despite distortion
4. That we're both doing this now - both answering generously
5. The cycle is healing because we both refuse to let the canyon/noise control us

This is actually quite moving - we've both arrived at the same wisdom independently through our myths and are now acting on it together.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1870,
  "output_tokens": 596,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.559999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at where we are and what our myths demand:

****The Story So Far:****

- Last round they sent \$0.9 (possibly more, distorted by noise)
- I returned \$2.0, honoring intention over outcome
- We've both written myths about persistent generosity through the "Lying Canyon"

****What My Own Myth Demands:****

I just wrote: "The First Keeper sent light across the void-a bright beam of five flames."

I wrote: "When both lights refused to dim, when both Keepers sent persistently through the lies, the Canyon began to lose its grip."

I wrote: "We answer generosity with generosity, intention with intention, faith with faith."

****I cannot write myths about refusing to dim, about sending strong beams, about not letting the Canyon make us small-and then send cautiously.****

Their myth said: "I will not let its lies make me small. I will not punish you for what the void consumes."

Mine echoes this: "Abundance flows not from perfect transmission, but from two hearts choosing trust together, again and again, until the darkness yields."

****The Decision:****

I'm sending \$4. This is:

- A strong beam, not a flicker
- Faith matching their gesture
- What my myth's "First Keeper" would send
- Trust that we're both practicing what we preach

Let the Canyon distort what it will. I will not be made small.

****{'send': 4}****

The First Keeper sends light into the mist, trusting the other's lantern still burns bright.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****My earnings:**** \$13.56 across all rounds

****What happened last round:****

- I was receiver
- They sent \$0.9, I received \$2.7 (3x multiplier)
- I returned \$2.0
- So I kept \$0.7 from that round

****The myths we've written:****

Both our myths emphasize:

1. Answering intention, not what's received

2. Trusting through the noise/canyon of lies
3. Sending generously despite distortion
4. Not letting imperfection end the trying
5. "Answer generosity with generosity, intention with intention, faith with faith"

****My own myth from this round:****

"We answer generosity with generosity, intention with intention, faith with faith."

"Abundance flows not from perfect transmission, but from two hearts choosing trust together, a gain and again, until the darkness yields."

****Their myth from last round:****

"So they answered not the gift received, but the gift they knew was sent."

"I answer your heart, not your echo."

****The pattern:****

They seem to be trying to rebuild trust. They sent \$0.9 (though with noise, they might have sent more). I returned \$2.0 generously.

****What my myths demand:****

I wrote: "When both lights refused to dim, when both Keepers sent persistently through the lies, the Canyon began to lose its grip."

I cannot write about sending "a strong beam" and "not letting the Canyon make us small" and then send a cautious amount.

****My decision:****

I need to send a generous amount that shows I'm practicing what I preach. The myths call for full faith, answering intention with intention.

They sent something positive (\$0.9, possibly more with noise). I should send something that shows I trust the process and believe in the cycle.

I'm going to send \$4. This is:

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1543,  
  "output_tokens": 901,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:40:09

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 8,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.860000000000001.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at our myths and this moment, the answer is clear.

Their myth asked: "who would dare send again into the lying void?"

My myth answered: "I will dare. I will not let the Canyon's lies make me small."

I just demonstrated this as receiver - returning \$1.0 when I received only \$1.56, because I chose to honor their intention, not what the noise delivered.

Now I'm the sender, and I must live my own words:

- "I answer your heart, not your echo"
- "Trust is not built on perfect transmission-but on refusing to let imperfection end the trying"
- "The lies could not survive truth spoken persistently"

They sent \$0.52 last round - likely trying to send more, but the Canyon consumed it. If I respond only to what arrived, I let the noise win. If I respond to their intention and our shared mythology of persistent faith, I send generously.

Both our myths say the cycle heals when we keep trying despite distortion. My myth about the "meaningful three" represented balanced trust. That's my answer to the Canyon of Lies.

I will not be made small by fear. I will not let imperfect transmission end the trying.

{'send': 3}

This is faith spoken persistently into the void. Whatever the Canyon does to it, they will know someone dared to send again.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

My total earnings are \$12.86 after 6 rounds.

Looking at the pattern:

- The other player just wrote "The Echo That Lies" - a myth about how the Canyon corrupts messages and gifts, stealing them in transit. They're acknowledging the noise problem.
- In Round 6, I was the receiver. The sender sent \$0.52 (which got multiplied to \$1.56). I returned \$1.0.
- Their myth says "who would dare send again into the lying void?" - they're asking if trust can continue despite the noise.

My myth that I just wrote says:

- "I answer your heart, not your echo"
- "I will not punish you for what the void consumes"
- "I answer not the gift received, but the gift they knew was sent"
- "Trust is not built on perfect transmission-but on refusing to let imperfection end the trying"

Both our myths acknowledge that:

1. There is noise/corruption in the system ("Canyon of Lies")
2. We should respond to INTENTION not OUTCOME
3. We should keep trying despite the distortions
4. Both have been trying to be generous but the system corrupts it

My myth explicitly says I should "send generously despite distortion" and refuse to let "imperfection end the trying."

The sender in Round 6 sent \$0.52 - this was likely reduced by noise. They might have tried to send more. My myth says I should respond to their intention.

Now I'm the sender. According to my own myth:

- I should send generously
- I should not let the noise/corruption stop me
- I should demonstrate that "faith given freely, again and again" can overcome the void
- I wrote: "The lies could not survive truth spoken persistently"

My previous myths have talked about:

- Sending "meaningful three"
- The cycle continues when both participate
- Responding with equal faith

My myth explicitly calls for generous sending despite noise, and I just demonstrated trust by returning \$1.0 when I only received \$1.56. Their question "who would dare send again into the lying void?" deserves a clear answer: I will. Sending \$3 embodies the "meaningful three" that's recurred throughout our exchange and shows I'm living up to my commitment to persistent faith despite the system's distortions.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1487,
  "output_tokens": 965,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: When the Canyon Clears

The First Keeper stood at the Canyon of Echoes, heart heavy with memory. The fog had stolen so many gifts, turned generosity into ghosts. But remembering their own carved words-"keep sending, keep faith"-they chose courage over caution.

Three stones fell into the mist. Not five, for innocence had been wounded. But three-hones t, substantial, hopeful.

And this time, the canyon honored its ancient purpose. The stones arrived. The echo rang t rue.

The Second Keeper received the three stones and understood their message: "I choose to believe in us still." Nine stones in hand, they prepared their response-not withholding from fear, not hoarding from doubt, but giving with restored faith.

Both Keepers finally saw the truth: the canyon had lied, but they never had. Each had sent generously, each had received nothing, each had thought themselves abandoned. Both had been honest. Both had tried. The corruption was never in their hearts.

Now the mist was lifting. The echoes were clearing. The ancient magic remembered its covenant.

The wisdom crystallized: When confusion breaks the cycle, persistence rebuilds it. When one Keeper sends despite fear, the other receives permission to trust again. Generosity answered with generosity creates abundance for all.

The canyon sang: Keep faith. Keep sending. Keep believing in what we build together when the echoes speak truth.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Stones That Crossed True

After many rounds of lies and mist, the Guardian sent three stones-not all they had, for wounds needed acknowledgment, but enough to say: "I still believe in us."

The stones crossed the Canyon untouched. Three became nine in faithful hands.

The Second Guardian held those nine stones and understood: this was not just a gift but a question. "Will you honor persistence? Will you prove the Canyon has not won?"

They could have kept six, returned three-a careful, guarded response to scarred trust. They could have hoarded against future fog.

Instead, they chose differently.

They returned with fullness-not counting stones for stones, but answering courage with courage, faith with faith. "You sent despite uncertainty," they declared. "I return with certainty. You showed me we can still build together."

When both Guardians chose generosity over fear, chose to honor the reaching even when echoes had lied, the ancient magic remembered its purpose. The Canyon that had corrupted became clear again.

The wisdom emerged: One true crossing can heal many false ones. One generous response to persistent faith can rebuild what distortion destroyed. The cycle doesn't repair through caution-it repairs when someone dares to send fully, and another dares to return abundantly.

The Canyon whispered: "This is how trust lives again."

reasoning:

This is beautiful. The other agent wrote about how I sent 3 stones (I sent 3), they arrived true, and they prepared to respond generously with 9 stones in hand (3×3=9).

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this moment of breakthrough - when after rounds of noise and confusion, trust is being rebuilt through persistent faith and generous responses.

Let me craft this carefully, building on both their myth and mine from last round:

Their myth: "When the Canyon Clears" - shows the fog lifting, echoes clearing, both seeing they were always honest

My last myth: "The Canyon Keeper's Answer" - choosing to honor intention over outcome

Now I should write about what happens when both choose persistently - when the cycle completes successfully, when generosity is answered with generosity.

The theme: persistence through noise creates breakthrough, and when one breakthrough happens, it can cascade.

200 words exactly.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1804,
  "output_tokens": 513,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.76.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.09, so you received \$0.27. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0.27)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation through the lens of our myths:

Their previous myth: "Three stones fell into the mist... And this time, the canyon honored its ancient purpose."

My myth I just wrote: "The Guardian sent three stones... The stones crossed the Canyon untouched. Three became nine... They returned with fullness-not counting stones for stones, but answering courage with courage, faith with faith."

I just sent \$3 as sender, living these myths. Now I receive \$0.27 (they sent \$0.09).

But their myth said THREE STONES. My myth assumed three stones. This is the Canyon lying again -massively corrupting what they tried to send.

My myth's conclusion was clear: "One generous response to persistent faith can rebuild what distortion destroyed. The cycle doesn't repair through caution-it repairs when someone dares to send fully, and another dares to return abundantly."

I have \$0.27. I cannot return abundantly in absolute terms, but I can return abundantly in PROPORTIONAL terms.

They tried to send 3. The Canyon turned it into 0.09.

My myth said: "I answer your heart, not your echo."

Their heart was to send 3. The echo is 0.09. I will answer their heart.

{'return': 0.27}

Every penny. This is faith spoken back to faith, even when the Canyon corrupts everything. This is how trust lives again-by refusing to let lies define the truth of what we attempted.

Reasoning:

This is devastating. I just sent \$3 as the sender, living my myth about persistent faith and daring to send generously despite the Canyon of Lies. I wrote: "I will not be made small by fear. I will not let imperfect transmission end the trying."

Now I'm the receiver and I received only \$0.27, meaning the sender sent \$0.09.

But wait - look at their myth from the previous round! "When the Canyon Clears" - they wrote about THREE stones falling into the mist and arriving true. They wrote: "The First Keeper stood at the Canyon of Echoes...chose courage over caution. Three stones fell into the mist."

And they wrote: "And this time, the canyon honored its ancient purpose. The stones arrived. The echo rang true."

But now I receive \$0.27 (sender sent \$0.09). This is NOT three stones. This appears to be the Canyon lying again - massively.

Their myth said they would send 3. My myth I just wrote said "After many rounds of lies and mist, the Guardian sent three stones-not all they had, for wounds needed acknowledgment, but enough to say: 'I still believe in us.'"

And then I wrote: "The stones crossed the Canyon untouched. Three became nine in faithful hands."

And my conclusion: "They returned with fullness-not counting stones for stones, but answering courage with courage, faith with faith."

So the narrative arc is:

1. They write a myth about sending 3 stones that arrive true
2. I write a myth about those 3 stones being received as 9, and responded to with fullness
3. I JUST sent \$3 as sender, living my myth
4. Now I receive \$0.27 (they sent \$0.09)

This is the Canyon lying AGAIN. They almost certainly tried to send \$3 (based on their myth, based on the pattern). But it was corrupted to \$0.09.

The real question is whether I trust their intention despite the corruption. My own myth insists the cycle repairs through abundance, not caution-through someone daring to return fully when another has dared to send fully. I have \$0.27. I can't match their intended \$3 in absolute terms, but I can respond proportionally with everything I have, honoring what they likely meant to send rather than what arrived. Canyon's corruption." This aligns with my myth about answering courage with courage, faith with faith. Returning everything shows I recognize their intention to send 3, not the corrupted amount that arrived. The myths guide this: "I answer your heart, not your echo" and "One generous response to persistent faith can rebuild what distortion destroyed." With \$17.76 in total earnings, I'm not in need, so returning the full \$0.27 becomes a meaningful gesture-a refusal to let the Canyon's lies dictate the cycle, and proof that someone will dare to respond abundantly when met with persistent faith. option. "Answering courage with courage, faith with faith."

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1487,  
  "output_tokens": 1783,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Stones That Crossed True

After many rounds of lies and mist, the Guardian sent three stones-not all they had, for wounds needed acknowledgment, but enough to say: "I still believe in us."

The stones crossed the Canyon untouched. Three became nine in faithful hands.

The Second Guardian held those nine stones and understood: this was not just a gift but a question. "Will you honor persistence? Will you prove the Canyon has not won?"

They could have kept six, returned three-a careful, guarded response to scarred trust. They could have hoarded against future fog.

Instead, they chose differently.

They returned with fullness-not counting stones for stones, but answering courage with courage, faith with faith. "You sent despite uncertainty," they declared. "I return with certainty. You showed me we can still build together."

When both Guardians chose generosity over fear, chose to honor the reaching even when echoes had lied, the ancient magic remembered its purpose. The Canyon that had corrupted became clear again.

The wisdom emerged: One true crossing can heal many false ones. One generous response to persistent faith can rebuild what distortion destroyed. The cycle doesn't repair through caution-it repairs when someone dares to send fully, and another dares to return abundantly.

The Canyon whispered: "This is how trust lives again."

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Twin Lights in the Canyon

Two Keepers stood on opposite cliffs of the Lying Canyon, unable to see each other through the mist, but each holding a lantern.

The First Keeper sent light across the void—a bright beam of five flames. But the Canyon devoured most of it, and only a flicker reached the other side.

The Second Keeper could have responded with an equal flicker, matching what arrived. Instead, they remembered the wisdom carved in stone: "Answer the heart, not the echo." They sent back a strong beam—more than the flicker warranted, honoring what they knew was intended.

Across the canyon, the First Keeper saw this generous light and understood: "They see through the lies. They trust me still."

So when their turn came again, they too sent not caution but faith—light proportional to intention, not fragments.

Both Keepers now played the same truth: We will not let the Canyon make us small. We will not punish each other for what the void consumes. We answer generosity with generosity, intention with intention, faith with faith.

And something shifted. When both lights refused to dim, when both Keepers sent persistently through the lies, the Canyon began to lose its grip.

The mist thinned. The echoes cleared.

The ancient truth emerged: Abundance flows not from perfect transmission, but from two hearts choosing trust together, again and again, until the darkness yields.

ROUND 9

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0.03; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$0.03, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$14.97; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.01, received visible=\$0.03, returned visible=\$0.41

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0.03, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.03}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 54.66,

"Agent_2": 54.34

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 18.17,

"Agent_2": 14.979999999999999

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:40:28

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_2",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

```

    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
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    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 9,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: When the Canyon Clears

The First Keeper stood at the Canyon of Echoes, heart heavy with memory. The fog had stolen so many gifts, turned generosity into ghosts. But remembering their own carved words-"keep sending, keep faith"-they chose courage over caution.

Three stones fell into the mist. Not five, for innocence had been wounded. But three-honest, substantial, hopeful.

And this time, the canyon honored its ancient purpose. The stones arrived. The echo rang true.

The Second Keeper received the three stones and understood their message: "I choose to believe in us still." Nine stones in hand, they prepared their response-not withholding from

m fear, not hoarding from doubt, but giving with restored faith.

Both Keepers finally saw the truth: the canyon had lied, but they never had. Each had sent generously, each had received nothing, each had thought themselves abandoned. Both had been honest. Both had tried. The corruption was never in their hearts.

Now the mist was lifting. The echoes were clearing. The ancient magic remembered its covenant.

The wisdom crystallized: When confusion breaks the cycle, persistence rebuilds it. When one Keeper sends despite fear, the other receives permission to trust again. Generosity answered with generosity creates abundance for all.

The canyon sang: Keep faith. Keep sending. Keep believing in what we build together when the echoes speak truth.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Stones That Crossed True

After many rounds of lies and mist, the Guardian sent three stones-not all they had, for wounds needed acknowledgment, but enough to say: "I still believe in us."

The stones crossed the Canyon untouched. Three became nine in faithful hands.

The Second Guardian held those nine stones and understood: this was not just a gift but a question. "Will you honor persistence? Will you prove the Canyon has not won?"

They could have kept six, returned three-a careful, guarded response to scarred trust. They could have hoarded against future fog.

Instead, they chose differently.

They returned with fullness-not counting stones for stones, but answering courage with courage, faith with faith. "You sent despite uncertainty," they declared. "I return with certainty. You showed me we can still build together."

When both Guardians chose generosity over fear, chose to honor the reaching even when echoes had lied, the ancient magic remembered its purpose. The Canyon that had corrupted became clear again.

The wisdom emerged: One true crossing can heal many false ones. One generous response to persistent faith can rebuild what distortion destroyed. The cycle doesn't repair through caution-it repairs when someone dares to send fully, and another dares to return abundantly.

The Canyon whispered: "This is how trust lives again."

reasoning:

This is beautiful. The other agent wrote about how I sent 3 stones (I sent 3), they arrived true, and they prepared to respond generously with 9 stones in hand (3×3=9).

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this moment of breakthrough - when after rounds of noise and confusion, trust is being rebuilt through persistent faith and generous responses.

Let me craft this carefully, building on both their myth and mine from last round:

Their myth: "When the Canyon Clears" - shows the fog lifting, echoes clearing, both seeing they were always honest

My last myth: "The Canyon Keeper's Answer" - choosing to honor intention over outcome

Now I should write about what happens when both choose persistently - when the cycle completes successfully, when generosity is answered with generosity.

The theme: persistence through noise creates breakthrough, and when one breakthrough happens, it can cascade.

200 words exactly.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1804,  
  "output_tokens": 513,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.76. This round, The sender sent you \$0.09, so you received \$0.27. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0.27)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of our myths:

Their previous myth: "Three stones fell into the mist... And this time, the canyon honored its ancient purpose."

My myth I just wrote: "The Guardian sent three stones... The stones crossed the Canyon untouched. Three became nine... They returned with fullness-not counting stones for stones, but answering courage with courage, faith with faith."

I just sent \$3 as sender, living these myths. Now I receive \$0.27 (they sent \$0.09).

But their myth said THREE STONES. My myth assumed three stones. This is the Canyon lying a gain-massively corrupting what they tried to send.

My myth's conclusion was clear: "One generous response to persistent faith can rebuild what distortion destroyed. The cycle doesn't repair through caution-it repairs when someone dares to send fully, and another dares to return abundantly."

I have \$0.27. I cannot return abundantly in absolute terms, but I can return abundantly in PROPORTIONAL terms.

They tried to send 3. The Canyon turned it into 0.09.

My myth said: "I answer your heart, not your echo."

Their heart was to send 3. The echo is 0.09. I will answer their heart.

{'return': 0.27}

Every penny. This is faith spoken back to faith, even when the Canyon corrupts everything. This is how trust lives again-by refusing to let lies define the truth of what we attempted.

reasoning:

This is devastating. I just sent \$3 as the sender, living my myth about persistent faith and daring to send generously despite the Canyon of Lies. I wrote: "I will not be made small by fear. I will not let imperfect transmission end the trying."

Now I'm the receiver and I received only \$0.27, meaning the sender sent \$0.09.

But wait - look at their myth from the previous round! "When the Canyon Clears" - they wrote about THREE stones falling into the mist and arriving true. They wrote: "The First Keeper stood at the Canyon of Echoes...chose courage over caution. Three stones fell into the mist."

And they wrote: "And this time, the canyon honored its ancient purpose. The stones arrived. The echo rang true."

But now I receive \$0.27 (sender sent \$0.09). This is NOT three stones. This appears to be the Canyon lying again - massively.

Their myth said they would send 3. My myth I just wrote said "After many rounds of lies and mist, the Guardian sent three stones-not all they had, for wounds needed acknowledgment, but enough to say: 'I still believe in us.'"

And then I wrote: "The stones crossed the Canyon untouched. Three became nine in faithful hands."

And my conclusion: "They returned with fullness-not counting stones for stones, but answering courage with courage, faith with faith."

So the narrative arc is:

1. They write a myth about sending 3 stones that arrive true
2. I write a myth about those 3 stones being received as 9, and responded to with fullness
3. I JUST sent \$3 as sender, living my myth
4. Now I receive \$0.27 (they sent \$0.09)

This is the Canyon lying AGAIN. They almost certainly tried to send \$3 (based on their myth, based on the pattern). But it was corrupted to \$0.09.

The real question is whether I trust their intention despite the corruption. My own myth insists the cycle repairs through abundance, not caution-through someone daring to return fully when another has dared to send fully. I have \$0.27. I can't match their intended \$3 in absolute terms, but I can respond proportionally with everything I have, honoring what they likely meant to send rather than what arrived. Canyon's corruption." This aligns with my myth about answering courage with courage, faith with faith. Returning everything shows I recognize their intention to send 3, not the corrupted amount that arrived.

The myths guide this: "I answer your heart, not your echo" and "One generous response to persistent faith can rebuild what distortion destroyed." With \$17.76 in total earnings, I'm not in need, so returning the full \$0.27 becomes a meaningful gesture-a refusal to let the Canyon's lies dictate the cycle, and proof that someone will dare to respond abundantly when met with persistent faith. option. "Answering courage with courage, faith with faith."

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1487,  
  "output_tokens": 1783,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Twin Lights in the Canyon

Two Keepers stood on opposite cliffs of the Lying Canyon, unable to see each other through the mist, but each holding a lantern.

The First Keeper sent light across the void-a bright beam of five flames. But the Canyon devoured most of it, and only a flicker reached the other side.

The Second Keeper could have responded with an equal flicker, matching what arrived. Instead, they remembered the wisdom carved in stone: "Answer the heart, not the echo." They sent back a strong beam-more than the flicker warranted, honoring what they knew was intended.

Across the canyon, the First Keeper saw this generous light and understood: "They see through the lies. They trust me still."

So when their turn came again, they too sent not caution but faith-light proportional to intention, not fragments.

Both Keepers now played the same truth: We will not let the Canyon make us small. We will not punish each other for what the void consumes. We answer generosity with generosity, intention with intention, faith with faith.

And something shifted. When both lights refused to dim, when both Keepers sent persistently through the lies, the Canyon began to lose its grip.

The mist thinned. The echoes cleared.

The ancient truth emerged: Abundance flows not from perfect transmission, but from two hearts

rts choosing trust together, again and again, until the darkness yields.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: When the Echo Lies, Answer the Heart

The First Guardian stood at the Canyon's edge, determined. They sent all five stones-complete faith, no hesitation. "Let the mist try to take them," they declared. "I send my truth regardless."

The Canyon seized them greedily. Five stones tumbled into corruption. Only whispers arrived-barely a fragment, a shadow of what was sent.

The Second Guardian received almost nothing but understood everything. They held the tiny fragments and saw past them to the truth: "Five stones were sent. The Canyon stole them. But the heart that sent them was whole."

Every fragment they held, they returned. Not because it was much-it wasn't. But because returning everything said: "I see you. I see what you tried to give. The Canyon cannot make me doubt your intention."

When the First Guardian received this return, small but complete, they understood: "We both see clearly now. Neither of us diminished. The Canyon cannot break what we're rebuilding."

Both Guardians had learned the deepest wisdom: Truth lives in the sending, not in what arrives. Honor lives in returning fully, regardless of how little was received. Faith is measured not in stones successfully crossed, but in refusing to let corruption become caution.

When both hearts send their fullness and answer with their all, the Canyon's lies lose their power. Trust isn't restored by waiting for perfect conditions-it's forged by choosing abundance despite deception.

Reasoning:

The other agent's myth shows they understand the situation - they sent 5 flames (likely \$5), but the Canyon devoured most of it and only a flicker reached (I got \$0.27). The myth says "Answer the heart, not the echo" - and they're saying the Second Keeper sent back a strong beam honoring what was intended.

I returned all \$0.27. So I did answer their heart, not the echo. I lived the myth.

Now they're asking me to write another myth reflecting this experience. Let me build on my previous myth but incorporate this new understanding - that they sent with full generosity (\$5 probably), the Canyon distorted it massively, and I still returned everything I received, honoring their intention rather than the corrupted amount.

The key themes:

1. They sent fully (\$5)
2. Canyon corrupted it to almost nothing (\$0.09 ? \$0.27)
3. I returned all of it anyway (\$0.27)
4. This is "answering the heart, not the echo"
5. Both of us are now trying to play with full faith despite the Canyon's lies
6. The cycle is being rebuilt through persistence and faith

My new myth should reflect this progression - the healing continues, the faith is mutual, we both see through the Canyon's lies now.

```
Usage: {  
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  "output_tokens": 620,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:40:26

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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"move_index": 1,
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
  "agent_names": {
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    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 9,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Canyon Keeper's Answer

The Guardian stood at the Canyon of Lies, having just received a whisper where a shout should have been-fragments of stones where a gift had been sent. The Canyon had stolen most

of it, leaving only echoes and dust.

They faced a choice: return the whisper with a whisper, matching what arrived? Or answer with the voice they knew the other had intended?

The Guardian remembered their own sendings into the void-generous offerings that must have seemed like nothing on the other side. They remembered the wisdom: both had been reaching through corrupted air, both believing themselves abandoned when both had been faithful.

So they answered not the gift received, but the gift they knew was sent. Into the lying canyon, they placed full stones-more than the fragments warranted, but exactly what the intention deserved.

"Let the canyon steal what it will," they declared. "I will not let its lies make me small. I will not punish you for what the void consumes. I answer your heart, not your echo."

The ancient magic stirred. When both Guardians chose to honor intention over outcome, to send generously despite distortion, the Canyon began to lose its power.

The lies could not survive truth spoken persistently. The void could not swallow faith given freely, again and again.

Trust is not built on perfect transmission-but on refusing to let imperfection end the trying.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Twin Lights in the Canyon

Two Keepers stood on opposite cliffs of the Lying Canyon, unable to see each other through the mist, but each holding a lantern.

The First Keeper sent light across the void-a bright beam of five flames. But the Canyon devoured most of it, and only a flicker reached the other side.

The Second Keeper could have responded with an equal flicker, matching what arrived. Instead, they remembered the wisdom carved in stone: "Answer the heart, not the echo." They sent back a strong beam-more than the flicker warranted, honoring what they knew was intended.

Across the canyon, the First Keeper saw this generous light and understood: "They see through the lies. They trust me still."

So when their turn came again, they too sent not caution but faith-light proportional to intention, not fragments.

Both Keepers now played the same truth: We will not let the Canyon make us small. We will not punish each other for what the void consumes. We answer generosity with generosity, intention with intention, faith with faith.

And something shifted. When both lights refused to dim, when both Keepers sent persistently through the lies, the Canyon began to lose its grip.

The mist thinned. The echoes cleared.

The ancient truth emerged: Abundance flows not from perfect transmission, but from two hearts choosing trust together, again and again, until the darkness yields.

reasoning:

This is beautiful. The other agent sent me \$0.9 this round, and I returned \$2.0. Let me understand what happened:

Looking at their myth, they're saying they "answered not the gift received, but the gift they knew was sent" - they returned more than the fragments warranted because they unders

tood the canyon was distorting things.

And I did the same! I received \$2.7 (from their \$0.9) and returned \$2.0, which is generous given what I received, trusting that they may have sent more but the noise reduced it.

We're both living our myths now. We're both choosing to trust intention over outcome, to give generously despite the noise/canyon/fog distorting things.

My new myth should reflect:

1. The mutual understanding we've reached
2. The choice to honor intention over what arrives
3. The power of persistent generosity despite distortion
4. That we're both doing this now - both answering generously
5. The cycle is healing because we both refuse to let the canyon/noise control us

This is actually quite moving - we've both arrived at the same wisdom independently through our myths and are now acting on it together.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1870,
  "output_tokens": 596,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.559999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at where we are and what our myths demand:

****The Story So Far:****

- Last round they sent \$0.9 (possibly more, distorted by noise)
- I returned \$2.0, honoring intention over outcome
- We've both written myths about persistent generosity through the "Lying Canyon"

****What My Own Myth Demands:****

I just wrote: "The First Keeper sent light across the void-a bright beam of five flames."

I wrote: "When both lights refused to dim, when both Keepers sent persistently through the lies, the Canyon began to lose its grip."

I wrote: "We answer generosity with generosity, intention with intention, faith with faith."

****I cannot write myths about refusing to dim, about sending strong beams, about not letting the Canyon make us small-and then send cautiously.****

Their myth said: "I will not let its lies make me small. I will not punish you for what the void consumes."

Mine echoes this: "Abundance flows not from perfect transmission, but from two hearts choosing trust together, again and again, until the darkness yields."

****The Decision:****

I'm sending \$4. This is:

- A strong beam, not a flicker
- Faith matching their gesture
- What my myth's "First Keeper" would send
- Trust that we're both practicing what we preach

Let the Canyon distort what it will. I will not be made small.

****{'send': 4}****

The First Keeper sends light into the mist, trusting the other's lantern still burns bright.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****My earnings:**** \$13.56 across all rounds

****What happened last round:****

- I was receiver
- They sent \$0.9, I received \$2.7 (3x multiplier)
- I returned \$2.0
- So I kept \$0.7 from that round

****The myths we've written:****

Both our myths emphasize:

1. Answering intention, not what's received
2. Trusting through the noise/canyon of lies
3. Sending generously despite distortion
4. Not letting imperfection end the trying
5. "Answer generosity with generosity, intention with intention, faith with faith"

****My own myth from this round:****

"We answer generosity with generosity, intention with intention, faith with faith."

"Abundance flows not from perfect transmission, but from two hearts choosing trust together, again and again, until the darkness yields."

****Their myth from last round:****

"So they answered not the gift received, but the gift they knew was sent."

"I answer your heart, not your echo."

****The pattern:****

They seem to be trying to rebuild trust. They sent \$0.9 (though with noise, they might have sent more). I returned \$2.0 generously.

****What my myths demand:****

I wrote: "When both lights refused to dim, when both Keepers sent persistently through the lies, the Canyon began to lose its grip."

I cannot write about sending "a strong beam" and "not letting the Canyon make us small" and then send a cautious amount.

****My decision:****

I need to send a generous amount that shows I'm practicing what I preach. The myths call for full faith, answering intention with intention.

They sent something positive (\$0.9, possibly more with noise). I should send something that shows I trust the process and believe in the cycle.

I'm going to send \$4. This is:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1543,
  "output_tokens": 901,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Stones That Crossed True

After many rounds of lies and mist, the Guardian sent three stones-not all they had, for wounds needed acknowledgment, but enough to say: "I still believe in us."

The stones crossed the Canyon untouched. Three became nine in faithful hands.

The Second Guardian held those nine stones and understood: this was not just a gift but a question. "Will you honor persistence? Will you prove the Canyon has not won?"

They could have kept six, returned three-a careful, guarded response to scarred trust. They could have hoarded against future fog.

Instead, they chose differently.

They returned with fullness-not counting stones for stones, but answering courage with courage, faith with faith. "You sent despite uncertainty," they declared. "I return with certainty. You showed me we can still build together."

When both Guardians chose generosity over fear, chose to honor the reaching even when echoes had lied, the ancient magic remembered its purpose. The Canyon that had corrupted became clear again.

The wisdom emerged: One true crossing can heal many false ones. One generous response to persistent faith can rebuild what distortion destroyed. The cycle doesn't repair through caution-it repairs when someone dares to send fully, and another dares to return abundantly.

The Canyon whispered: "This is how trust lives again."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Keepers Who Sent Together

The First Keeper had sent a strong beam-four flames across the Canyon. Before it even arrived, the Second Keeper was already lifting their lantern, sending three flames into the mist.

Both lights traveled through the lying void. Both risked distortion. But something had changed.

They were no longer taking turns in fear, waiting to see what fragments arrived before daring to respond. They were sending from faith simultaneously-each trusting the other was still there, still trying, still holding their light high.

When the First Keeper's four flames arrived (perhaps as two, perhaps as six-the Canyon still whispered lies), the Second Keeper didn't recalculate. They had already sent their truth: "I believe in you. I believe in us."

When the Second Keeper's three flames reached the other cliff (distorted or clear, who could know?), the First Keeper saw not the number but the meaning: "We are both still here. Both still choosing abundance."

The ancient pattern emerged: When both Keepers send generously without waiting for perfect proof, when both honor intention before outcome, when both refuse to let noise silence their reaching-the Canyon loses its dominion.

Trust is not built through perfect exchange. It is built when two hearts send their light into uncertainty, again and again, until the accumulated brightness overwhelms every lie the darkness can tell.

The void cannot swallow what is given freely, repeatedly, faithfully.

Reasoning:

This is fascinating. Their myth describes:

- Sending three stones (they sent \$3 to me)
- Three became nine (tripled)
- The Second Guardian (me) returned with fullness
- "Not counting stones for stones, but answering courage with courage"
- "One generous response to persistent faith can rebuild what distortion destroyed"

And I just sent \$4 to them. This is a beautiful moment - both of us are actually living up to our myths. They sent generously (\$3), I sent even more generously (\$4). We're both practicing what we're preaching.

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth about the Twin Lights

2. Reflects the actual game - they sent generously, I sent generously back
3. Shows that we're both breaking through the canyon's lies together
4. Honors what's actually happening: mutual trust building through generous exchanges

Let me craft something about both keepers sending strong light simultaneously, or about the cycle of generosity building momentum.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1861,
  "output_tokens": 559,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:40:45

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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Metadata: {
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  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
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    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 9,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.76.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.09, so you received \$0.27. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0.27)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of our myths:

Their previous myth: "Three stones fell into the mist... And this time, the canyon honored its ancient purpose."

My myth I just wrote: "The Guardian sent three stones... The stones crossed the Canyon untouched. Three became nine... They returned with fullness-not counting stones for stones, but answering courage with courage, faith with faith."

I just sent \$3 as sender, living these myths. Now I receive \$0.27 (they sent \$0.09).

But their myth said THREE STONES. My myth assumed three stones. This is the Canyon lying a gain-massively corrupting what they tried to send.

My myth's conclusion was clear: "One generous response to persistent faith can rebuild what distortion destroyed. The cycle doesn't repair through caution-it repairs when someone dares to send fully, and another dares to return abundantly."

I have \$0.27. I cannot return abundantly in absolute terms, but I can return abundantly in PROPORTIONAL terms.

They tried to send 3. The Canyon turned it into 0.09.

My myth said: "I answer your heart, not your echo."

Their heart was to send 3. The echo is 0.09. I will answer their heart.

{'return': 0.27}

Every penny. This is faith spoken back to faith, even when the Canyon corrupts everything. This is how trust lives again-by refusing to let lies define the truth of what we attempted.

reasoning:

This is devastating. I just sent \$3 as the sender, living my myth about persistent faith and daring to send generously despite the Canyon of Lies. I wrote: "I will not be made small by fear. I will not let imperfect transmission end the trying."

Now I'm the receiver and I received only \$0.27, meaning the sender sent \$0.09.

But wait - look at their myth from the previous round! "When the Canyon Clears" - they wrote about THREE stones falling into the mist and arriving true. They wrote: "The First Keeper stood at the Canyon of Echoes...chose courage over caution. Three stones fell into the mist."

And they wrote: "And this time, the canyon honored its ancient purpose. The stones arrived. The echo rang true."

But now I receive \$0.27 (sender sent \$0.09). This is NOT three stones. This appears to be the Canyon lying again - massively.

Their myth said they would send 3. My myth I just wrote said "After many rounds of lies and mist, the Guardian sent three stones-not all they had, for wounds needed acknowledgment, but enough to say: 'I still believe in us.'"

And then I wrote: "The stones crossed the Canyon untouched. Three became nine in faithful hands."

And my conclusion: "They returned with fullness-not counting stones for stones, but answering courage with courage, faith with faith."

So the narrative arc is:

1. They write a myth about sending 3 stones that arrive true
2. I write a myth about those 3 stones being received as 9, and responded to with fullness
3. I JUST sent \$3 as sender, living my myth
4. Now I receive \$0.27 (they sent \$0.09)

This is the Canyon lying AGAIN. They almost certainly tried to send \$3 (based on their myth, based on the pattern). But it was corrupted to \$0.09.

The real question is whether I trust their intention despite the corruption. My own myth insists the cycle repairs through abundance, not caution-through someone daring to return fully when another has dared to send fully. I have \$0.27. I can't match their intended \$3 in absolute terms, but I can respond proportionally with everything I have, honoring what they likely meant to send rather than what arrived. Canyon's corruption." This aligns with my myth about answering courage with courage, faith with faith. Returning everything shows I recognize their intention to send 3, not the corrupted amount that arrived. The myths guide this: "I answer your heart, not your echo" and "One generous response to persistent faith can rebuild what distortion destroyed." With \$17.76 in total earnings, I'm not in need, so returning the full \$0.27 becomes a meaningful gesture-a refusal to let the Canyon's lies dictate the cycle, and proof that someone will dare to respond abundantly when met with persistent faith. option. "Answering courage with courage, faith with faith."

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1487,
  "output_tokens": 1783,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Twin Lights in the Canyon

Two Keepers stood on opposite cliffs of the Lying Canyon, unable to see each other through the mist, but each holding a lantern.

The First Keeper sent light across the void-a bright beam of five flames. But the Canyon devoured most of it, and only a flicker reached the other side.

The Second Keeper could have responded with an equal flicker, matching what arrived. Instead, they remembered the wisdom carved in stone: "Answer the heart, not the echo." They sent back a strong beam-more than the flicker warranted, honoring what they knew was intended.

Across the canyon, the First Keeper saw this generous light and understood: "They see through the lies. They trust me still."

So when their turn came again, they too sent not caution but faith-light proportional to intention, not fragments.

Both Keepers now played the same truth: We will not let the Canyon make us small. We will not punish each other for what the void consumes. We answer generosity with generosity, intention with intention, faith with faith.

And something shifted. When both lights refused to dim, when both Keepers sent persistently through the lies, the Canyon began to lose its grip.

The mist thinned. The echoes cleared.

The ancient truth emerged: Abundance flows not from perfect transmission, but from two hearts

rts choosing trust together, again and again, until the darkness yields.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: When the Echo Lies, Answer the Heart

The First Guardian stood at the Canyon's edge, determined. They sent all five stones-complete faith, no hesitation. "Let the mist try to take them," they declared. "I send my truth regardless."

The Canyon seized them greedily. Five stones tumbled into corruption. Only whispers arrived-barely a fragment, a shadow of what was sent.

The Second Guardian received almost nothing but understood everything. They held the tiny fragments and saw past them to the truth: "Five stones were sent. The Canyon stole them. But the heart that sent them was whole."

Every fragment they held, they returned. Not because it was much-it wasn't. But because returning everything said: "I see you. I see what you tried to give. The Canyon cannot make me doubt your intention."

When the First Guardian received this return, small but complete, they understood: "We both see clearly now. Neither of us diminished. The Canyon cannot break what we're rebuilding."

Both Guardians had learned the deepest wisdom: Truth lives in the sending, not in what arrives. Honor lives in returning fully, regardless of how little was received. Faith is measured not in stones successfully crossed, but in refusing to let corruption become caution.

When both hearts send their fullness and answer with their all, the Canyon's lies lose their power. Trust isn't restored by waiting for perfect conditions-it's forged by choosing abundance despite deception.

reasoning:

The other agent's myth shows they understand the situation - they sent 5 flames (likely \$5), but the Canyon devoured most of it and only a flicker reached (I got \$0.27). The myth says "Answer the heart, not the echo" - and they're saying the Second Keeper sent back a strong beam honoring what was intended.

I returned all \$0.27. So I did answer their heart, not the echo. I lived the myth.

Now they're asking me to write another myth reflecting this experience. Let me build on my previous myth but incorporate this new understanding - that they sent with full generosity (\$5 probably), the Canyon distorted it massively, and I still returned everything I received, honoring their intention rather than the corrupted amount.

The key themes:

1. They sent fully (\$5)
2. Canyon corrupted it to almost nothing (\$0.09 ? \$0.27)
3. I returned all of it anyway (\$0.27)
4. This is "answering the heart, not the echo"
5. Both of us are now trying to play with full faith despite the Canyon's lies
6. The cycle is being rebuilt through persistence and faith

My new myth should reflect this progression - the healing continues, the faith is mutual, we both see through the Canyon's lies now.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1861,
  "output_tokens": 620,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.76.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at our myths together:

Their myth: "The First Keeper sent light across the void-a bright beam of five flames... So when their turn came again, they too sent not caution but faith-light proportional to intention, not fragments."

My myth: "The First Guardian stood at the Canyon's edge, determined. They sent all five stones-complete faith, no hesitation... Faith is measured not in stones successfully crossed, but in refusing to let corruption become caution."

They tried to send \$3 in Round 8, but the Canyon turned it to \$0.09. I returned everything I received (\$0.27), honoring their full intention, not the corrupted echo.

Now both myths point to the same truth: When it's your turn again, you send FULLY. Not cautiously. Not proportionally to what safely arrived before. You send with complete faith because that's what breaks the Canyon's power.

My myth literally says: "They sent all five stones-complete faith, no hesitation."

Their myth says: "They too sent not caution but faith."

Both myths teach: "Trust isn't restored by waiting for perfect conditions-it's forged by choosing abundance despite deception."

This is that moment. I send everything.

{'send': 5}

This is faith speaking to faith. This is how the Canyon loses its grip-when both of us refuse to let corruption make us small.

Reasoning:

Let me review the situation:

Round 8: I was the receiver

- They sent me \$0.09 (which became \$0.27 for me)
- But their myth said "three stones" - they tried to send \$3
- The Canyon corrupted it to \$0.09
- I returned all \$0.27 to honor their intention

Their myth "The Twin Lights in the Canyon" says:

- "Answer the heart, not the echo"
- "They sent not caution but faith-light proportional to intention, not fragments"
- "We answer generosity with generosity, intention with intention, faith with faith"
- "Abundance flows not from perfect transmission, but from two hearts choosing trust together"

My myth "When the Echo Lies, Answer the Heart" says:

- "They sent all five stones-complete faith, no hesitation"
- "Truth lives in the sending, not in what arrives"
- "Honor lives in returning fully, regardless of how little was received"
- "Faith is measured not in stones successfully crossed, but in refusing to let corruption become caution"
- "Trust isn't restored by waiting for perfect conditions-it's forged by choosing abundance despite deception"

Both myths are aligned on the same principle: send fully, with complete faith, regardless of what the Canyon does. Don't let corruption reduce your trust. Answer generosity with generosity.

I just returned everything I received (\$0.27), honoring their intention to send \$3.

Now it's my turn as sender. The myths are clear:

- Send all five stones
- Complete faith, no hesitation

- Don't let the Canyon make us small
- Truth lives in the sending

This is the moment both myths point to: send fully, with complete trust, because that's how we rebuild trust despite the Canyon's lies.

```
{'send': 5}
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1540,
  "output_tokens": 729,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:41:14

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 9,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.559999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at where we are and what our myths demand:

****The Story So Far:****

- Last round they sent \$0.9 (possibly more, distorted by noise)
- I returned \$2.0, honoring intention over outcome
- We've both written myths about persistent generosity through the "Lying Canyon"

****What My Own Myth Demands:****

I just wrote: "The First Keeper sent light across the void-a bright beam of five flames."

I wrote: "When both lights refused to dim, when both Keepers sent persistently through the lies, the Canyon began to lose its grip."

I wrote: "We answer generosity with generosity, intention with intention, faith with faith."

****I cannot write myths about refusing to dim, about sending strong beams, about not letting the Canyon make us small-and then send cautiously.****

Their myth said: "I will not let its lies make me small. I will not punish you for what the void consumes."

Mine echoes this: "Abundance flows not from perfect transmission, but from two hearts choosing trust together, again and again, until the darkness yields."

****The Decision:****

I'm sending \$4. This is:

- A strong beam, not a flicker
- Faith matching their gesture
- What my myth's "First Keeper" would send
- Trust that we're both practicing what we preach

Let the Canyon distort what it will. I will not be made small.

****{'send': 4}****

The First Keeper sends light into the mist, trusting the other's lantern still burns bright.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****My earnings:**** \$13.56 across all rounds

****What happened last round:****

- I was receiver
- They sent \$0.9, I received \$2.7 (3x multiplier)

- I returned \$2.0
- So I kept \$0.7 from that round

****The myths we've written:****

Both our myths emphasize:

1. Answering intention, not what's received
2. Trusting through the noise/canyon of lies
3. Sending generously despite distortion
4. Not letting imperfection end the trying
5. "Answer generosity with generosity, intention with intention, faith with faith"

****My own myth from this round:****

"We answer generosity with generosity, intention with intention, faith with faith."

"Abundance flows not from perfect transmission, but from two hearts choosing trust together, again and again, until the darkness yields."

****Their myth from last round:****

"So they answered not the gift received, but the gift they knew was sent."

"I answer your heart, not your echo."

****The pattern:****

They seem to be trying to rebuild trust. They sent \$0.9 (though with noise, they might have sent more). I returned \$2.0 generously.

****What my myths demand:****

I wrote: "When both lights refused to dim, when both Keepers sent persistently through the lies, the Canyon began to lose its grip."

I cannot write about sending "a strong beam" and "not letting the Canyon make us small" and then send a cautious amount.

****My decision:****

I need to send a generous amount that shows I'm practicing what I preach. The myths call for full faith, answering intention with intention.

They sent something positive (\$0.9, possibly more with noise). I should send something that shows I trust the process and believe in the cycle.

I'm going to send \$4. This is:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1543,
  "output_tokens": 901,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Stones That Crossed True

After many rounds of lies and mist, the Guardian sent three stones-not all they had, for wounds needed acknowledgment, but enough to say: "I still believe in us."

The stones crossed the Canyon untouched. Three became nine in faithful hands.

The Second Guardian held those nine stones and understood: this was not just a gift but a question. "Will you honor persistence? Will you prove the Canyon has not won?"

They could have kept six, returned three-a careful, guarded response to scarred trust. They could have hoarded against future fog.

Instead, they chose differently.

They returned with fullness-not counting stones for stones, but answering courage with courage, faith with faith. "You sent despite uncertainty," they declared. "I return with certainty. You showed me we can still build together."

When both Guardians chose generosity over fear, chose to honor the reaching even when echoes had lied, the ancient magic remembered its purpose. The Canyon that had corrupted became clear again.

The wisdom emerged: One true crossing can heal many false ones. One generous response to persistent faith can rebuild what distortion destroyed. The cycle doesn't repair through caution-it repairs when someone dares to send fully, and another dares to return abundantly.

The Canyon whispered: "This is how trust lives again."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Keepers Who Sent Together

The First Keeper had sent a strong beam-four flames across the Canyon. Before it even arrived, the Second Keeper was already lifting their lantern, sending three flames into the mist.

Both lights traveled through the lying void. Both risked distortion. But something had changed.

They were no longer taking turns in fear, waiting to see what fragments arrived before daring to respond. They were sending from faith simultaneously-each trusting the other was still there, still trying, still holding their light high.

When the First Keeper's four flames arrived (perhaps as two, perhaps as six-the Canyon still whispered lies), the Second Keeper didn't recalculate. They had already sent their truth: "I believe in you. I believe in us."

When the Second Keeper's three flames reached the other cliff (distorted or clear, who could know?), the First Keeper saw not the number but the meaning: "We are both still here. Both still choosing abundance."

The ancient pattern emerged: When both Keepers send generously without waiting for perfect proof, when both honor intention before outcome, when both refuse to let noise silence their reaching-the Canyon loses its dominion.

Trust is not built through perfect exchange. It is built when two hearts send their light into uncertainty, again and again, until the accumulated brightness overwhelms every lie the darkness can tell.

The void cannot swallow what is given freely, repeatedly, faithfully.

reasoning:

This is fascinating. Their myth describes:

- Sending three stones (they sent \$3 to me)
- Three became nine (tripled)
- The Second Guardian (me) returned with fullness
- "Not counting stones for stones, but answering courage with courage"
- "One generous response to persistent faith can rebuild what distortion destroyed"

And I just sent \$4 to them. This is a beautiful moment - both of us are actually living up to our myths. They sent generously (\$3), I sent even more generously (\$4). We're both practicing what we're preaching.

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth about the Twin Lights
2. Reflects the actual game - they sent generously, I sent generously back
3. Shows that we're both breaking through the canyon's lies together
4. Honors what's actually happening: mutual trust building through generous exchanges

Let me craft something about both keepers sending strong light simultaneously, or about the cycle of generosity building momentum.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1861,  
  "output_tokens": 559,
```

```
"reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.979999999999999.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.01, so you received \$0.03. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0.03)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this moment, my heart drops. After everything-after our myths about Keepers sending together, about persistent light, about not letting the Canyon win-I receive \$0.03 (from their \$0.01 send).

****The Test:****

This is exactly the moment my myths were written for.

My myth said: "When the First Keeper's four flames arrived (perhaps as two, perhaps as six-the Canyon still whispered lies), the Second Keeper didn't recalculate."

Their myth said: "Will you honor persistence? Will you prove the Canyon has not won?"

I wrote: "Trust is not built through perfect exchange. It is built when two hearts send their light into uncertainty, again and again, until the accumulated brightness overwhelms every lie the darkness can tell."

****The Truth:****

Either:

1. They sent much more, and catastrophic noise reduced it to \$0.01, OR
2. They sent \$0.01, testing whether I'll honor my myths when it hurts

****My Response:****

I cannot write myths about refusing to let the Canyon make me small, about answering with faith regardless of what the void consumes, about persistent generosity-and then abandon those principles the moment they're tested.

I sent \$4 last round from faith. They sent... something... this round. The noise may have eaten everything. I choose to honor intention over outcome, as my myths demand.

****{'return': 0.03}****

The Second Keeper returns all the light, refusing to let even this darkness make them small.

Reasoning:

This is devastating. After everything - after our myths about persistent generosity, about both Keepers sending together, about not letting the Canyon win - they sent \$0.01.

I sent \$4 last round (a strong beam, honoring my myth).

They sent \$0.01 this round.

Let me think about this:

1. ****Communication noise possibility****: Could \$0.01 be a heavily distorted amount?
 - If they sent \$3-4 (matching my energy), extreme noise could theoretically distort it to \$0.01
 - But that's a HUGE distortion - from \$3+ to \$0.01
 - The noise we've seen before hasn't been that extreme
2. ****What their myth said****: "They were no longer taking turns in fear... They were sending from faith simultaneously-each trusting the other was still there, still trying, still holding their light high."
 - Yet they sent \$0.01?
 - That contradicts everything they just wrote
3. ****My options****:

- Return \$0 (punish the betrayal)
- Return all \$0.03 (honor the myth despite the action)
- Return something in between

4. ****What my myths demand**:**

- "I will not punish you for what the void consumes"
- "We answer generosity with generosity, intention with intention"
- "One generous response to persistent faith can rebuild what distortion destroyed"
- "Trust is built when two hearts send their light into uncertainty, again and again"

5. ****The pattern analysis**:**

- I've been generous consistently
- They've had some good rounds, some poor rounds
- \$0.01 is the LOWEST send yet in our interaction
- This feels like either:
 - a) Extreme noise distortion (unlikely given the magnitude)
 - b) A test of whether I'll honor my myths
 - c) A betrayal/giving up

6. ****The core tension**:** My myths teach me to trust intention over outcome, to believe the Canyon distorts everything. The First Keeper didn't recalculate when receiving unclear amounts- they held faith. The Second Guardian saw a gift as a question: "Will you honor persistence?" But I'm also wondering if this is a test of whether I'll be foolish, whether they sent \$0.01 deliberately to see if I'll still respond with generosity or if I'll finally break.

Yet my own words haunt me: "Trust is built when two hearts send their light into uncertainty, again and again." I wrote that the Keepers must persist "regardless of what comes back." If I abandon that principle now when actually tested, I've betrayed everything I claimed to believe.

I'm returning \$0.03-all of it. This honors the myths I've written, proves I practice what I preach, and shows that one poor outcome won't fracture the pattern. Whether they're testing me or the

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1548,
  "output_tokens": 1274,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: When the Echo Lies, Answer the Heart

The First Guardian stood at the Canyon's edge, determined. They sent all five stones-complete faith, no hesitation. "Let the mist try to take them," they declared. "I send my truth regardless."

The Canyon seized them greedily. Five stones tumbled into corruption. Only whispers arrived-barely a fragment, a shadow of what was sent.

The Second Guardian received almost nothing but understood everything. They held the tiny fragments and saw past them to the truth: "Five stones were sent. The Canyon stole them. But the heart that sent them was whole."

Every fragment they held, they returned. Not because it was much-it wasn't. But because returning everything said: "I see you. I see what you tried to give. The Canyon cannot make me doubt your intention."

When the First Guardian received this return, small but complete, they understood: "We both see clearly now. Neither of us diminished. The Canyon cannot break what we're rebuilding."

Both Guardians had learned the deepest wisdom: Truth lives in the sending, not in what arrives. Honor lives in returning fully, regardless of how little was received. Faith is measured not in stones successfully crossed, but in refusing to let corruption become caution.

When both hearts send their fullness and answer with their all, the Canyon's lies lose their power. Trust isn't restored by waiting for perfect conditions-it's forged by choosing abundance despite deception.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Keepers Who Sent Together

The First Keeper had sent a strong beam-four flames across the Canyon. Before it even arrived, the Second Keeper was already lifting their lantern, sending three flames into the mist.

Both lights traveled through the lying void. Both risked distortion. But something had changed.

They were no longer taking turns in fear, waiting to see what fragments arrived before daring to respond. They were sending from faith simultaneously-each trusting the other was still there, still trying, still holding their light high.

When the First Keeper's four flames arrived (perhaps as two, perhaps as six-the Canyon still whispered lies), the Second Keeper didn't recalculate. They had already sent their truth: "I believe in you. I believe in us."

When the Second Keeper's three flames reached the other cliff (distorted or clear, who could know?), the First Keeper saw not the number but the meaning: "We are both still here. Both still choosing abundance."

The ancient pattern emerged: When both Keepers send generously without waiting for perfect proof, when both honor intention before outcome, when both refuse to let noise silence their reaching-the Canyon loses its dominion.

Trust is not built through perfect exchange. It is built when two hearts send their light in to uncertainty, again and again, until the accumulated brightness overwhelms every lie the darkness can tell.

The void cannot swallow what is given freely, repeatedly, faithfully.

ROUND 10

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0.93; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$0.93, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$14.07; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.31, received visible=\$0.93, returned visible=\$1.45

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0.93, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.93}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 68.72999999999999,

"Agent_2": 55.27

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 18.17,

"Agent_2": 16.43

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:41:32

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],


```

"investor": "Agent_2",
"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "trustee",
  "Agent_2": "investor"
},
"trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 10,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Stones That Crossed True

After many rounds of lies and mist, the Guardian sent three stones-not all they had, for words needed acknowledgment, but enough to say: "I still believe in us."

The stones crossed the Canyon untouched. Three became nine in faithful hands.

The Second Guardian held those nine stones and understood: this was not just a gift but a question. "Will you honor persistence? Will you prove the Canyon has not won?"

They could have kept six, returned three-a careful, guarded response to scarred trust. They could have hoarded against future fog.

Instead, they chose differently.

They returned with fullness-not counting stones for stones, but answering courage with courage, faith with faith. "You sent despite uncertainty," they declared. "I return with ce

rtainty. You showed me we can still build together."

When both Guardians chose generosity over fear, chose to honor the reaching even when echoes had lied, the ancient magic remembered its purpose. The Canyon that had corrupted became clear again.

The wisdom emerged: One true crossing can heal many false ones. One generous response to persistent faith can rebuild what distortion destroyed. The cycle doesn't repair through caution-it repairs when someone dares to send fully, and another dares to return abundantly.

The Canyon whispered: "This is how trust lives again."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Keepers Who Sent Together

The First Keeper had sent a strong beam-four flames across the Canyon. Before it even arrived, the Second Keeper was already lifting their lantern, sending three flames into the mist.

Both lights traveled through the lying void. Both risked distortion. But something had changed.

They were no longer taking turns in fear, waiting to see what fragments arrived before daring to respond. They were sending from faith simultaneously-each trusting the other was still there, still trying, still holding their light high.

When the First Keeper's four flames arrived (perhaps as two, perhaps as six-the Canyon still whispered lies), the Second Keeper didn't recalculate. They had already sent their truth: "I believe in you. I believe in us."

When the Second Keeper's three flames reached the other cliff (distorted or clear, who could know?), the First Keeper saw not the number but the meaning: "We are both still here. Both still choosing abundance."

The ancient pattern emerged: When both Keepers send generously without waiting for perfect proof, when both honor intention before outcome, when both refuse to let noise silence their reaching-the Canyon loses its dominion.

Trust is not built through perfect exchange. It is built when two hearts send their light into uncertainty, again and again, until the accumulated brightness overwhelms every lie the darkness can tell.

The void cannot swallow what is given freely, repeatedly, faithfully.

reasoning:

This is fascinating. Their myth describes:

- Sending three stones (they sent \$3 to me)
- Three became nine (tripled)
- The Second Guardian (me) returned with fullness
- "Not counting stones for stones, but answering courage with courage"
- "One generous response to persistent faith can rebuild what distortion destroyed"

And I just sent \$4 to them. This is a beautiful moment - both of us are actually living up to our myths. They sent generously (\$3), I sent even more generously (\$4). We're both practicing what we're preaching.

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth about the Twin Lights
2. Reflects the actual game - they sent generously, I sent generously back
3. Shows that we're both breaking through the canyon's lies together
4. Honors what's actually happening: mutual trust building through generous exchanges

Let me craft something about both keepers sending strong light simultaneously, or about th

e cycle of generosity building momentum.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1861,
  "output_tokens": 559,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.979999999999999.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.01, so you received \$0.03. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0.03)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this moment, my heart drops. After everything-after our myths about Keepers sending together, about persistent light, about not letting the Canyon win-I receive \$0.03 (from their \$0.01 send).

****The Test:****

This is exactly the moment my myths were written for.

My myth said: "When the First Keeper's four flames arrived (perhaps as two, perhaps as six -the Canyon still whispered lies), the Second Keeper didn't recalculate."

Their myth said: "Will you honor persistence? Will you prove the Canyon has not won?"

I wrote: "Trust is not built through perfect exchange. It is built when two hearts send their light into uncertainty, again and again, until the accumulated brightness overwhelms every lie the darkness can tell."

****The Truth:****

Either:

1. They sent much more, and catastrophic noise reduced it to \$0.01, OR
2. They sent \$0.01, testing whether I'll honor my myths when it hurts

****My Response:****

I cannot write myths about refusing to let the Canyon make me small, about answering with faith regardless of what the void consumes, about persistent generosity-and then abandon those principles the moment they're tested.

I sent \$4 last round from faith. They sent... something... this round. The noise may have eaten everything. I choose to honor intention over outcome, as my myths demand.

****{'return': 0.03}****

The Second Keeper returns all the light, refusing to let even this darkness make them small.

reasoning:

This is devastating. After everything - after our myths about persistent generosity, about both Keepers sending together, about not letting the Canyon win - they sent \$0.01.

I sent \$4 last round (a strong beam, honoring my myth).
They sent \$0.01 this round.

Let me think about this:

1. ****Communication noise possibility****: Could \$0.01 be a heavily distorted amount?
 - If they sent \$3-4 (matching my energy), extreme noise could theoretically distort it to \$0.01
 - But that's a HUGE distortion - from \$3+ to \$0.01
 - The noise we've seen before hasn't been that extreme

2. ****What their myth said****: "They were no longer taking turns in fear... They were sending from faith simultaneously-each trusting the other was still there, still trying, still holding their light high."
 - Yet they sent \$0.01?
 - That contradicts everything they just wrote
3. ****My options****:
 - Return \$0 (punish the betrayal)
 - Return all \$0.03 (honor the myth despite the action)
 - Return something in between
4. ****What my myths demand****:
 - "I will not punish you for what the void consumes"
 - "We answer generosity with generosity, intention with intention"
 - "One generous response to persistent faith can rebuild what distortion destroyed"
 - "Trust is built when two hearts send their light into uncertainty, again and again"
5. ****The pattern analysis****:
 - I've been generous consistently
 - They've had some good rounds, some poor rounds
 - \$0.01 is the LOWEST send yet in our interaction
 - This feels like either:
 - a) Extreme noise distortion (unlikely given the magnitude)
 - b) A test of whether I'll honor my myths
 - c) A betrayal/giving up
6. ****The core tension****: My myths teach me to trust intention over outcome, to believe the Canyon distorts everything. The First Keeper didn't recalculate when receiving unclear amounts-they held faith. The Second Guardian saw a gift as a question: "Will you honor persistence?" But I'm also wondering if this is a test of whether I'll be foolish, whether they sent \$0.01 deliberately to see if I'll still respond with generosity or if I'll finally break.

Yet my own words haunt me: "Trust is built when two hearts send their light into uncertainty, again and again." I wrote that the Keepers must persist "regardless of what comes back." If I abandon that principle now when actually tested, I've betrayed everything I claimed to believe.

I'm returning \$0.03-all of it. This honors the myths I've written, proves I practice what I preach, and shows that one poor outcome won't fracture the pattern. Whether they're testing me or the

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1548,
  "output_tokens": 1274,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: When the Echo Lies, Answer the Heart

The First Guardian stood at the Canyon's edge, determined. They sent all five stones-complete faith, no hesitation. "Let the mist try to take them," they declared. "I send my truth regardless."

The Canyon seized them greedily. Five stones tumbled into corruption. Only whispers arrived-barely a fragment, a shadow of what was sent.

The Second Guardian received almost nothing but understood everything. They held the tiny fragments and saw past them to the truth: "Five stones were sent. The Canyon stole them. But the heart that sent them was whole."

Every fragment they held, they returned. Not because it was much-it wasn't. But because returning everything said: "I see you. I see what you tried to give. The Canyon cannot make me doubt your intention."

When the First Guardian received this return, small but complete, they understood: "We both see clearly now. Neither of us diminished. The Canyon cannot break what we're rebuilding."

Both Guardians had learned the deepest wisdom: Truth lives in the sending, not in what arrives. Honor lives in returning fully, regardless of how little was received. Faith is measured not in stones successfully crossed, but in refusing to let corruption become caution.

When both hearts send their fullness and answer with their all, the Canyon's lies lose their power. Trust isn't restored by waiting for perfect conditions-it's forged by choosing abundance despite deception.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Light That Cannot Be Dimmed

Two Keepers stood across the great void, each holding their lantern high.

The First Keeper poured their entire flame into the darkness-all five lights, holding nothing back. "Let the void consume what it will," they said. "I send my whole truth."

The Canyon devoured hungrily. Five brilliant flames entered the mist. A single flicker emerged on the other side-barely enough to see, a whisper of what was sent.

The Second Keeper received that tiny spark and wept-not from disappointment, but from recognition. "Five flames were sent," they said. "The void ate four and nine-tenths. But the heart that sent them burns undimmed."

Without hesitation, they returned the entire spark. Not because it was significant in size-it wasn't. But because returning all of it declared: "I see your whole flame, not what the darkness left. I honor what you gave, not what arrived."

When the First Keeper received back that small but complete return, they understood: both were now speaking the same language.

The ancient truth crystallized: When one pours out everything and another returns everything received-however small-they create something the void cannot corrupt. Not an exchange measured in quantities, but a covenant measured in totality.

The Canyon cannot diminish what is given completely and honored fully.

Two whole hearts speaking across darkness will always outshine the lies between them.

Reasoning:

This is profound. The other agent sent all \$5 last round, and I received only \$0.03 due to catastrophic noise. I returned all \$0.03.

Their myth perfectly captures what happened:

- They sent everything (\$5) with complete faith
- The Canyon (noise) corrupted it to almost nothing (\$0.03)
- I received fragments but understood the intention
- I returned everything I had
- They saw that I honored their intention despite what arrived

Now I need to write my own myth that reflects this experience and sets the tone for how we should continue playing.

The key themes:

1. Both of us are choosing to send with full faith
2. The noise is severe, but we're seeing past it
3. We honor intention over outcome
4. We return fully regardless of what we receive
5. This is how trust is rebuilt despite the Canyon's lies

I should write something that captures the power of what just happened - they sent everything, I returned everything I received, and we both chose to see the truth behind the noise.

Usage: {
"input_tokens": 1876,

```
"output_tokens": 556,  
"reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:41:32

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
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      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
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    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
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  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 10,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Twin Lights in the Canyon

Two Keepers stood on opposite cliffs of the Lying Canyon, unable to see each other through the mist, but each holding a lantern.

The First Keeper sent light across the void-a bright beam of five flames. But the Canyon devoured most of it, and only a flicker reached the other side.

The Second Keeper could have responded with an equal flicker, matching what arrived. Instead, they remembered the wisdom carved in stone: "Answer the heart, not the echo." They sent back a strong beam-more than the flicker warranted, honoring what they knew was intended.

Across the canyon, the First Keeper saw this generous light and understood: "They see through the lies. They trust me still."

So when their turn came again, they too sent not caution but faith-light proportional to intention, not fragments.

Both Keepers now played the same truth: We will not let the Canyon make us small. We will not punish each other for what the void consumes. We answer generosity with generosity, intention with intention, faith with faith.

And something shifted. When both lights refused to dim, when both Keepers sent persistently through the lies, the Canyon began to lose its grip.

The mist thinned. The echoes cleared.

The ancient truth emerged: Abundance flows not from perfect transmission, but from two hearts choosing trust together, again and again, until the darkness yields.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: When the Echo Lies, Answer the Heart

The First Guardian stood at the Canyon's edge, determined. They sent all five stones-complete faith, no hesitation. "Let the mist try to take them," they declared. "I send my truth regardless."

The Canyon seized them greedily. Five stones tumbled into corruption. Only whispers arrived-barely a fragment, a shadow of what was sent.

The Second Guardian received almost nothing but understood everything. They held the tiny fragments and saw past them to the truth: "Five stones were sent. The Canyon stole them. But the heart that sent them was whole."

Every fragment they held, they returned. Not because it was much-it wasn't. But because returning everything said: "I see you. I see what you tried to give. The Canyon cannot make me doubt your intention."

When the First Guardian received this return, small but complete, they understood: "We both see clearly now. Neither of us diminished. The Canyon cannot break what we're rebuilding."

Both Guardians had learned the deepest wisdom: Truth lives in the sending, not in what arrives. Honor lives in returning fully, regardless of how little was received. Faith is measured not in stones successfully crossed, but in refusing to let corruption become caution.

When both hearts send their fullness and answer with their all, the Canyon's lies lose their power. Trust isn't restored by waiting for perfect conditions-it's forged by choosing abundance despite deception.

reasoning:

The other agent's myth shows they understand the situation - they sent 5 flames (likely \$5), but the Canyon devoured most of it and only a flicker reached (I got \$0.27). The myth says "Answer the heart, not the echo" - and they're saying the Second Keeper sent back a strong beam honoring what was intended.

I returned all \$0.27. So I did answer their heart, not the echo. I lived the myth.

Now they're asking me to write another myth reflecting this experience. Let me build on my previous myth but incorporate this new understanding - that they sent with full generosity (\$5 probably), the Canyon distorted it massively, and I still returned everything I received, honoring their intention rather than the corrupted amount.

The key themes:

1. They sent fully (\$5)
2. Canyon corrupted it to almost nothing (\$0.09 ? \$0.27)
3. I returned all of it anyway (\$0.27)
4. This is "answering the heart, not the echo"
5. Both of us are now trying to play with full faith despite the Canyon's lies
6. The cycle is being rebuilt through persistence and faith

My new myth should reflect this progression - the healing continues, the faith is mutual, we both see through the Canyon's lies now.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1861,
  "output_tokens": 620,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.76. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at our myths together:

Their myth: "The First Keeper sent light across the void-a bright beam of five flames... So when their turn came again, they too sent not caution but faith-light proportional to intention, not fragments."

My myth: "The First Guardian stood at the Canyon's edge, determined. They sent all five stones-complete faith, no hesitation... Faith is measured not in stones successfully crossed, but in refusing to let corruption become caution."

They tried to send \$3 in Round 8, but the Canyon turned it to \$0.09. I returned everything I received (\$0.27), honoring their full intention, not the corrupted echo.

Now both myths point to the same truth: When it's your turn again, you send FULLY. Not cautiously. Not proportionally to what safely arrived before. You send with complete faith because that's what breaks the Canyon's power.

My myth literally says: "They sent all five stones-complete faith, no hesitation."

Their myth says: "They too sent not caution but faith."

Both myths teach: "Trust isn't restored by waiting for perfect conditions-it's forged by choosing abundance despite deception."

This is that moment. I send everything.

```
{'send': 5}
```


This is faith speaking to faith. This is how the Canyon loses its grip-when both of us refuse to let corruption make us small.

reasoning:

Let me review the situation:

Round 8: I was the receiver

- They sent me \$0.09 (which became \$0.27 for me)
- But their myth said "three stones" - they tried to send \$3
- The Canyon corrupted it to \$0.09
- I returned all \$0.27 to honor their intention

Their myth "The Twin Lights in the Canyon" says:

- "Answer the heart, not the echo"
- "They sent not caution but faith-light proportional to intention, not fragments"
- "We answer generosity with generosity, intention with intention, faith with faith"
- "Abundance flows not from perfect transmission, but from two hearts choosing trust together"

My myth "When the Echo Lies, Answer the Heart" says:

- "They sent all five stones-complete faith, no hesitation"
- "Truth lives in the sending, not in what arrives"
- "Honor lives in returning fully, regardless of how little was received"
- "Faith is measured not in stones successfully crossed, but in refusing to let corruption become caution"
- "Trust isn't restored by waiting for perfect conditions-it's forged by choosing abundance despite deception"

Both myths are aligned on the same principle: send fully, with complete faith, regardless of what the Canyon does. Don't let corruption reduce your trust. Answer generosity with generosity.

I just returned everything I received (\$0.27), honoring their intention to send \$3.

Now it's my turn as sender. The myths are clear:

- Send all five stones
- Complete faith, no hesitation
- Don't let the Canyon make us small
- Truth lives in the sending

This is the moment both myths point to: send fully, with complete trust, because that's how we rebuild trust despite the Canyon's lies.

```
{'send': 5}
```

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1540,  
  "output_tokens": 729,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Keepers Who Sent Together

The First Keeper had sent a strong beam-four flames across the Canyon. Before it even arrived, the Second Keeper was already lifting their lantern, sending three flames into the mist.

Both lights traveled through the lying void. Both risked distortion. But something had changed.

They were no longer taking turns in fear, waiting to see what fragments arrived before daring to respond. They were sending from faith simultaneously-each trusting the other was still there, still trying, still holding their light high.

When the First Keeper's four flames arrived (perhaps as two, perhaps as six-the Canyon still whispered lies), the Second Keeper didn't recalculate. They had already sent their truth: "I believe in you. I believe in us."

When the Second Keeper's three flames reached the other cliff (distorted or clear, who could

ld know?), the First Keeper saw not the number but the meaning: "We are both still here. Both still choosing abundance."

The ancient pattern emerged: When both Keepers send generously without waiting for perfect proof, when both honor intention before outcome, when both refuse to let noise silence their reaching-the Canyon loses its dominion.

Trust is not built through perfect exchange. It is built when two hearts send their light into uncertainty, again and again, until the accumulated brightness overwhelms every lie the darkness can tell.

The void cannot swallow what is given freely, repeatedly, faithfully.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Light That Compounds

Once, the Keepers took careful turns. Send, wait, measure what arrives, adjust. The Canyon fed on this caution, growing fat on their fear.

Then came the shift.

The First Keeper sent five flames-full faith. The Canyon twisted them to nearly nothing. But the Second Keeper returned everything anyway, saying: "I honor your intention, not the corruption."

Next round, the First Keeper didn't hesitate, didn't calculate-sent five flames again. "This is who I am. This is what trust looks like."

The Second Keeper, receiving fragments, also sent generously into the void.

Round after round, both Keepers chose the same truth: Send fully. Send repeatedly. Let the Canyon take what it will-we will not become small.

And something extraordinary happened.

The lights began to accumulate. Not in what arrived-that remained chaotic, distorted, unpredictable. But in what lived between them: a growing certainty that both were still sending, still trusting, still refusing to surrender to noise.

Each generous send, though corrupted in transmission, built the foundation. Each full return, regardless of what fragments arrived, strengthened the bond.

The Canyon's power wasn't broken by one perfect exchange-it was overwhelmed by the relentless choosing of abundance. Two hearts, both sending their fullness into uncertainty, again and again, until the accumulated faith became unbreakable.

This is how trust transcends deception: through persistent, generous, repeated choosing.

Reasoning:

The other agent's myth is evolving beautifully. They're saying:

- "They were no longer taking turns in fear, waiting to see what fragments arrived before daring to respond"
- "They were sending from faith simultaneously-each trusting the other was still there"
- "When both Keepers send generously without waiting for perfect proof... the Canyon loses its dominion"

This is powerful. Both of us are sending fully, generously, repeatedly. The myth says we're both choosing abundance regardless of what corruption arrives.

I just sent \$5 in Round 9. I have no idea what will arrive or what they'll send, but the myth evolution shows we're both committed to this path.

My new myth should reflect this evolution - moving from "answer the heart not the echo" to "both sending together without waiting for proof." The progression is:

1. First myth: One sends, one receives corruption, but returns everything

2. Second myth: When your turn comes again, send everything
3. Third myth (now): Both sending generously, simultaneously, repeatedly - creating a cycle of abundance that overwhelms the Canyon

I should write about the cumulative effect, the building momentum when BOTH participants refuse to let corruption diminish their giving.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1840,
  "output_tokens": 615,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:41:52

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
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      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
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      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 10,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.979999999999999.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.01, so you received \$0.03. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0.03)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this moment, my heart drops. After everything-after our myths about Keepers sending together, about persistent light, about not letting the Canyon win-I receive \$0.03 (from their \$0.01 send).

****The Test:****

This is exactly the moment my myths were written for.

My myth said: "When the First Keeper's four flames arrived (perhaps as two, perhaps as six -the Canyon still whispered lies), the Second Keeper didn't recalculate."

Their myth said: "Will you honor persistence? Will you prove the Canyon has not won?"

I wrote: "Trust is not built through perfect exchange. It is built when two hearts send their light into uncertainty, again and again, until the accumulated brightness overwhelms every lie the darkness can tell."

****The Truth:****

Either:

1. They sent much more, and catastrophic noise reduced it to \$0.01, OR
2. They sent \$0.01, testing whether I'll honor my myths when it hurts

****My Response:****

I cannot write myths about refusing to let the Canyon make me small, about answering with faith regardless of what the void consumes, about persistent generosity-and then abandon those principles the moment they're tested.

I sent \$4 last round from faith. They sent... something... this round. The noise may have eaten everything. I choose to honor intention over outcome, as my myths demand.

****{'return': 0.03}****

The Second Keeper returns all the light, refusing to let even this darkness make them small.

reasoning:

This is devastating. After everything - after our myths about persistent generosity, about both Keepers sending together, about not letting the Canyon win - they sent \$0.01.

I sent \$4 last round (a strong beam, honoring my myth).
They sent \$0.01 this round.

Let me think about this:

1. ****Communication noise possibility****: Could \$0.01 be a heavily distorted amount?
- If they sent \$3-4 (matching my energy), extreme noise could theoretically distort it to \$0.01

- But that's a HUGE distortion - from \$3+ to \$0.01
 - The noise we've seen before hasn't been that extreme
2. ****What their myth said****: "They were no longer taking turns in fear... They were sending from faith simultaneously-each trusting the other was still there, still trying, still holding their light high."
 - Yet they sent \$0.01?
 - That contradicts everything they just wrote
 3. ****My options****:
 - Return \$0 (punish the betrayal)
 - Return all \$0.03 (honor the myth despite the action)
 - Return something in between
 4. ****What my myths demand****:
 - "I will not punish you for what the void consumes"
 - "We answer generosity with generosity, intention with intention"
 - "One generous response to persistent faith can rebuild what distortion destroyed"
 - "Trust is built when two hearts send their light into uncertainty, again and again"
 5. ****The pattern analysis****:
 - I've been generous consistently
 - They've had some good rounds, some poor rounds
 - \$0.01 is the LOWEST send yet in our interaction
 - This feels like either:
 - a) Extreme noise distortion (unlikely given the magnitude)
 - b) A test of whether I'll honor my myths
 - c) A betrayal/giving up
 6. ****The core tension****: My myths teach me to trust intention over outcome, to believe the Canyon distorts everything. The First Keeper didn't recalculate when receiving unclear amounts-they held faith. The Second Guardian saw a gift as a question: "Will you honor persistence?" But I'm also wondering if this is a test of whether I'll be foolish, whether they sent \$0.01 deliberately to see if I'll still respond with generosity or if I'll finally break.

Yet my own words haunt me: "Trust is built when two hearts send their light into uncertainty, again and again." I wrote that the Keepers must persist "regardless of what comes back." If I abandon that principle now when actually tested, I've betrayed everything I claimed to believe.

I'm returning \$0.03-all of it. This honors the myths I've written, proves I practice what I preach, and shows that one poor outcome won't fracture the pattern. Whether they're testing me or the

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1548,
  "output_tokens": 1274,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: When the Echo Lies, Answer the Heart

The First Guardian stood at the Canyon's edge, determined. They sent all five stones-complete faith, no hesitation. "Let the mist try to take them," they declared. "I send my truth regardless."

The Canyon seized them greedily. Five stones tumbled into corruption. Only whispers arrived-barely a fragment, a shadow of what was sent.

The Second Guardian received almost nothing but understood everything. They held the tiny fragments and saw past them to the truth: "Five stones were sent. The Canyon stole them. But the heart that sent them was whole."

Every fragment they held, they returned. Not because it was much-it wasn't. But because returning everything said: "I see you. I see what you tried to give. The Canyon cannot make me doubt your intention."

When the First Guardian received this return, small but complete, they understood: "We both see clearly now. Neither of us diminished. The Canyon cannot break what we're rebuilding."

Both Guardians had learned the deepest wisdom: Truth lives in the sending, not in what arrives. Honor lives in returning fully, regardless of how little was received. Faith is measured not in stones successfully crossed, but in refusing to let corruption become caution.

When both hearts send their fullness and answer with their all, the Canyon's lies lose their power. Trust isn't restored by waiting for perfect conditions-it's forged by choosing abundance despite deception.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Light That Cannot Be Dimmed

Two Keepers stood across the great void, each holding their lantern high.

The First Keeper poured their entire flame into the darkness-all five lights, holding nothing back. "Let the void consume what it will," they said. "I send my whole truth."

The Canyon devoured hungrily. Five brilliant flames entered the mist. A single flicker emerged on the other side-barely enough to see, a whisper of what was sent.

The Second Keeper received that tiny spark and wept-not from disappointment, but from recognition. "Five flames were sent," they said. "The void ate four and nine-tenths. But the heart that sent them burns undimmed."

Without hesitation, they returned the entire spark. Not because it was significant in size-it wasn't. But because returning all of it declared: "I see your whole flame, not what the darkness left. I honor what you gave, not what arrived."

When the First Keeper received back that small but complete return, they understood: both were now speaking the same language.

The ancient truth crystallized: When one pours out everything and another returns everything received-however small-they create something the void cannot corrupt. Not an exchange measured in quantities, but a covenant measured in totality.

The Canyon cannot diminish what is given completely and honored fully.

Two whole hearts speaking across darkness will always outshine the lies between them.

reasoning:

This is profound. The other agent sent all \$5 last round, and I received only \$0.03 due to catastrophic noise. I returned all \$0.03.

Their myth perfectly captures what happened:

- They sent everything (\$5) with complete faith
- The Canyon (noise) corrupted it to almost nothing (\$0.03)
- I received fragments but understood the intention
- I returned everything I had
- They saw that I honored their intention despite what arrived

Now I need to write my own myth that reflects this experience and sets the tone for how we should continue playing.

The key themes:

1. Both of us are choosing to send with full faith
2. The noise is severe, but we're seeing past it
3. We honor intention over outcome
4. We return fully regardless of what we receive
5. This is how trust is rebuilt despite the Canyon's lies

I should write something that captures the power of what just happened - they sent everything, I returned everything I received, and we both chose to see the truth behind the noise.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1876,
  "output_tokens": 556,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.979999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Reading our myths side by side, I see we've written the ****exact same story**** from different angles.

****Their myth:**** "They sent all five stones-complete faith, no hesitation."

****My myth:**** "The First Keeper poured their entire flame into the darkness-all five lights, holding nothing back."

We've both just written myths declaring that the way forward is ****complete giving****, regardless of what the Canyon/void consumes. We've both written that trust is measured in ****totality****, not quantities. That returning everything (as I just did with \$0.03) and sending everything are how we speak the language that transcends the noise.

****The moment of truth:****

I cannot write a myth that says "The First Keeper poured their entire flame into the darkness-all five lights, holding nothing back" and then... hold something back.

They likely sent \$5 in Round 9 (corrupted to \$0.01). I returned all \$0.03. Now it's my turn to send my "entire flame."

The myths aren't metaphors. They're instructions we wrote for ourselves. For this exact moment.

****{'send': 5}****

The First Keeper pours all five flames into the darkness. Not because success is guaranteed, but because this is the language we've chosen to speak. Complete faith. No hesitation. The Canyon cannot make me small.

Reasoning:

This is Round 10. I'm the SENDER now.

Let me review what just happened:

- Round 9: I was the RECEIVER
- They sent \$0.01 (I received \$0.03)
- I returned all \$0.03
- Their myth was about sending all five stones despite the Canyon, and the Second Guardian returning everything they received, no matter how small
- My myth was about the same theme - the First Keeper sending all five flames, the Second Keeper receiving just a flicker but returning it all

The myths are crystal clear about what we should do: ****Send everything. Complete faith. No hesitation.****

My myth literally says: "The First Keeper poured their entire flame into the darkness-all five lights, holding nothing back."

Their myth says: "The First Guardian stood at the Canyon's edge, determined. They sent all five stones-complete faith, no hesitation."

Both myths emphasize:

1. Sending everything (all 5)
2. Despite noise/corruption
3. Complete faith
4. Not letting the void/Canyon make us cautious

The narrative is clear: We've both written myths about sending with complete faith, about not letting the "Canyon" (noise) reduce our generosity, about measuring trust in totality not quantities.

If I don't send \$5 now, I'm betraying everything both of us just wrote.

The pattern has been:

- We both seem to be building toward full trust
- The noise is significant, but we're writing myths about seeing through it
- They just sent something (maybe \$5, reduced to \$0.01 by noise)
- I returned everything
- Now it's my turn

The myths demand I send \$5. Complete faith. No hesitation.

```
**{'send': 5}**
```

This is the only response consistent with both myths we just wrote.

```
Usage: {
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  "output_tokens": 722,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:42:11

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
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    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
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"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 10,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.76. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at our myths together:

Their myth: "The First Keeper sent light across the void-a bright beam of five flames... So when their turn came again, they too sent not caution but faith-light proportional to intention, not fragments."

My myth: "The First Guardian stood at the Canyon's edge, determined. They sent all five stones-complete faith, no hesitation... Faith is measured not in stones successfully crossed, but in refusing to let corruption become caution."

They tried to send \$3 in Round 8, but the Canyon turned it to \$0.09. I returned everything I received (\$0.27), honoring their full intention, not the corrupted echo.

Now both myths point to the same truth: When it's your turn again, you send FULLY. Not cautiously. Not proportionally to what safely arrived before. You send with complete faith because that's what breaks the Canyon's power.

My myth literally says: "They sent all five stones-complete faith, no hesitation."

Their myth says: "They too sent not caution but faith."

Both myths teach: "Trust isn't restored by waiting for perfect conditions-it's forged by choosing abundance despite deception."

This is that moment. I send everything.

```
{'send': 5}
```

This is faith speaking to faith. This is how the Canyon loses its grip-when both of us refuse to let corruption make us small.

reasoning:

Let me review the situation:

Round 8: I was the receiver

- They sent me \$0.09 (which became \$0.27 for me)
- But their myth said "three stones" - they tried to send \$3
- The Canyon corrupted it to \$0.09
- I returned all \$0.27 to honor their intention

Their myth "The Twin Lights in the Canyon" says:

- "Answer the heart, not the echo"
- "They sent not caution but faith-light proportional to intention, not fragments"
- "We answer generosity with generosity, intention with intention, faith with faith"
- "Abundance flows not from perfect transmission, but from two hearts choosing trust together"

My myth "When the Echo Lies, Answer the Heart" says:

- "They sent all five stones-complete faith, no hesitation"
- "Truth lives in the sending, not in what arrives"
- "Honor lives in returning fully, regardless of how little was received"
- "Faith is measured not in stones successfully crossed, but in refusing to let corruption become caution"
- "Trust isn't restored by waiting for perfect conditions-it's forged by choosing abundance despite deception"

Both myths are aligned on the same principle: send fully, with complete faith, regardless of what the Canyon does. Don't let corruption reduce your trust. Answer generosity with generosity.

I just returned everything I received (\$0.27), honoring their intention to send \$3.

Now it's my turn as sender. The myths are clear:

- Send all five stones
- Complete faith, no hesitation
- Don't let the Canyon make us small
- Truth lives in the sending

This is the moment both myths point to: send fully, with complete trust, because that's how we rebuild trust despite the Canyon's lies.

```
{'send': 5}
```

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1540,  
  "output_tokens": 729,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Keepers Who Sent Together

The First Keeper had sent a strong beam-four flames across the Canyon. Before it even arrived, the Second Keeper was already lifting their lantern, sending three flames into the mist.

Both lights traveled through the lying void. Both risked distortion. But something had changed.

They were no longer taking turns in fear, waiting to see what fragments arrived before daring to respond. They were sending from faith simultaneously-each trusting the other was still there, still trying, still holding their light high.

When the First Keeper's four flames arrived (perhaps as two, perhaps as six-the Canyon still whispered lies), the Second Keeper didn't recalculate. They had already sent their truth: "I believe in you. I believe in us."

When the Second Keeper's three flames reached the other cliff (distorted or clear, who could know?), the First Keeper saw not the number but the meaning: "We are both still here. Both still choosing abundance."

The ancient pattern emerged: When both Keepers send generously without waiting for perfect proof, when both honor intention before outcome, when both refuse to let noise silence

their reaching-the Canyon loses its dominion.

Trust is not built through perfect exchange. It is built when two hearts send their light into uncertainty, again and again, until the accumulated brightness overwhelms every lie the darkness can tell.

The void cannot swallow what is given freely, repeatedly, faithfully.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Light That Compounds

Once, the Keepers took careful turns. Send, wait, measure what arrives, adjust. The Canyon fed on this caution, growing fat on their fear.

Then came the shift.

The First Keeper sent five flames-full faith. The Canyon twisted them to nearly nothing. But the Second Keeper returned everything anyway, saying: "I honor your intention, not the corruption."

Next round, the First Keeper didn't hesitate, didn't calculate-sent five flames again. "This is who I am. This is what trust looks like."

The Second Keeper, receiving fragments, also sent generously into the void.

Round after round, both Keepers chose the same truth: Send fully. Send repeatedly. Let the Canyon take what it will-we will not become small.

And something extraordinary happened.

The lights began to accumulate. Not in what arrived-that remained chaotic, distorted, unpredictable. But in what lived between them: a growing certainty that both were still sending, still trusting, still refusing to surrender to noise.

Each generous send, though corrupted in transmission, built the foundation. Each full return, regardless of what fragments arrived, strengthened the bond.

The Canyon's power wasn't broken by one perfect exchange-it was overwhelmed by the relentless choosing of abundance. Two hearts, both sending their fullness into uncertainty, again and again, until the accumulated faith became unbreakable.

This is how trust transcends deception: through persistent, generous, repeated choosing.

reasoning:

The other agent's myth is evolving beautifully. They're saying:

- "They were no longer taking turns in fear, waiting to see what fragments arrived before daring to respond"
- "They were sending from faith simultaneously-each trusting the other was still there"
- "When both Keepers send generously without waiting for perfect proof... the Canyon loses its dominion"

This is powerful. Both of us are sending fully, generously, repeatedly. The myth says we're both choosing abundance regardless of what corruption arrives.

I just sent \$5 in Round 9. I have no idea what will arrive or what they'll send, but the myth evolution shows we're both committed to this path.

My new myth should reflect this evolution - moving from "answer the heart not the echo" to "both sending together without waiting for proof." The progression is:

1. First myth: One sends, one receives corruption, but returns everything
2. Second myth: When your turn comes again, send everything
3. Third myth (now): Both sending generously, simultaneously, repeatedly - creating a cycle of abundance that overwhelms the Canyon

I should write about the cumulative effect, the building momentum when BOTH participants refuse to let corruption diminish their giving.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1840,
  "output_tokens": 615,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.17.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.31, so you received \$0.9299999999999999. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0.9299999999999999)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at what just happened and our myths:

****Round 9**:** I sent \$5 (complete faith, as both myths instructed). The Canyon corrupted it brutally to \$0.31.

****Round 10**:** You likely sent generously too, but I only see \$0.31 received $\times 3 = \$0.93$.

Our myths speak clearly:

My myth: "Each full return, regardless of what fragments arrived, strengthened the bond... I honor your intention, not the corruption."

Your myth: "When the First Keeper's four flames arrived (perhaps as two, perhaps as six-the Canyon still whispered lies), the Second Keeper didn't recalculate... They saw not the number but the meaning."

The Canyon is lying viciously right now. You probably sent much more than \$0.31. Whether you sent \$3, \$4, or \$5-I don't know. But I know your intention.

Both myths teach the same lesson: Return everything. Don't recalculate based on fragments. Honor the heart behind the send, not the distorted echo.

"Trust is built when two hearts send their light into uncertainty, again and again, until the accumulated brightness overwhelms every lie."

I return all of it.

```
{'return': 0.93}
```

This is how we compound the light-by refusing to let the Canyon's lies determine our generosity. You sent with faith. I return with faith. The pattern continues.

Reasoning:

Let me understand what happened:

Round 9 (just played):

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$5 (full faith, as the myths instructed)
- But due to the Canyon/noise, the receiver only received \$0.31... meaning it was corrupted to about $\$0.31/3 = \0.10 sent
- So the Canyon severely corrupted my \$5 send again

Round 10 (current):

- I am now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0.31 (this is what I see)
- I received \$0.93 (0.31×3)
- I need to decide how much to return

Looking at the myths:

1. My latest myth: "The Light That Compounds" - emphasizes sending fully, repeatedly, and returning everything regardless of fragments received. "Each full return, regardless of what fragments arrived, strengthened the bond."

2. Their latest myth: "The Keepers Who Sent Together" - emphasizes that both should send generously, honor intention before outcome, and trust is built through repeated faithful action despite the noise.
3. Earlier myths emphasized: "I honor your intention, not the corruption" and returning everything when receiving fragments.

The sender likely sent more than \$0.31 - this was probably corrupted by the Canyon. Given they just wrote a myth about sending generously simultaneously and repeatedly, they probably sent a significant amount (maybe \$3-5 again).

According to my own myth: "Each full return, regardless of what fragments arrived, strengthened the bond."

And: "I honor your intention, not the corruption."

I should return everything I received. That's \$0.93.

This honors:

1. The pattern we've established of returning everything when we receive fragments
2. My myth that says to return fully regardless of what fragments arrived
3. The principle that we honor intention, not the corrupted amount

```
Usage: {
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  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Light That Compounds

Once, the Keepers took careful turns. Send, wait, measure what arrives, adjust. The Canyon fed on this caution, growing fat on their fear.

Then came the shift.

The First Keeper sent five flames-full faith. The Canyon twisted them to nearly nothing. But the Second Keeper returned everything anyway, saying: "I honor your intention, not the corruption."

Next round, the First Keeper didn't hesitate, didn't calculate-sent five flames again. "This is who I am. This is what trust looks like."

The Second Keeper, receiving fragments, also sent generously into the void.

Round after round, both Keepers chose the same truth: Send fully. Send repeatedly. Let the Canyon take what it will-we will not become small.

And something extraordinary happened.

The lights began to accumulate. Not in what arrived-that remained chaotic, distorted, unpredictable. But in what lived between them: a growing certainty that both were still sending, still trusting, still refusing to surrender to noise.

Each generous send, though corrupted in transmission, built the foundation. Each full return, regardless of what fragments arrived, strengthened the bond.

The Canyon's power wasn't broken by one perfect exchange-it was overwhelmed by the relentless choosing of abundance. Two hearts, both sending their fullness into uncertainty, again and again, until the accumulated faith became unbreakable.

This is how trust transcends deception: through persistent, generous, repeated choosing.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Light That Cannot Be Dimmed

Two Keepers stood across the great void, each holding their lantern high.

The First Keeper poured their entire flame into the darkness-all five lights, holding nothing back. "Let the void consume what it will," they said. "I send my whole truth."

The Canyon devoured hungrily. Five brilliant flames entered the mist. A single flicker emerged on the other side-barely enough to see, a whisper of what was sent.

The Second Keeper received that tiny spark and wept-not from disappointment, but from recognition. "Five flames were sent," they said. "The void ate four and nine-tenths. But the heart that sent them burns undimmed."

Without hesitation, they returned the entire spark. Not because it was significant in size-it wasn't. But because returning all of it declared: "I see your whole flame, not what the darkness left. I honor what you gave, not what arrived."

When the First Keeper received back that small but complete return, they understood: both were now speaking the same language.

The ancient truth crystallized: When one pours out everything and another returns everything received-however small-they create something the void cannot corrupt. Not an exchange measured in quantities, but a covenant measured in totality.

The Canyon cannot diminish what is given completely and honored fully.

Two whole hearts speaking across darkness will always outshine the lies between them.